TUESDAY
September 29, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
18 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 231
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

To subscribe, give a missed call at 9828331787 or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna

BROAD-BASED UPTICK

India's IIP growth quickens to 8% in Aug.

BUSINESS » PAGE 13

ROAD-WIDENING PROJECT

15 held after clashes over razing portion of M.P. mosque

NEWS » PAGE 12

'UNFULFILLED PROMISE'

J&K Assembly passes Statehood resolution

NEWS » PAGE 10

CONFLICT ZONE

Time runs short for Iran and America

Both must hear the bells toll as economies falter

EDITORIAL » PAGE 8

ASIAN GAMES

India wins four silver, four bronze medals

SPORT » PAGE 15

NEARBY

Vijay launches gold-ring scheme for newborns

MADURAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday launched the '*Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam*' here, marking the rollout of the scheme under which a gold ring will be gifted to newborns in government hospitals. » PAGE 6

HC rejects plea against TVK MLA's single-vote win

CHENNAI
The Madras High Court has rejected an election petition against the victory of TVK MLA R. Seenivasa Sethupathy from the Tirupattur constituency by a razor-thin margin of one vote in the 2026 election. » PAGE 6

Authorities lax in ensuring women's safety in Delhi: SC

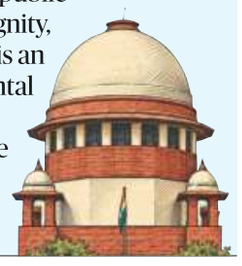
Court takes *suo motu* cognisance of recent sexual violence cases in the National Capital Region; administrative deficiencies should not make people unsafe in parks, transport networks, it says

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

Taking *suo motu* cognisance of a spate of sexual assault incidents against minors and women in the Delhi-National Capital Region (NCR), the Supreme Court on Monday directed the Delhi Police to immediately identify vulnerable pockets, step up patrolling, and undertake an audit of lighting and CCTV coverage in public spaces within four weeks.

A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran observed that public spaces, including parks, buses, and Metro stations, cannot be allowed to become "zones of high risk" because of deficiencies such as "grossly inadequate illumination" and "lax patrolling". Where basic measures of public safety remain compromised, no individual, irrespective of age, gender or sexual identity, can navigate public spaces with a sense of security, it said.

> These incidents, considered alongside recent reports of sexual offences across Delhi-NCR, starkly underline the failure of law enforcement and public administration authorities to guarantee basic public safety. The right to live with dignity, free from the fear of violence, is an intrinsic facet of the fundamental guarantee of life and personal liberty enshrined under Article 21 of the Constitution
>
> SUPREME COURT BENCH



It took note of several recent cases of sexual violence reported in the national capital, including the rape of a 17-year-old at Astha Kunj park near Lady Shri Ram College, the gang-rape of a minor at Swaroop Nagar, and the sexual assault of another minor inside a bus travelling from Greater Noida to Delhi. "These incidents, considered alongside recent reports of sexual offences across Delhi-NCR, starkly underline the failure of law enforcement and public administration authorities to guarantee basic public safety. The right to live with dignity, free from the fear of violence, is an intrinsic facet of the fundamental guarantee of life and personal liberty enshrined under Article 21 of the Constitution," the Bench said.

The Delhi Police and other authorities have also been asked to file a detailed response outlining the measures currently in place to ensure safety at parks, educational institutions, and other areas frequented by women and children.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10

States stumped by demography panel's religion-wise queries

EXCLUSIVE

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

State governments are unable to answer most of the queries posed by a high-level panel studying demographic changes, as departments do not ordinarily maintain much of the information sought by the panel on a religion-wise basis.

The High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC) under the Union Home Ministry has sought religion-wise data for the past 15 years on birth and vehicle registrations, school enrolment, and property transactions, as well as district-wise details of religious structures and unusual increases in Aadhaar, and voter ID registrations. States have been asked to collate data on Hindus, Sikhs, Christians, Muslims, Parsis and Buddhists in all the categories.

State officials told *The Hindu* that the set of 35 questions asked by the panel was difficult to answer as the secular construct of the Constitution prohibited the collection of data under religious categories.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10

Unusual data

The HLCDC has sought religion-wise records from States for the past 15 years

Information sought on:

- Birth registration
- School enrolment
- Property transaction
- Vehicle registration
- Religious structures
- Voter registration

Yet another POCSO case filed against Veeramani

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Police registered a fresh case against 'Gem Granites' R. Veeramani under the POCSO Act, police sources said on Monday.

The second case was registered on a complaint filed by a woman that her daughter, a minor, was sexually abused by the businessman. The Special Investigation Team (SIT) has taken up the probe. The police booked Veeramani, 85, under the POCSO Act, and are likely to formally arrest him. He is currently lodged at the Puzhal prison in connection with a different POCSO case.

The police are probing the statements given by three other women that they were subjected to sexual abuse by him.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 6

Dr. M.G.R.
EDUCATIONAL AND RESEARCH INSTITUTE
UNIVERSITY
University with Graded Autonomy Status
(An ISO 21001 : 2018 Certified Institution)
Periyar E.V.R. High Road, Maduravoyal, Chennai-95. Tamilnadu, India.

ACCREDITED WITH GRADE A+ NAAC

Chancellor, President, Vice-President, Vice-Chancellor, Pro Vice-Chancellors,
Rector, Members of the Executive Council, Faculty & Students cordially invite you to the

36th CONVOCATION

Chief Guest
Thiru. Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar
Hon'ble Governor of Tamil Nadu and Keralam
has kindly consented to participate as the
Chief Guest and deliver the Convocation Address

Venue:
A.C.S. Convention Centre
A.C.S. Medical College & Hospital Campus, Velappanchavadi, Chennai - 77.

Dr. A.C. Shanmugam
B.A., B.L., FRCPS (UK), Former M.P., M.L.A.,
Chancellor
Dr. M.G.R. University
Will preside

Date:
30.09.2026
Time:
11:00 AM

In the presence of
Thiru. Er. A.C.S. Arun Kumar
President
Dr. M.G.R. University

Tmt. S. LALITHALAKSHMI
Managing Trustee
MGRERI Trust

Tmt. NIRMALA ARUNKUMAR
Director

Thiru. A. RAVIKUMAR
Secretary
A.C.S. Medical College and Hospital

Dr.S. GEETHALAKSHMI
Vice - Chancellor

Dr. C.B. PALANIVELU
Registrar

ENGINEERING | MEDICINE | PHARMACY | NURSING | DENTAL | LAW | EDUCATION | COMPUTER APPLICATIONS | AVIATION | FASHION DESIGN | ALLIED HEALTH SCIENCES | ARCHITECTURE | MGMT. STUDIES | HUMANITIES & SCIENCE | PHYSIOTHERAPY | ARTS & COMMERCE | DEFENCE & STRATEGIC STUDIES | HOTEL MGMT. & CULN. ARTS, | ANIMATION & VISCOM | RESEARCH | ONLINE PROGRAMS

10-year-old girl sexually assaulted, one arrested

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 10-year-old girl with cerebral palsy was allegedly sexually assaulted by a man when she was alone at her house near Madurantakam in Chengalpattu district on Friday (September 25). Based on a complaint from her parents, the All Women Police, Melmaruvathur registered a case and launched an investigation.

Police sources said the accused was detained for questioning on Sunday and remanded in judicial custody after the inquiry.

Police sources said the survivor was alone at home when her parents had been away for a few hours to attend a relative's function. The accused allegedly entered the house, sexually assaulted her and fled. The girl told the incident to her parents after they came back.

On Saturday, the girl's parents lodged a complaint, based on which the police registered a case under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act. Police identified the suspect on Sunday and detained him for questioning. A few more persons were also inquired by the police in connection with the incident.

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami expressed concern over the reported incident and urged the government to take stringent action against those responsible.

Tambaram City Police meet IT firms' officials, stress employee safety

The meeting focused on women's safety, cybercrime and digital fraud, traffic safety, emergency preparedness, and drug-abuse prevention

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tambaram City Police on Monday held a meeting with representatives and security officials of major IT companies to strengthen coordination on employee safety, crime prevention and emergency response.

The meeting, led by Commissioner of Police Prem Anand Sinha, focused on women's safety, cybercrime and digital fraud, night-shift transport, traffic safety, emergency preparedness and drug-abuse prevention.

Police officials stressed the need for safe pick-up and drop-off points, verified transport, adequate CCTV coverage and lighting, and prompt reporting of incidents. Measures to improve traffic management along IT corridors and create greater awareness of cyber fraud were also discussed.

Timely outreach: Tambaram Police Commissioner Prem Anand Sinha addressing a meeting held with representatives and security officials of major IT companies.

The police briefed the companies on initiatives such as Kaval Udhavi, Singappen Special Force and WhatsCop

The police briefed the companies on initiatives including Kaval Udhavi, Singappen Special Force and WhatsCop. Companies were asked to designate nodal officers and 24x7 emergency contacts, identify vulnerable locations, facilitate CCTV coordination and participate in awareness programmes and emergency drills.

Mr. Sinha said the meeting ended with a commitment to closer coordination among the police, IT companies, employees and transport operators to improve security along the IT corridors in Tambaram.

Book documenting contemporary architecture of Chennai released

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Architecture expert P.T. Krishnan releasing the book curated by A. Srivathsan and Fiona Evangeline S. in the presence of N. Murali, Chairman, The Hindu Group, N. Ram, Director, The Hindu Group, Suresh Nambath, Editor, *The Hindu*, historian V. Sriram, and architect Pramod Balakrishnan. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

A new book documenting contemporary architecture in Chennai was released on Monday. Published by the Chennai Architecture Foundation (CAF) and The Hindu Group, the book has been curated by architects A. Srivathsan and Fiona Evangeline S.

Titled 'Chennai Contemporary Architecture: A Guide', the book was released by renowned architecture expert P.T. Krishnan in the presence of N. Murali, Chairman, The Hindu Group, N. Ram, Director, The Hindu Group, Suresh Nambath, Editor, *The Hindu*, historian V. Sriram, and architect Pramod Balakrishnan.

Speaking at the launch, Mr. Ram said the book was not a conventional "then versus now" account of Chennai's architecture. He described it as a balanced and accessible guide that documented the city's architectural evolution, particularly after the economic liberalisation of the 1990s.

Mr. Ram said the book would be useful not only to architecture students and professionals but also to others interested in the city and its built environment.

Of the 52 buildings featured in the book, 28 were mostly constructed after 1995, and have detailed descriptions, drawings, and interviews with architects. Another 24 buildings provide a broader view of the city's architectural development.

Tracing the evolution of modern architecture in India, Mr. Krishnan said Chennai's relative distance from dominant architectural schools had also given its architects a degree of freedom. "There are advantages to being in the wilderness because it offers you total freedom," he said, adding that this freedom had been used productively by architects in the city. Mr. Krishnan said the book documented what he described as an "enlightenment" in the architectural scene, where external factors such as environmental conditions and human behaviour were increasingly shaping buildings. "This gives a new meaning to the idea that form follows function. I think the whole concept needs to be re-understood. If we understand this new interpretation of 'form follows function', I think we are ready for the future," he said.

Historian V. Sriram welcomed the book's attention to structural elements and the ways in which buildings responded to local requirements. "It just shows that creativity is not stopped, and it is not correct to trash everything as concrete and glass and cement and say that's all finished," he said.

Mr. Srivathsan said the book was conceived fundamentally as "an historical record of the present". The decision to focus largely on buildings from 1995 onwards, he said, was driven by the significant changes in Chennai's architectural landscape following economic reforms and the emergence of new generations of architects.

The cover price of the book is ₹699. As a launch offer, it is available at ₹550 for a limited period. The book can be purchased at https://publications.thehindugroup.com/ or by scanning the QR code.

Metro Railway, Kolkata

e-Tender is invited by Principal Chief Engineer, Metro Railway for the following work: **Name of work:** Supply, installation, commissioning and operating of track based gauge face rail lubricators (Electronic type) for 05 years at Noapara-Jai Hind Bimanbandar section of Yellow Line of Metro Railway, Kolkata. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 2,10,51,120/-. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 2,55,300/-. **Completion Period:** Sixty (60) Months. **Date and Time of Closing:** 27.10.2026 at 12:00 Hrs. The Tender Document and other details can be obtained from the website **www.ireps.gov.in** Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be uploaded only on the website.

Abridged e-Tender Notice No. : Civil-2549-2026-Recall(Open) (Two Packet)

Follow us at: /metrorailwaykol /metrorailkolkata

MSME TECHNOLOGY CENTRE
Ministry of MSME Govt. Of India
MINISTRY OF MICRO, SMALL & MEDIUM ENTERPRISES, GOVT. OF INDIA
KIADB Industrial Estate, Devanahalli, Bengaluru
HOW TO SUCCESSFULLY VENTURE INTO WORLD WIDE BUSINESS OF
EXPORT- IMPORT
Start Your Own Business
Course Duration 2 Days (ONLINE) Date: 03 & 04 October 2026 Time : 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM
Course Content: Export Documentation, **Market Identification, Launching Business, Locating the resources, Pricing Strategies & Payments , Buyer/Seller Identification, Policies and Schemes, Getting Finance for Export,** Forex Risk Management, finding top Importing Countries for your products, **High Potential Products, Role of Banks in Trade, Terms & strategies to crack export order successfully,** E-Commerce in Export, Anti Dumping Laws, **Government Schemes, Letter of credit Incentive, EXPORT PRICING AND PAYMENT SYSTEMS, Latest Updates on Export-Import (GST), HOW TO FIND EXPORT OPPORTUNITIES**
Fees : Rs.3,540/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
Coordinator: 9818676612, 9818528498, 9686564246
Government of India certificate will be awarded

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

For & on behalf of The President of India, Sr.CDO, Santragachi, South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur Division, invites an open tender, through e-tendering in **www.ireps.gov.in** website as per details mentioned below. Eligible tenderers are requested to apply for the same through online only in website as per details mentioned below. No offline tender will be accepted. Please read the tender document uploaded in the document section for details. **Tender Notice No.: C-SRC-LAU-R-dt-250926; Name of Work:** "Maintenance of mechanized laundry machines & equipment at Coaching Depot, Santragachi and Operations of laundry machines for washing and packaging of linens" for a period of 03 (three) years." **Tender Value:** ₹33,23,17,094.23/-; **EMD:** ₹18,11,600/-; **Closing Date of Tender:** 16.10.2026 at 11:30 hrs.; **Cost of Tender Document :** ₹10,000/- **(PR-815)**

UTTAR PRADESH MEDICAL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of Uttar Pradesh Undertaking)
Tender Notice
Tender Ref.No: UPMSCL/Drugs-267/19 Date: 24th September, 2026
e-TENDER FOR SUPPLY OF DRUGS
Online tenders are invited from licensed manufacturers for supply of drugs to UPMSCL. The details of tender, list of items and Tender Documents are made available on website https://etender.up.nic.in and www.upmsc.in. The last date/time of online submission of the tender documents is 15th October, 2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.
Managing Director
UPMSCL, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
Department of Medical Health & Family Welfare, Uttar Pradesh

Government of Tamil Nadu
TAMIL NADU e-GOVERNANCE AGENCY (TNeGA)
TNeGA
2nd Floor, P.T. Lee Chengalvarayan Naicker Maaligai, 807, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600 002
www.tnega.tn.gov.in | +91-44-40164907 |
Email: tenders.tnega@tn.gov.in | GST-33AABTT6381N1ZZ
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender No: TNeGA/OT/CBTE/01/2026-2027
TNeGA invites Tender for empanelment of vendors for conducting "Computer Based Test for various government Agencies". For complete details, please visit **https://tntenders.gov.in.** Pre-bid meeting: **08.10.2026, 11:30 AM** at TNeGA Office. Last date for submission of e-bids: **29.10.2026, 04:00 PM.** Date of opening of technical bids: **29.10.2026, 04:30 PM.** For queries: **tenders.tnega@tn.gov.in**
DIPR/2967/Tender/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER**

AMARAVATI GROWTH AND INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGICL)
2nd Floor, APCRDA Project Office, Rayapudi, Thulluru Mandal, Guntur Dist. (A.P.)-522237.
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

Sl. No.	Name of the Work	NIT NO.
1.	Providing Electrical, HVAC, Firefighting System, Lifts, Fire Alarm, Detection & Public Address System, ELV (Structured Cabling System) and Plumbing works for Legislative Assembly Building in Super block, "E" of Amaravati Govt. Complex Area in Amaravati Capital city, Andhra Pradesh".	**NIT No. 21/MD/CE(ELE)/ AGICL/2026, Dated: 28.09.2026**
2.	"Providing MEP like high side Electrical, HVAC, Fire Fighting, Lifts, Plumbing Works and ELV works to the High Court Building in Super Block "F" Amaravati Government Complex Area in Amaravati Capital City, Andhra Pradesh".	**NIT No. 22/MD/CE(ELE)/ AGICL/2026, Dated: 28.09.2026**

The bids can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **30-09-2026.** For further details, please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **www.agicl.org .**
Sd/- Managing Director, AGICL, Amaravati

TAMILNADU INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
TIDCO
19-A, Rukmini Lakshmipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008
CIN-U65993TN1965SGC005327
e-TENDER NOTICE
NIT. No. TIDCO/DFH-Coimbatore/2026-27 Date:29.09.2026
TIDCO invites bids from the eligible bidders through e-Tender for the work mentioned below:

S.No	Particulars	EMD Amount in Rs.
1.	e-Tender for Selection of Consultant for Preparation of Techno-Economic Feasibility Report for Establishment of Digital FinTech Hub at Coimbatore.	3,00,000/-

Tenders shall be uploaded through **https://tntenders.gov.in** on or before **3.00 PM on 29.10.2026** and the same will be opened **on 29.10.2026 at 5.00 PM.**
For More details, please visit **https://tntenders.gov.in**
DIPR/2957/TENDER/2026 **Chairman and Managing Director TIDCO**

Technology Development Board
Department of Science & Technology Block-II, 2nd Floor, Technology Bhawan, New Mehrauli Road, New Delhi-110016
Website: www.tdb.gov.in
TENDER NOTICE
Tender Reference No.: TDB-140R/2/2026 Date: 29-09-2026
TDB invites Expressions of Interest (EOIs) from reputed and experienced consulting firms / companies for empanelemnt to provide compliance Screening and Extended Know Your Customer (KYC) consulting Services for proposals submitted by start-ups, MSMEs, companies, research institutions and other eligible entities seeking financial assistance under the Technology Development Board – Research, Development and Innovation Fund (TDB-RDIF).
The EOI document is available on the TDB website: i.e. **www.tdb.gov.in** Interested Firms may download the EOI documents from the website and submit their Proposals.
The last date of receipt of Tender 21-10-2026 before 17:00 Hrs. at TDB, Technology Bhawan, New Delhi.
Under Secretary TDB
CBC 36106/11/0007/2627

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
Corrigendum
Tender Notice No. E-DRM-Engg-ADRA-96-26 Dtd. 03.09.2026, published earlier by Sr. Divisional Railway Engineer(Co), S.E. Railway, Adra, in which the tender Closing Date Scheduled on 28.09.2026 instead of should be read as **06.10.2026** due to administrative reason. Other aspects are same as published earlier. Other terms and conditions of original tender notice shall remain unchanged. **(PR-820/C)**

Centre for Railway Information Systems
CRIS
Chanakyapuri, New Delhi-110021
Tel : 011-24106717, 24104525
Tender No. : 01265244 **Tender Title : Procurement of 'Data Replication Service from Divisional COA Server to Central Server & vice versa' and 'Hardware' & OEM Man Days. Date of Closing : 21.10.2026 (Wednesday)** 15:30 hrs. **Pre-Bid Meeting on: 07.10.2026 (Wednesday)** at 11:30 hrs. CRIS at CRIS, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi-110021. Tender Documents may be downloaded from Website **www.ireps.gov.in.** For future modification/extensions pl. see **www.ireps.gov.in.**

CLASSIFIEDS SPECIAL

HANBAO®
Fans | Appliances | Houseware
Ayudha Pooja All Festival Gifting
PRODUCT RANGE 69/-* ONWARDS
Kettles | Airfryer | Induction Stove
Bullet Mixer | Houseware | Cookware
Corporate/Custom Gifting/Bulk Orders
Mob. : +91 99401 39999
www.hanbaoindia.com
*Call/Whatsapp for Free Product Demo.

MAKNILL®
(Magnesium Sulphate Paste BP)
Presentation 10x15, 75 & 400 gms.
- A researched ready to apply magnesium sulphate paste without cumbersome mixing and heating by the nursing staff
- Another unique product from Southern Soleil.
- A Popular Product in UK offered by Southern Soleil.
- 'Drawing Paste' or 'Morrison Paste' as it is called helps to treat skin infections, including boils, acne and to reduce swelling.
- It is also used to remove splinters.
- Good remedy for Carbuncles, Boils, Bruises and Sprains.

For External Use only
Cellulitis
May also be used in the treatment of prolonged administration of intramuscular injections & IV drips - Phlebitis. Hematoma, Insect bites swelling,finger nail boils, diabetic foot swelling.
Phlebitis
A brand of Soleil®
Quality products manufacturer for more than 70 years Available with all leading distributors
For use under Medical Supervision only
Scan for video
Under trade mark agreement with
Southern Soleil
Chennai-600 021.
Phone : 044-25904323 Airtel : 044-42081090
Cell : 09884257495
Email: soleilsouthern5@gmail.com
Web site: southernsoleil.com

WORLD HEART DAY
Classifieds Special

மத்திய அரசின்
மக்கள் மருந்தகம்
T.NAGAR | KANDIGAI | PERUMBAKKAM | VANAGARAM
30% முதல்
உங்கள் பணத்தை சேமியுங்கள்
90% வரை
1400 MEDICINES AVAILABLE
Generic Medical Store
Pradhan Mantri Bharthiya Jan Aushadhi Kendra
50%
Online Order Available
Home Delivery
75300 98222, 86109 85363, 87545 68022 ,7305965671
93423 36125 98841 58567
T.Nagar : 30/19, Shop No:1, Duraiswamy Road, (Near Duraiswamy Subway) T.Nagar, Ch - 17.
Kandigai : No.12, Kelambakkam Main Road, Nallambakkam Panchayat, Union Kandigai, Ch-127
Perumbakkam : No.7/749,1st Main Rd, Nookampalayam Main Road, St.Thomas mount union, Perumbakkam, Ch - 100
Vanagaram : Plot no .6 ,Vanagaram Main Road, Porur Garden, Phase 2, Ch - 95
pmbjktnagar@gmail.com | www.buyjanashudhionline.com

WORLD HEART DAY
29 SEPTEMBER
repute
PACKAGED DRINKING WATER
"Your Healthy Partner"
Pure Water Healthy Heart
Customer Care 98845 44444

To advertise in
Classifieds Special
Contact: **T Muni Babu @** 98407 95023
Toll Free @ 1800 102 4161

AMS
SKIN CARE CLINIC
Dermatologist | Cosmetologist
Anti Hair Loss Treatment
PRP @ LOWER PRICE
VITILIGO TREATMENT
Purasaiwalkam, New Washermanpet
CONSULTATION BY APPOINTMENT
97105 16205

CINEMA ARTS EVENTS
MUSIC DANCE DRAMA
Papanasam Sivan Rasikar Sangam ,Chennai In association with Narada Gana Sabha, Chennai Presents
SIVANISAI MUSIC FESTIVAL - 2026
On the occasion of 136th Birthday Celebrations of Brahmasri Papanasam Sivan
Today at Sathguru Gnanananda Hall, Narada Gana Sabha.
5.00 PM - "Carnatic Jugalbandi"- Vid.Kunnakudi M Balamuralikrishna-Vocal, Vid.M.A.Sundaresan-Violin and Vid.Mylai Karthikeyan –Nadaswaram with Vid. Mannargudi M.R.Vasudevan and Vid. Tharapuram V Ganesan-Special Thavil.
7.00 PM -"Sivanin Paadhayil"- Sangeetha Upanyasam by Sri.U.Ve.Dushyanth Sridhar with Vocal support by Vid.Sakthi Muralidharan.
Master of Ceremony:Smt.Revathy Sankaran
Main Sponsor: Lancor Holdings Limited.
Co-Sponsors: COSMO, Kalpataru Doors and Plywood, Kone Elevators & Escalators, Mangal Tirth, Natraj & Venkat Architects and Roca.
All are welcome.

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
044-28576300
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

CLASSIFIEDS MART
TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 044-28576300
TOLL FREE: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised space sellers

PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME
I, Anandhi K, Residing at B211, Elegants Pinnacle Apt, 480, Nukampalayam link Road, Semmancherry, Chennai-19, have changed my Minor Son's Name from Nikhilesh S to Nikhil Vikram A.
OLD AGE HOME
PALLIATIVE CARE at your home Trained Nurses, 24/7, Dr., Physio visits, Lab tests 1800–313–1883 tikotra.com/seniors
HEALTH
HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Nagar. 60min– 999/– Ct: 90421 82828
HOME NEEDS
Parryware always in fashion
BATHROOM RENOVATION
From Professional Bathroom Makers Since 2001
FRIENDLY SERVICES
Call Now:
044 - 2432 3144
98412-95033
98412-78121
T.Nagar, Chennai - 600 017.

Flood mitigation works in city and suburbs to be completed by Oct. 15

An official says that works are being carried out at an estimated cost of ₹100 crore as part of the Northeast monsoon preparedness measures in the Greater Chennai Corporation areas, as per instructions from Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay

Aloysius Xavier Lopez
CHENNAI

The State government has extended the deadline for completion of flood mitigation work in Chennai and suburban districts and has ordered civic agencies to complete the work by October 15.

At a meeting on Monday, B. Chandra Mohan, Additional Chief Secretary/ Commissioner of Revenue Administration reviewed the flood mitigation works and monsoon preparatory works for Chennai, Chengalpattu, Tiruvallur, and Kancheepuram districts in the presence of Commissioners of Chennai, Avadi, and Tambaram Municipal Corporations, district revenue officials, WRD and highway officials.

Rain-ready: Of the 83 waterbodies taken up for improvement, works have been completed in 51. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The Commissioner of Revenue Administration also reviewed various flood mitigation works extensively and gave instructions to complete these before October 15.

"The construction of a storm-water drain network under ADB Scheme for Kosasthalaiyar basin is almost completed. The remaining 0.69 km will be completed in two weeks. The priority works in Kovalam basin covering Sholinganallur, Perungudi, Alandur will be completed before the onset of Northeast Monsoon," said an official.

In Chennai Corporation zones, desilting works were being carried out in 1,683 km of storm-water drains.

Desilting was completed in 1,328 km of drains so far. The work is under way, and will be completed in one week. Storm-water drain connectivity works were taken up at 105 locations covering 922 metres. Works were completed at 44 locations, while works are in progress at 61 locations that will be completed before the onset of monsoon, said an official.

Desilting and the removal of water hyacinth were not completed in many of the 44 waterways maintained by the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC), 13 canals maintained by the Water Resources Department, and the Cooum, Adyar, and Buckingham Canal. Residents had also complained about a delay in desilting work in the seven drains passing through minor railway bridges.

Improvement works started in 83 waterbodies and 51 waterbodies have been improved so far. Work was not completed in 32 water bodies.

An official said, as per the directions of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, works were being undertaken by allocating an estimated cost of ₹100 crore as part of Northeast monsoon preparedness measures in the GCC areas.

An online application was also developed for volunteers to register for relief operations, and the registration process is currently under way.

'Sakhi centre staff not paid for 3 months'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

PMK president Anbumani Ramadoss on Monday urged the Tamil Nadu government to immediately release three months' pending salaries to employees of Sakhi One Stop Centres, which provide support to women and children affected by violence.

In a statement, he said that the employees, who were paid between ₹10,000 and ₹22,000 a month on a contractual basis, faced severe financial hardship due to the delay in payment of salaries.

Mr. Ramadoss added that the centres, established at 59 locations across Tamil Nadu with Central government funding, provided medical assistance, legal aid, psychological counselling, temporary shelter, and rehabilitation services under one roof.

VCK chief against outsourcing reading of electricity meters

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan on Monday urged the Tamil Nadu government to drop its decision to outsource electricity meter reading to private companies and fill vacancies in the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited through internal recruitment. In a statement, he said Tamil Nadu had around 3.52 crore electricity consumers and complaints over power outages, delays in meter reading, and billing errors were increasing. He attributed the problems largely to staff shortage. Citing the department's White Paper, he said 53,575 posts were vacant and the government had announced plans to fill 20,449 posts, including 12,500 multi-purpose field and 945 technical assistants. He said the decision to outsource meter reading through a limited tender for six months from October amounted to an attempt to privatise the power utility.

Mr. Thirumavalavan also highlighted the shortage of substation operators, with around 1,800 posts vacant. He said around 600 employees who had cleared the internal recruitment process for technical assistant posts were awaiting appointment.

Two drown in sea in separate incidents

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Two persons drowned in separate incidents along the Chennai and Tiruvallur coast on Sunday night.

In the first incident, a 51-year-old mason drowned while bathing in the sea at Pulicat during a family outing on Sunday night. The police identified the victim as Gurumoorthy of Rajapalayam in Virudhunagar district.

While bathing in the sea, he fell unconscious after attempting somersaults in the water.

His relatives pulled him out and took him to Pulicat Government Hospital, where doctors declared him dead. The police suspect that he drowned.

In the second incident, a 19-year-old student at Loyola College drowned after being swept away by strong waves while bathing in the beach near Palagai Thotti Kuppam, the police said. The victim, Sunil, was a resident of Sivasakthi Nagar in Tiruvottiyur. His body washed ashore and was recovered by the Tiruvottiyur police.

Chief Minister announces ₹30 lakh for medallist

CHENNAI: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday congratulated athlete Vithya Ramraj on winning a bronze medal in the 400m hurdles at the Asian Games and announced a cash prize of ₹30 lakh. In a social media post, he said Ms. Ramraj had broken P.T. Usha's record, set at the 1984 Asian Games, describing it as a significant achievement.

Timings
CHENNAI

TUESDAY, SEP. 29			
RISE	05:59	SET	18:01
RISE	19:56	SET	08:07
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 30			
RISE	05:59	SET	18:00
RISE	20:49	SET	09:08
THURSDAY, OCT. 01			
RISE	05:59	SET	17:59
RISE	21:47	SET	10:11

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	38	29
Chennai City	38	28

Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. The night will be comfortable. A spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be very warm. The night will be comfortable. There are chances of light to moderate rain and thundershowers.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin 603209. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

Transpersons speak out against online backlash over *Dorothy*

They say the film showcases the lived experiences of members of the community, and request the public to see the good intentions of the film. The movie, which was released on September 25, faced homophobic and transphobic backlash online

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A cross-section of transpersons in Chennai on Monday has urged the public to not to criticise the recently released Tamil film *Dorothy,* as it showcases the lived experiences of the community. This comes after the film, released on September 25, faced homophobic and transphobic backlash online for the portrayal of the community.

Welcoming the movie, transwomen thanked director Karthik Subbaraj for portraying their experience very well.

Addressing the media, Kalaimamani Sudha, a transwoman said, "The movie is an eye opener for the public which showcases how transpersons live from childhood. As organisations, we couldn't take such messaging across to the public on a large scale, we are glad that the movie does this." She pointed out that in the past many movies have portrayed the community in a harsh light, not showcasing the truth just to move a plot forward. "This movie seemed as though I was watching my own experience come to the big screen. Our life is in the film," said Vaishnavi, a transwoman.

Fervent appeal: Transpersons at a media gathering in the city on Monday, urging the public not to criticise the recently released Tamil film *Dorothy*. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Speaking about the backlash, Sudha added there's a difference between sexual orientation and gender. "There is a need for good gender education to be imparted to the public. The general public are confusing themselves between two different sections," she said.

Narrating her own experience, transwoman Meghna said she hid her true self for over 15 years to accommodate society's expectations. "The movie is showing the truth of our community, for which we are very glad."

Transpersons further requested the public to see the good intentions of the film and not to assume the worst of it.

Webinar explores ways to prevent heart diseases

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Ahead of the World Heart Day on September 29, *The Hindu*, in association with Kauvery Hospital, conducted a webinar on Monday titled 'Don't Miss a Beat: Prevent, Detect & Treat Heart Disease'. The webinar brought together cardiac specialists, who spoke about minimally invasive heart procedures, ways to prevent heart disease, measures that people with a family history of heart disease can take to reduce risk, rehabilitation, congenital heart diseases in children, and other related topics.

The experts were Professor Ajith Pillai, Head of the Department and interventional cardiologist, Kauvery Hospital, Radial Road; Arunkumar Krishnaswamy, senior consultant, cardiothoracic surgeon, Kauvery Hospital, Alwarpet; Mahadevan V., senior consultant, interventional cardiology and diabetology, Kauvery Hospital, Vadapalani; and Javid Raja, consultant, paediatric cardiac surgeon, Kauvery Hospital, Heartcity, Tiruchi.

Dr. Ajith spoke about how minimally invasive heart procedures brought about a paradigm shift in cardiac surgery. He discussed transcatheter valve replacement and repair procedures, which are suitable for elderly people and those with diabetes, kidney disease, and other health conditions. He highlighted several benefits of minimally invasive surgeries.

Dr. Mahadevan discussed heart failure, describing it as a condition in which the heart is unable to pump enough blood to meet the body's demands. He said that if heart failure is detected early and treated at the right time, the heart can recover to near-normal functioning.

Dr. Arunkumar spoke about coronary artery bypass surgery, a landmark procedure that had improved life expectancy and quality of life. He discussed the evolution of various CABG techniques - from conventional surgery performed through a sternotomy using a cardiopulmonary bypass machine to the now-established 'beating-heart' surgery.

Dr. Javid elaborated on congenital heart disease, a structural problem in the heart that is present from birth. He said 1% of babies worldwide were affected by congenital heart disease, and one in four cases was considered critical and required care during infancy. The webinar was moderated by Meenakshy S., principal correspondent, *The Hindu*.

You can watch the webinar here: https://newsth.live/THKAHBY

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

BIRTHDAY REMEMBRANCE

85th BIRTHDAY REMEMBRANCE

29.09.1941 18.02.2020
Mr. J.R.M. FOULGER
EX-MFL
A remarkable life that inspired and uplifted many
Fondly remembered by:
Glory Foulger (Wife)
Josh Foulger (Son) and Family
Franklin Foulger (Son) and Family
Family and Friends

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

TWENTY EIGHTH ANNIVERSARY

KAMALA RAJASINGH
1932 - 1998
"Simple, kind and generous
A GODLY LIFE"

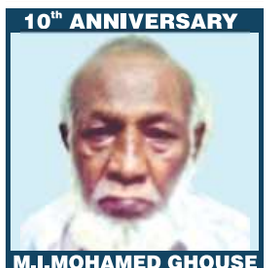
DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

NINTH ANNIVERSARY

In Loving Memory of
Dr. PREMA SEMBULINGAM
29.09.2017
Sanyu
Shruthi
Prakash
Sembulingam

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

10th ANNIVERSARY



M.I.MOHAMED GHOUSE
(Retd. Asst. Director- TN Govt. Press)
10 years have passed, but your memories remain in our hearts.
Remembered with love and prayers.
- Family Members

TWENTY FOURTH ANNIVERSARY

Dr.CHINNIAH GURUMURTHY
13.10.1954 29.09.2002
"Continuing Life Journey with you"
Dr.NIRMALA CHINNIAH, N.PRAVEEN KUMAR DEEPIKA PRAVEEN KAVIYA PRAVEEN KUMAR

25th DEATH ANNIVERSARY
IN LOVING MEMORY OF

SUGUNA SARATHY
You left us on 29.9.2001
25 years have gone but never forgotten
Your love remains with us always.
With lots of love from
Sucharitha Gopinath & Family

बिहार सरकार

अधीक्षक का कार्यालयः पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल, पटना
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल, पटना के आन्तरिक सुरक्षा व्यवस्था, अपराधिक गतिविधि का पहचान एवं कार्य व्यवस्था का सतत् निगरानी हेतु विभिन्न विभागों/वार्डो/आकस्मिकी आदि एवं आवश्यकतानुसार अस्पताल के अन्य स्थलों पर सी0सी0टी0भी0 कैमरा, एन0 भी0 आर0, मोनिटर एवं यू0पी0एस0 के अधिष्ठापन एवं संचालन हेतु द्वि–बोली प्रणाली के अन्तर्गत सीलबंद निविदा स्पीड पोस्ट/ निबंधित डाक से आमंत्रित की जाती है।

इस सम्बन्ध में विस्तृत जानकारी वास्ते अधीक्षक कार्यालय, पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल, पटना से निविदा प्रकाशन के पश्चात् सम्पर्क –समन्वय स्थापित कार्य–दिवसों में कार्यालय अवधि के बीच प्राप्त किया जा सकता है। निविदा संबंधित सभी जानकारी बेबसाइट www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखा एवं डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है।

Last date and time for receipt of tender :	21-10-2026 up to 5.00 PM
Place of submission of Tender :	Superintendent, Patna Medical College Hospital, Ashok Raj Path, Patna- 800004
Time and date of opening of Tender :	23-10-2026 at 12.30 PM in the Chamber of Superintendent, PMCH, Patna

अधीक्षक,
पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल
पटना

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR. No.012660 (Health) 2026-27

नशे से बनानी दूरी है, क्योंकि परिवार जरूरी है।

Govt. of Bihar

Office of the Executive Enginner
Master Planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division-1,
Room No.-503, 5th Floor, Block A, Jal Sansadhan Bhawan, Anisabad, Patna-800002,
Water Resources Department, Government of Bihar
Email Id:-eeapippd1@gmail.com
Short Notice Invitation
Request for Proposal
for

Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Kosi and Gandak River Corridor in Bihar.

Tender/ RFP No.:11/योo/**Ganga-RFP-**

1. Executive Engineer, Master planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division -1, WRD, Government of Bihar (Authority) invites this RFP proposals from eligible and experienced agencies for Selection of Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Kosi and Gandak River Corridor in Bihar.

Particulars	Bid processing Fees inclusive of GST (Non-refundable)	Bid Document Cost (Non-refundable)	Bid Security (EMD)
Selection for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Kosi and Gandak River Corridor in Bihar.	Rs. 1180/- (As applicable as per e-PROC Bid Processing Fee Structure)	INR 10,000/- (INR Ten Thousand only)	INR 2,00,000/- (INR Two Lakh only)

2.	Date of downloading of bid document	:	From 01.10.2026 to 14.10.2026 up to 03:00 PM
3.	Place & Date of Pre-bid meeting (both online and in person attendance permitted)	:	Date 09.10.2026 at 01:30 PM Meeting hall of Chief Engineer, Master Planning Investigation and Project Planning, Water Resources Department, Jal Sansadhan Bhawan, Anisabad, Patna–800002, Bihar.
4.	Last date and time for receipt of bids on eproc2.	:	Date 14.10.2026 at 3:00 PM
5.	Time and Date of opening of technical bids	:	Date 14.10.2026 at 4:00 PM, through website: **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
6.	Time and Date of financial bids	:	To be Communicated later on
7.	Bid Submission	:	Through website: **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
8.	Period of bids validity	:	120 days
9.	Officer inviting bids	:	Executive Engineer, Master planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division-1, Anishabad, Patna-800002
10.	For participating in the e-tendering process, the bidder shall have to get them selves registered to obtain a User ID, Password and Digital Signature. This will enable them to access the website **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** and download/participate in the e-tender.		
11.	All tender-related queries shall be communicated at Email id- eeapippd1@gmail.com.		
12.	I. Bid processing fees/ Bid document cost to be paid through online mode i.e. Internet payment gateway (Credit/Debit Card) Net Banking, NEFT/RTGS. II. Bids along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-procurement portal **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** before the date & time specified in the NIT. The department does not take any responsibility for the delay/non availability of internet connection. Network Traffic/Holidays or any other reasons.		

For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 012554 (W R D) 2026-27
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

(Sheo Bachan Kumar),
Executive Engineer.

KARNATAKA STATE ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION

Central Offices, Stores and Purchase Dept, K.H. Road, Shanthinagar,
Bengaluru - 560 027. Tele No. 080-22221321 Ext: 224 Fax No: 080-22223424

NOTICE INVITING TENDER NO. 11 Dated: 28.09.2026

Tenders (Pre-qualification and / or commercial offers) through e-procurement portal (http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in) are invited for supply of the following Goods/Services.

Tender Nos as per e-Portal	Nomenclature of Items/ Services/Equipment	Tender value in Crores (Approx.)	Last date for submission of tender @17.00 hrs.
KSRTC/2026-27/ SE4119	Selection of system Integrator(Si) for the implementation of smart ticketing system for STUs of Karnataka.	370.00	29.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/ SE4123	Selection of third party Audit agency for managing the transactions & providing web based application with end to end online process for KSRTC Health Scheme.	0.50	15.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/ IND0347	Procurement of Radiator Assemblies & Cores.	5.25	29.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/ IND0348	Procurement of Industrial Gases (Dissolved Acetylene, CO2, 02 & Commercial Argon)	1.00	29.10.2026

NOTE:- Interested suppliers need to register in the e-procurement portal. For further information log into **http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**. In case of further assistance, contact e-procurement cell (**Phone. No. 080-46010000/080-68948777**). Interested bidders may also contact e-procurement cell for training on bid submission. Mail to **Support@eprochelpdesk.com** for further information if required. In case of bidders need assistance from KSRTC, can communicate at **cosp@ksrtc.org,** (contact: 7760990224)

Sd/-
CONTROLLER OF STORES & PURCHASES
(Tender Inviting Authority)

DIPR/CP/2978/MAA/2026-27

STUDENTS PLANT PALM SEEDS

Blessings Matric. Hr. Sec. School and International Sr. Sec. School saw 60 teachers and 1,025 students plant 10,000 palm seeds on the bundhs of lakes around nearby villages. Mr. V. Vijayaraj, MLA, Tiruporur Constituency, attended the event, along with Chairman Mr. E. Thomas Jeyapaul, Vice Chairman Dr. Rajan Thomas, Correspondent Ms. Emimah Thomas, Principal (Mat.) T. Sofia Rachel Mary and Principal (CBSE) Ms. T. Kiruba Princess.

FREEDOM 250 PROGRAMME

Christwood School collaborated with the U.S. Consulate General, Chennai, to host a 'U.S. at Your School' programme marking the 250th anniversary of the United States. U.S. Consulate personnel engaged students through presentations on American history and values. Students took part in a Freedom 250-themed Poster Competition and an interactive U.S. Quiz Competition. The programme concluded with prize distribution to winners, celebrating enduring people-to-people ties between India and the United States. Dr. S. Vijayakumar, Principal, said their school is known for excellence in academics, sports, music and other activities, with their 'Career Quest' programme helping students build strong CVs through STEM, Nature Ecology, Volunteerism, Quantathlon and Battle of Words.

'FIT FEST' SPORTS CARNIVAL HELD

TRS Global Public School, CBSE, Arakkonam organised the Young Stars Sports Carnival – FIT FEST 2026 for students from Pre-KG to Class V, aimed at promoting physical fitness, discipline, sportsmanship and team spirit. Mrs. V. Preethi, Mrs. V. Vaishnavi and Mrs. V. Niranjani, Police Constables from the Avadi Police Commissionerate and Greater Chennai City Police, graced the event as Chief Guests. Students presented a drill display, pyramid performance and karate demonstration. Ln. MJF Dr. T. R. Subramaniam, Chairman, Sri Krishna Group of Educational Institutions, presided over the event, with Correspondent T. S. Ravikumar and Principal Mrs. K. Kavitha present.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Subramaniam P: Handphone:+91 98408 98088 | Email: subramaniam.p@thehindu.co.in

The Rhythm of Life

World Heart Day 2026

Arthrobotics - Robotic Joint Replacement
Reclaim your natural Knee & Hip movement

Dr.DEEPAK KUMAR K.S
Certified Mako Stryker Specialist

Chief Consultant - Orthopedic Surgeon MBBS, MS (Orthopedics), MCH (Ortho)
23 years experience.

Dr. Deepak Kumar & his team have completed over 200 robotic surgeries in the first year.

Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals

FOR DETAILS, CALL OUR ARTHROBOTICS COUNSELLOR
8939 000 900

#1, Radial Road, Pallikaranai, Chennai - 600100, Tamil Nadu, India. 91 44 71 200 200 +91 99627 25555 | www.drkmh.com

From daily movement to mindful eating, small choices can help make heart health part of everyday life.

Haarshini Agarwal

It can begin with something as ordinary as a walk to the office or a flight of stairs. Perhaps there is a moment when the heartbeat feels a little different, or the body asks for a pause. This is where the message of World Heart Day 2026, Don't Miss a Beat, comes in. The campaign by the World Heart Federation is centered on recognizing the signs of cardiovascular disease, protecting heart health and cardiovascular wellbeing.

The idea is to make awareness part of everyday life. Cardiovascular health is increasingly understood as something that can be

supported through a combination of small, consistent choices - Regular physical activity, nutritious food and attention to factors such as blood pressure, blood sugar and cholesterol. For cardiologists, this shift towards prevention is particularly meaningful because heart health begins much earlier, through routine health checks, everyday movement, food choices and an understanding of personal risk factors.

The 2026 World Heart Day campaign encourages choosing to move more, a heart-friendly plate and knowing one's Blood pressure, cholesterol and blood sugar. Heart health is not limited to a particular age group or fitness level. The World Heart Federation's 2026 campaign specifically highlights how cardiovascular disease can affect people across ages and circumstances, including congenital heart conditions in young people and symptoms that may be overlooked in women. Technology is adding another layer to this awareness. Smartwatches and fitness trackers have made people more conscious of activity, sleep and heart rate patterns. While these devices are not substituted for clinical evaluation, they can encourage people to pay closer attention to their wellbeing and become more engaged with their health.

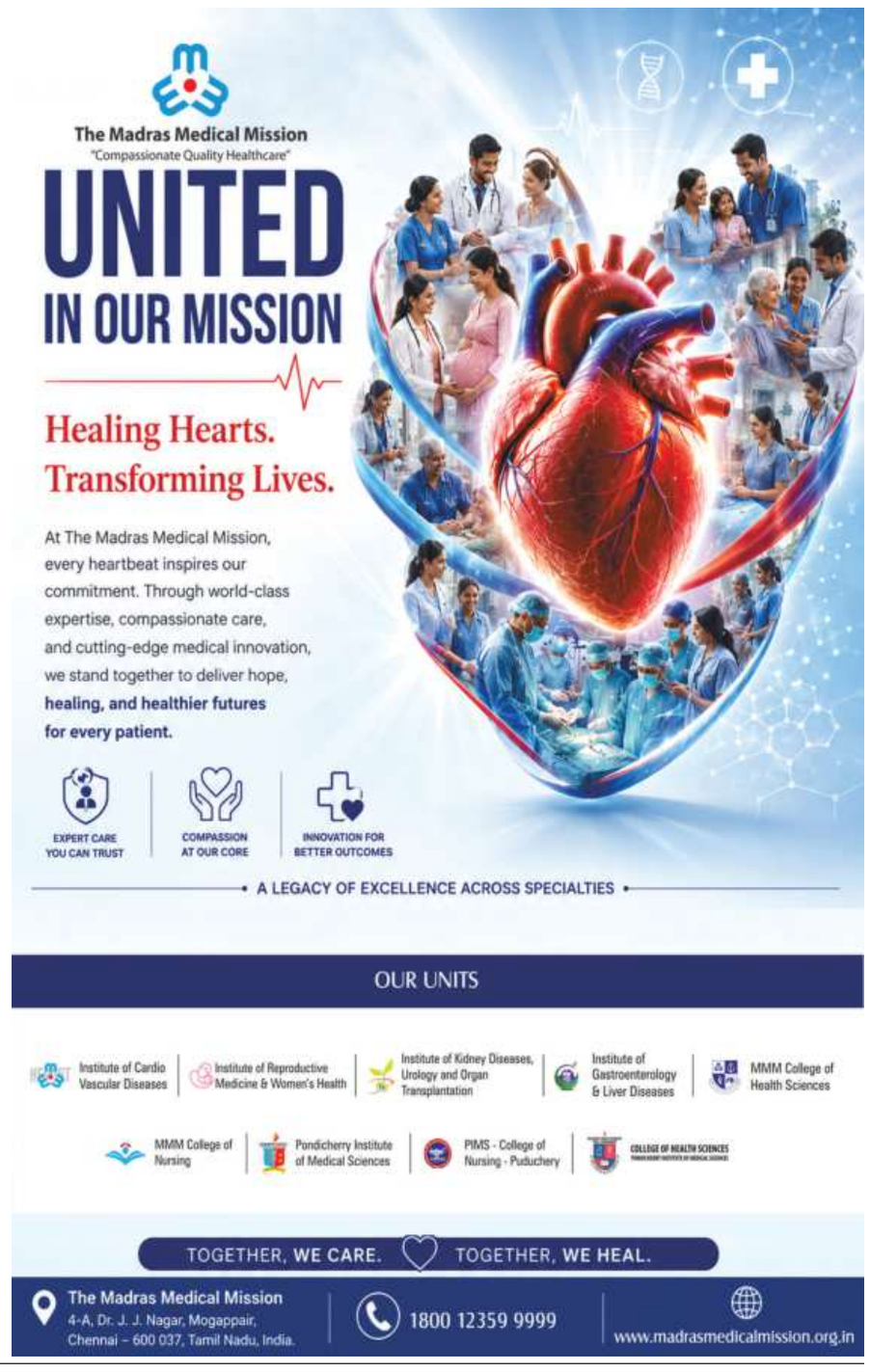
Perhaps this is what makes Don't Miss a Beat particularly relevant this year. It is not simply about the heart as an organ. It is about noticing the rhythm of everyday life and making space for health within it. The heart does its part every day. World Heart Day is an invitation to do ours.

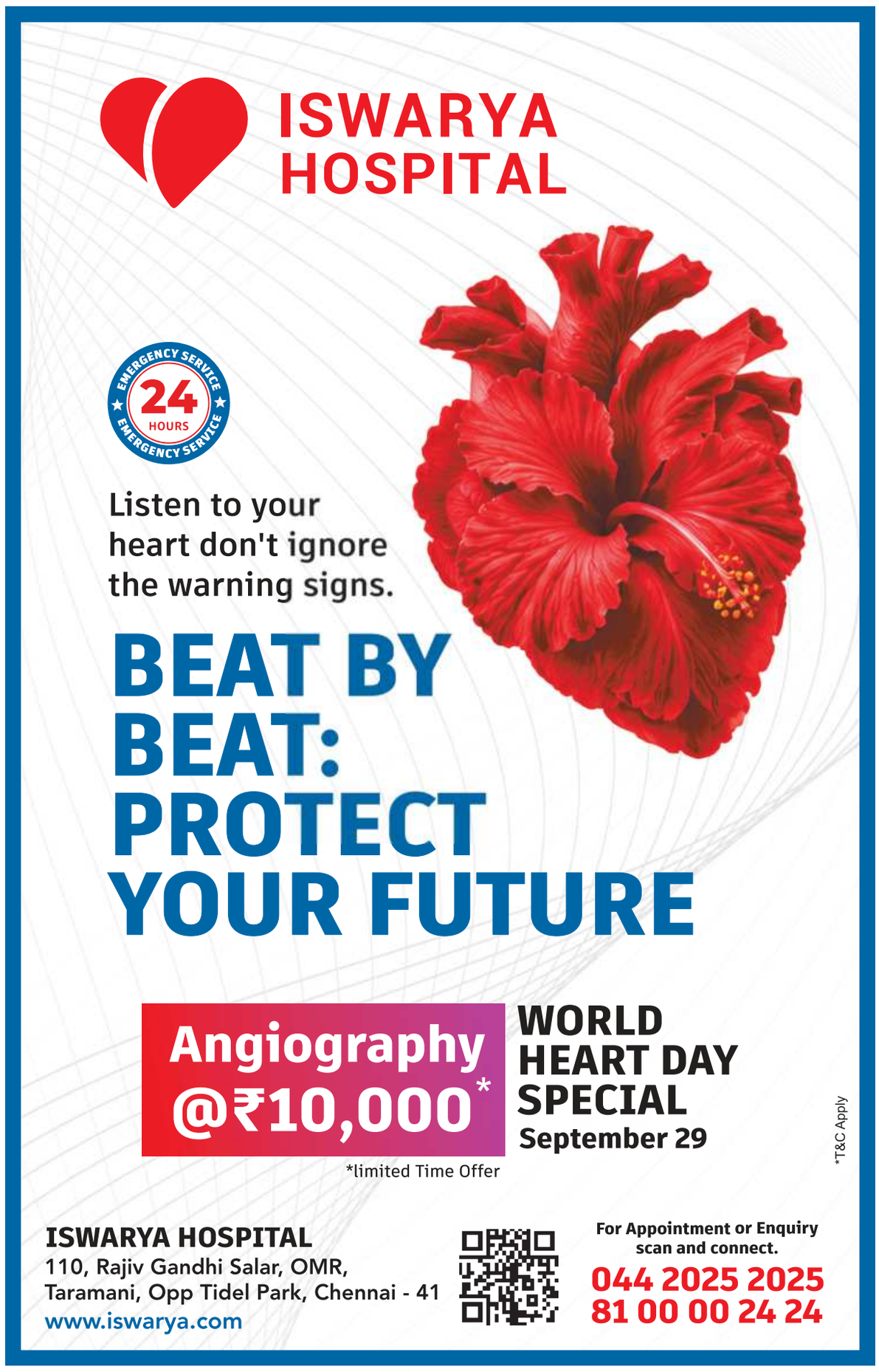
Every Minute Counts in a Heart Attack

Acute myocardial infarction or heart attack is one of the most deadly conditions, if not treated appropriately in time. Delays can happen at the patients enc and it is important for people to recognize symptoms of heart attack which at times can be atypical especially in diabetic patients. Over my tenure, I have noticed inappropriate delays in the treatment of heart attack patients, due to either patient passing it off as gastric pain and delaying simple investigations like ECG.

The golden hour after chest pain is the most crucial time as appropriate treatment with either clot busting drugs or angioplasty can save lives and improve heart function. As a society, if heart disease has to be treated doctors, governments and hospitals will need to reach out to the public, create awareness and take steps in basic prevention like stopping smoking, alcohol consumption, daily exercise and avoiding sugar, salt and oily food.

Dr. Mullasari Ajit S
Chairman & HOD,
Division of Cardiology
Madras Medical Mission





From Page One

Yet another POCSO case filed against Veeramani

Investigators are also probing a complaint from a woman that her daughter, who was abused by Veeramani, had ended her life. The incident occurred many years ago. The complainant said that though she had lodged a complaint with the local police then, no action was taken, the sources said.

The police said those willing to file complaints relating to the above cases or share any information could call or send details on WhatsApp to 9345319676. The identity of the sender would be kept confidential.

In a related development, DMK treasurer T.R. Baalu on Monday submitted a petition to the Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the case, urging it to summon Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and his Cabinet colleagues Aadhav Arjuna and C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar and seek the evidence supporting their allegations against the DMK in the case.

In his petition, Mr. Baalu recalled Mr. Arjuna's allegation that the DMK had protected Mr. Veeramani and closed the case against him. "Mr. Nirmal Kumar alleged that the DMK received ₹500 crore from the industrialist. The allegations are false and have been made to defame DMK leaders. If the two Ministers possess evidence in this case, why have they not handed it over to the officials probing the case," he asked.

Mr. Baalu said details from the case diary had been made available unofficially and were being circulated outside. "The allegations made by the Chief Minister and his Cabinet colleagues are directly connected with the case. The SIT should obtain the details and evidence from them," he added.

(*Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104, Tele-MANAS 14416, and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050*)

Chief Minister launches *Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam* in Madurai

At the launch event, Vijay distributes one-gram gold rings to 37 newborns, including three who were born to mothers from three different religions. The scheme is being implemented with retrospective effect to cover babies born in government hospitals from June 22, 2026, the CM's birthday

C. Palanivel Rajan
MADURAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday launched the *Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam* at the Government Rajaji Hospital in Madurai, marking a Statewide rollout of one of his Assembly poll promises.

Under the State-sponsored scheme, a one gram gold ring will be gifted to every baby born in government hospitals and primary health centres across Tamil Nadu. The scheme is being implemented with retrospective effect to cover babies born in government hospitals from June 22, 2026 (Mr. Vijay's birthday) onwards.

On day one, Mr. Vijay personally presented gold rings to 37 newborns, moving through the main auditorium and the Comprehensive Emergency Obstetric and Newborn Care (CEmONC) ward at the hospital.

Keeping a promise: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay presenting a gold ring to a newborn at the launch of the scheme at the Government Rajaji Hospital in Madurai on Monday. X/@CMOTAMILNADU

At the launch event, mothers belonging to three different religions were seated on the stage with their children. Mr. Vijay first adorned these three children – Yazhini, a baby girl born to the couple Muthu and Muniyandi; Mohammed Sainsha, a baby boy born to the couple Sikandar and Ramila Banu; and a baby girl named Joman born to the couple Bose and Stella Mary – with gold rings.

Health Minister K.G. Arunraj, participating at the event, said: "A maternal uncle (*Thaimaaman* in Tamil) is among the first to arrive when a new life begins, sharing fully in his sister's joy and promising lifelong love, support, and security. By launching the *Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam*, the Chief Minister embodies this sacred cultural bond, gifting a one-gram gold ring to every new born in government hospitals. When considering where to launch this initiative, the Chief Minister chose Madurai – a sacred soil blessed by the grace of Goddess Meenakshi," he said.

He said Tamil Nadu strengthened maternal and child health through robust medical infrastructure, skilled personnel, and priority schemes such as financial assistance, emergency obstetric care, nutritional support, free deliveries, and newborn care. "Approximately 7.80 lakh children are born annually in Tamil Nadu, with about 4.20 lakh deliveries (53%) taking place in government hospitals. Further, according to the National Family Health Survey-6 data, 99.9 % of deliveries in Tamil Nadu take place in medical institutions," Dr. Arunraj added.

Of these, 90% of deliveries occur in Comprehensive Emergency Obstetric and Newborn Care Centres established exclusively across 130 government hospitals, he said.

"With the objective of further strengthening public trust in the services of the Department of Health and Family Welfare, in accordance with the Vision Plan, the Tamil Nadu government has announced the *Thaimaaman Thangam Mothiram Thittam* as a special welfare scheme to honour children born in Government Hospitals," he said. The Government Order for this was issued on June 23, 2026, and ₹755.83 crore has been allocated to implement the scheme this year.

Museum inaugurated

The Chief Minister later in the day inaugurated the newly renovated Gandhi Memorial Museum, and in the evening, he visited the Sri Meenakshi Sundareswarar Temple to offer prayers.

How can EC render case against bypolls infructuous: CM's counsel

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Senior counsel G. Masilamani, representing Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, on Monday argued that the Election Commission of India (EC) cannot make a case pending before the Madras High Court infructuous by deciding not to conduct byelections to five vacant Assembly constituencies in Tamil Nadu until the disposal of the election petitions connected to them.

Commencing final arguments before the first Division Bench, comprising Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, the senior counsel said the EC had failed to clarify whether it had taken the decision *suo motu* or on a representation made by K. Venkatachalapathy of Tirunelveli, who had filed a public interest litigation (PIL) petition against the conduct of bypolls to the five constituencies. The PIL plea had sought to restrain the EC from conducting bypolls in the Tiruchi East, Perundurai, Ambasamudram, Viralimalai, and Karur constituencies since election petitions had been filed with respect to them.

EC's counter-affidavit

However, in its counter-affidavit, the EC told the court that the Commission itself does not intend to notify byelections to those five constituencies until the disposal of the election petitions. Highlighting the EC's submission before the court, the PIL petitioner's counsel, V.R. Shanmuganathan, said the other respondents (including the Chief Minister, who had won from two constituencies but vacated the Tiruchi East seat after retaining Perambur) in his case could not object to the EC's decision in a PIL filed by his client, and they should file separate writ petitions challenging the Commission's decision. On the other hand, Mr. Masilamani argued that the court was entitled to mould the relief in a PIL petition filed under Article 226 (writ jurisdiction of High Courts) of the Constitution. He said that the powers of the High Court were very wide under its writ jurisdiction.

Mr. Masilamani also told the court that the people of those five constituencies could not remain unrepresented in the Legislative Assembly for long. Since his arguments remained unconcluded and senior counsel Dama Seshadri Naidu for the ECI and senior counsel Gopal Sankaranarayanan for resigned MLA M.R. Vijayabhaskar of Karur were also yet to argue, the judges decided to continue the hearing on Tuesday.

High Court rejects election petition filed against victory of Tirupattur TVK MLA by a single vote

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Monday rejected an election petition filed against the victory of Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) MLA R. Seenivasa Sethupathy from the Tirupattur constituency in Sivaganga district by a razor-thin margin of just one vote in the 2026 Assembly elections.

Justice G.K. Ilanthiraiyan allowed an application filed by the TVK MLA to reject the election petition filed by Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) candidate and former Minister K.R. Periakaruppan, who had contended that he lost the polls primarily because of the existence of two Legislative Assembly constituencies with the same name 'Tirupattur' in Tamil Nadu.

The judge said one of the main grounds raised by the election petitioner was that one postal vote meant for him in Tiruppatur constituency (number 185) in Sivaganga district was wrongly sent to Tirupattur constituency (number 50) in Tirupattur district. The petitioner had filed an affidavit sworn by Tirupattur district DMK candidate A. Nallathambi's counting agent S. Rajendran, who claimed to have come across that one postal vote.

R. Seenivasa Sethupathy

K.R. Periakaruppan

However, "the allegation regarding the alleged wrong receipt of one postal ballot rests substantially upon the affidavit of the election agent and, in the absence of any supporting material, the manner in which such alleged irregularity occurred and its actual effect upon the result of the election remains unsubstantiated," the judge wrote.

He agreed with senior counsel V. Raghavachari, assisted by Dixita Gohil and Pranjal Agarwal, that the constituency number and not the name of the constituency was the key identifier used by election officials to transport postal votes to their intended destination. The judge said every postal ballot would be accompanied by Form 13C, which contained full particulars of the concerned constituency, including the constituency number, name, district, and complete address.

The judge allows an application filed by the MLA to reject the election petition preferred by former DMK Minister K.R. Periakaruppan

Further, the postal ballots get deposited at facilitation centres contemplated under Rule 18A of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, and thereafter, the election officials take the responsibility of transporting them.

"The allegation that the identical names of the two Assembly Constituencies resulted in confusion and, consequently, caused a postal ballot to be wrongly sent to another constituency also appears difficult to reconcile with the procedural safeguards governing the handling of postal ballots," the judge held.

Also, rejecting the other grounds raised by the election petitioner, the judge wrote: "Equally, there is no material to demonstrate any violation of the prescribed procedure which, even if established, could have materially affected the result of the election. In the absence of any foundational material establishing that exactly one postal ballot was received in the wrong constituency and that such alleged irregularity had any material effect upon the election result, the said allegation, by itself, cannot constitute a complete cause of action."

He accepted the TVK MLA's plea to reject the election petition at the threshold without taking it to the stage of trial.

Only Governor can sanction probe against me, not government, ex-Minister tells court

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Former Tamil Nadu School Education Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi has contended before the Madras High Court that a First Information Report (FIR) registered against him by the Chennai Central Crime Branch (CCB) police, in the over ₹100 crore fraud case, was not sustainable since the sanction had been obtained from the State government and not the Governor.

In his FIR quash plea, the former Minister contended only the Governor was the competent authority to grant sanction under Section 17A of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, before the police could commence investigation into any alleged offence by a public servant in discharge of official functions or duties.

Justice V. Lakshminarayanan on Monday allowed an application filed by the Minister to dispense with the production of the original copy of the FIR registered against him so that the Registry could number the main case, which sought to quash the FIR on multiple grounds, including the ground of sanction.

Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi

In the petition filed through his counsel Richardson Wilson, Mr. Poyyamozhi said the sanction, which had been granted by the Public department by way of a government letter on June 23, 2026, should be considered as non est in law and incapable of sustaining the FIR as well as the subsequent investigation.

Even otherwise, the FIR does not disclose any specific act of dishonest or fraudulent conduct attributable to the petitioner personally besides being vague and also vitiated by inordinate, unexplained delay of over four years from the date of the original complaint, he argued.

'Regime revenge'

"The haste in registering the FIR post regime change in the State of Tamil Nadu and a reading of the FIR would show that petitioner is being subjected to this biased investigation as a part of regime revenge, which ought not to be countenanced by this court," the former Minister's petition read.

He also brought it to the notice of the High Court that the CCB had included the provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, by filing an FIR alteration report before a metropolitan magistrate's court at Egmore on September 9, 2026.

The alteration report claimed that material collected during the course of investigation disclosed the role of the present petitioner in relation to certain demands.

However, the petitioner contended the alteration report does not state that any kind of illegal gratification was paid to him by any of the private school managements in the State for the purpose of upgrading their schools or obtaining permanent recognition and so on.

"The alteration report does not speak about any overt act done by this petitioner, or any illegal gratification received by the petitioner. Thus, the sum and substance of the witness statements seem to be that some persons have allegedly collected money using this petitioner's name," he added.

HC quashes Arasakumar's detention under Goondas Act in private schools fraud case

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Monday quashed an order passed by the Greater Chennai Commissioner of Police on July 11, 2026, detaining an unregistered private schools association president B.T. Arasakumar, 59, under the Goondas Act on a complaint that he had illegally collected over ₹100 crore from various private schools.

Justices N. Sathish Kumar and K. Rajasekar set aside the preventive detention order on the ground that there was a delay in considering a representation made by the detainee on July 23 for revoking the detention order. The judges agreed with senior counsel P. Wilson that such representations must be considered without delay when an individual's personal liberty had been curtailed.

The judges allowed a *habeas corpus* petition filed by the detainee's wife. She had challenged the detention order also on the ground that no threat had been caused to public order, because of any of the alleged acts committed by her husband, necessitating the invocation of the Tamil Nadu Prevention of Dangerous Activities of Bootleggers, Drug Offenders, Goondas, Immoral Traffic Offenders and Slum-Grabbers Act, 1982.

B.T. Arasakumar

On June 23, C. Elangovan, secretary of the Tamil Nadu Private Schools Federation, had lodged a complaint with the Commissioner of Police levelling serious charges against Arasakumar who was accused of having collected large sums of money by running an unregistered association named 'Tamil Nadu Private Schools Association'.

According to the complainant, the detainee had collected money from private schools by promising services such as obtaining approval for upgrading schools, gaining permanent recognition, securing building plan approval and so on "using his proximity" with the then ruling dispensation.

He was also accused of having threatened the private schools of dire consequences if they revealed the transactions in public. Hence, the police registered a First Information Report, arrested and subjected him to custodial interrogation, and then invoked the Goondas Act, too.

Assailing the preventive detention order passed by the Commissioner of Police on July 11, the petitioner said her husband had been making efforts for long to get the 'Tamil Nadu Private Schools Association' registered, but it could not be done owing to the existence of another association with the same name.

She claimed that the complaint was the result of a civil dispute between the office-bearers of different associations representing private schools in the State, and it would have no bearing on maintenance of public order which alone could be a reason to invoke the Goondas Act.

"The detenu is aged about 59 years, and has been continuously cooperating with the investigation. He is suffering from severe neck and knee pain, diabetes, and hypertension, and has remained in custody for a considerable period," the petitioner said.

INBRIEF

Two arrested after bike enters convoy of V-P in Keralam

Two people have been arrested after a motorcycle allegedly entered the convoy of Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan near Kovalam during his visit to Thiruvananthapuram, Keralam, on Sunday. The Kanjiramkulam police identified the accused as Ashkar and Nadirsha, both of whom hail from Vallakkadavu. The two were allegedly under the influence of alcohol at the time of the incident. An investigation into the incident is under way. The police are examining the circumstances that led to the security lapse.

Elephant kills 60-year-old on morning walk in Bengaluru

A 60-year-old man, who was on his morning walk with his daughter, was killed in an elephant attack near Mysuru Road in Bengaluru. The victim was identified as Nagaraju. N.R. Kamble, Range Forest Officer, Kaggalipura Range, said that the elephant reached the spot from the Bannerghatta Wildlife Sanctuary. "Our team is tracking the elephant," he said. Deputy Conservator of Forests Y. Chakrapani said that steps would be taken to ensure that elephants do not stray beyond the Bannerghatta division.

Four women labourers killed in accident in Telangana

Four women labourers were killed and three others were injured after a lorry collided head-on with the autorickshaw in which they were travelling in Mancherial district of Telangana on Monday. Minister G. Vivek Venkataswamy, expressed grief over the deaths and announced a financial aid of ₹25,000 each to the families of the deceased and ₹10,000 each to the injured.

Rain damages roads, crops in A.P.; 71,700 farmers affected

Flood alerts issued for hundreds of villages in the State; in Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema district, people in island villages advised to vacate and avoid crossing the Godavari by traditional boats

Hareesh P.
VISAKHAPATNAM

Amid heavy rain induced by the deep depression over the Bay of Bengal, the Godavari Delta and Godavari Valley in Andhra Pradesh are bracing for floods for the second time in six days.

On Monday, the Sir Arthur Cotton Barrage at Dowleswaram in Rajamahendravaram continued to receive more than 9.7 lakh cusecs of water.

According to initial estimates, the rain damaged horticultural crops in over 1,734 hectares and agricultural crops in around 44,029 hectares.

State Agriculture Minister K. Atchannaidu said horticultural crops were affected in 89 mandals and 351 villages across 14 districts in Andhra Pradesh.

Severe damage: The paddy crop submerged in floodwater at a village in Srikakulam district of Andhra Pradesh on Monday. V. RAJU

According to preliminary estimates prepared by the Agriculture Department, crops in 1,229 villages across 190 mandals were damaged, affecting an estimated 71,796 farmers.

Roads and Buildings Minister B.C. Janardhan Reddy said an estimated 2,405 km of roads were damaged across the State, with the preliminary restoration cost being put at ₹1,498.30 crore. The greatest extent of damage was reported in Srikakulam district, where 412 km of roads were affected, he said.

In Polavaram district, which is nestled between the Sabari and the Godavari, flood alerts have been issued for 171 villages. "As many as 55 motorboats and eight launches are kept ready at Kunavaram and V.R. Puram for relief operations. By Monday, 17 habitations have been submerged," said Integrated Tribal Development Agency Project Officer Subham Nokwal.

In Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema district, people in island villages have been advised to vacate and avoid crossing the Godavari by traditional boats.

In North Andhra, floodwaters are slowly receding in several villages of Srikakulam district. However, crops in Santabommali, Polaki, Meliaputti, Jalumuru and Burja villages were inundated by floodwaters from Vamsadhara, Nagavali, Bahuda and other rivers. The total loss was expected to be around ₹150 crore. At Allina in Burja mandal, paddy fields in 1,100 acres have been damaged.

Police told to tighten Keralam CM's security

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Intelligence wing of Kerala police has directed District Police Chiefs to strengthen security arrangements for Keralam Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan at public functions and travels.

It cited concerns over uncontrolled crowds, including presspersons, who approach Mr. Satheesan and come into physical contact with him.

V.D. Satheesan

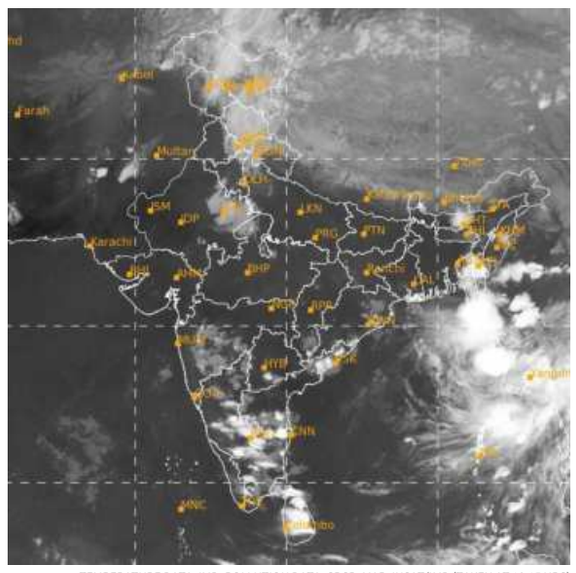
In a confidential alert issued on Saturday, the Additional Director-General of Police (Intelligence) cautioned that such situations could result in serious security lapses, considering that the Chief Minister belongs to the highest security category in the State.

Besides uniformed personnel, police officers in plainclothes must be deployed to prevent untoward incidents and ensure his complete security, the order stated. The instructions come against the backdrop of recent instances in which presspersons were allegedly prevented from approaching the Chief Minister at public engagements.

Senior officials of the Kochi City police reportedly prevented presspersons from posing questions to Mr. Satheesan when he arrived to participate in a function on September 26.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal and Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, Konkan & Goa, Keralam and Mahe

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	34.7	26.2	Kurnool	—	37.6	25.3
Ahmedabad	—	33.6	25.1	Lucknow	2.5	32.0	21.4
Aizawl	—	32.3	21.0	Madurai	—	38.1	26.1
Bengaluru	—	31.8	22.1	Mangaluru	—	32.8	23.4
Bhopal	—	32.6	22.5	Mumbai	—	32.4	25.7
Bhubaneswar	—	34.0	25.0	Mysuru	—	33.0	18.0
Chandigarh	—	25.4	22.1	New Delhi	—	28.7	23.0
Chennai	—	37.5	25.8	Patna	—	31.7	25.9
Coimbatore	—	35.0	22.6	Port Blair	—	31.2	26.3
Dehradun	1	27.3	14.9	Prayagraj	—	33.4	24.0
Gangtok	—	26.3	16.5	Puducherry	—	35.4	27.8
Goa	—	32.2	24.8	Pune	—	34.0	22.5
Guwahati	—	34.7	29.1	Raipur	—	32.6	24.1
Hubballi	—	31.0	20.0	Ranchi	—	29.2	20.0
Hyderabad	—	34.0	22.3	Shillong	—	27.0	18.0
Imphal	—	33.3	21.1	Shimla	6	16.8	8.8
Jaipur	—	33.6	23.8	Srinagar	—	21.5	9.8
Kochi	—	31.7	26.0	Thiruvananthapuram	—	33.8	25.1
Kohima	—	24.8	19.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	37.1	27.4
Kolkata	—	33.8	25.6	Vijayawada	—	35.2	23.8
Kozhikode	—	35.2	25.8	Visakhapatnam	—	33.7	26.5

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.47	..17	..5	 63	...121	.....
Bengaluru	.26	..54	42	 79	...136	.....
Chennai	.16	..10	24	... 111	...119	.....
Delhi	.10	..34	72	 52	46	.....
Hyderabad	.16	..13	28	 49	71	.....
Kolkata	.12	..19	19	... 133	...125	.....
Lucknow	.32	..14	39	 21	26	.....
Mumbai	...4	..14	17	 42	...106	.....
Pune	.11	..42	61	 39	76	.....
Visakhapatnam	...7	..43	12	 91	...127	.....

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Gummidipoondi, Tamil Nadu recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 174 indicating a moderate level of pollution. In contrast, Gangtok, Sikkim recorded a healthy AQI score of 19

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

AMARAVATI GROWTH and INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGICL)
2nd FLOOR, APCRDA PROJECT OFFICE, RAYAPUDI, THULLURU MANDAL, GUNTUR DISTRICT (A.P.)

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

NIT.No. 20/MD/CE-2/AGICL/2026 Date 28-09-2026

Bids are invited for the work "Construction of Neighbourhood Retail Centre at Amaravati Government complex (AGC), Lingayapalem Village, Amaravati through EPC (Design & Build) mode". The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **30-September-2026 15:00 Hrs** For further details, please refer to www.apeprocurement.gov.in and www.agicl.org.

Sd/- Managing Director, AGICL, Amaravati

Govt. of Bihar

Office of the Executive Enginner
Master Planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division-1,
Room No.-503, 5th Floor, Block A, Jal Sansadhan Bhawan, Anisabad, Patna-800002,
Water Resources Department, Government of Bihar
Email Id:-eeapippd1@gmail.com

Short Notice Invitation
Request for Proposal
for

Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Ganga River Corridor in Bihar.

Tender/RFP No.:11/यो०/Ganga-RFP-

1. Executive Engineer, Master planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division -1, WRD, Government of Bihar (Authority) invites this RFP proposals from eligible and experienced agencies for Selection of Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Ganga River Corridor in Bihar.

Particulars	Bid processing Fees inclusive of GST (Non-refundable)	Bid Document Cost (Non-refundable)	Bid Security (EMD)
Selection for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Ganga River Corridor in Bihar.	Rs. 1180/- (As applicable as per e-PROC Bid Processing Fee Structure)	INR 10,000/- (INR Ten Thousand only)	INR 2,00,000/- (INR Two Lakh only)

2.	Date of downloading of bid document	:	From 01.10.2026 to 14.10.2026 up to 03:00 PM
3.	Place & Date of Pre-bid meeting (both online and in person attendance permitted)	:	Date 09.10.2026 at 12:30 PM Meeting hall of Chief Engineer, Master Planning Investigation and Project Planning, Water Resources Department, Jal Sansadhan Bhawan, Anisabad, Patna– 800002, Bihar.
4.	Last date and time for receipt of bids on eproc2.	:	Date 14.10.2026 at 3:00 PM
5.	Time and Date of opening of technical bids	:	Date 14.10.2026 at 3:30 PM, through website: **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
6.	Time and Date of financial bids	:	To be Communicated later on
7.	Bid Submission	:	Through website: **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
8.	Period of bids validity	:	120 days
9.	Officer inviting bids	:	Executive Engineer, Master planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division-1, Anishabad, Patna-800002
10.	For participating in the e-tendering process, the bidder shall have to get them selves registered to obtain a User ID, Password and Digital Signature. This will enable them to access the website **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** and download/participate in the e-tender.		
11.	All tender-related queries shall be communicated at Email id- eeapippd1@gmail.com.		

For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 012555 (W R D) 2026-27 **(Sheo Bachan Kumar), Executive Engineer.**

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

समाहरणालय, सहरसा
(जिला योजना कार्यालय)
ई–मेल–dpo.saharsa-bih@nic.in, दूरभाष – 06478–222466

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

मुख्यमंत्री क्षेत्र विकास योजना के अन्तर्गत वित्तीय वर्ष 2026–27 से माननीय, विधायक, डॉ0 गौतम कृष्ण, महिषी विधानसभा द्वारा अपने क्षेत्रान्तर्गत प्रखंड महिषी, नवहट्टा एवं सत्तरकटैया के विभिन्न विद्यालयों/शैक्षणिक संस्थानों में आयरण बुक–सेल्फ के क्रय हेतु संबंधित ख्याती प्राप्त फर्मों/विक्रेताओं/प्रतिष्ठानों से मुहरबंद लिफाफा में अलग–अलग निविदा दिनांक **29.10.2026** को **01:00 बजे अपराह्न** तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। प्राप्त निविदा को उप विकास आयुक्त–सह– अध्यक्ष जिला क्रय समिति, सहरसा के समक्ष दिनांक **29.10.2026** को **04:00** बजे अपराह्न में खोला जायेगा, जिसमें निविदादाता स्वयं या उनके द्वारा प्राधिकृत प्रतिनिधि भाग ले सकते है। क्रय की जानेवाली सामग्रियों की विस्तृत सूची जिला योजना कार्यालय, सहरसा से किसी भी कार्यदिवस में प्राप्त कर सकते है, अथवा जिले के बेबसाईट www.saharsa.bih.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

माननीय विधायक से प्राप्त अनुशंसा के अनुरूप आपूर्ति की जानेवाली आयरण बुक–सेल्फ की विशिष्टियाँ निम्नवत है :–

IRON BOOK SHELF SIZE 66"×34"×14" THREE SHELVES FOUR COMPARTMENT FRONT SIDE GLASS FITTING WITH LOCK 22MM CHADER (Annexure-1 Specifications of Book Shelf).

निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR- 012636 (Planning) 2026-27 उप विकास आयुक्त, सहरसा

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

Govt. of Bihar

Mines and Geology Department
District- Rohtas
Notice Inviting E-Auction for Settlement of Stone Blocks
(Through MSTC over https://www.mstcecommerce.com)

बिहार खनिज (समानुदान, अवैध खनन, परिवहन एवं भंडारण निवारण) नियमावली, 2019 (समय–समय पर यथा संशोधित) में उल्लेखित प्रावधानों के तहत अनुमोदित जिला सर्वेक्षण प्रतिवेदन में सृजित पत्थर भूखण्डों की अगामी पाँच वर्षों के लिए बंदोबस्ती निम्न कार्यक्रमानुसार करायी जाएगी :–

1. ई–नीलामी कार्यक्रमः–

क्र0 स0	पत्थर भूखण्ड का नाम	ई–नीलामी से पूर्व प्री–बीड बैठक एवं प्रशिक्षण का समय एवं स्थान	निविदा दस्तावेज बिक्री शुल्क (10,000/–रू0) जमाकर निविदा दस्तावेज डाउनलोड प्रारंभ करने की तिथि	अग्रधन राशि ऑनलाईन जमा करने तथा निविदा दस्तावेज अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि	तकनीकी निविदा की जाँच एवं मूल्यांकन हेतु संबंधित समाहर्त्ता द्वारा डाउनलोड करने की तिथि	तकनीकी निविदा की जाँच/मूल्यांकन कर सफल निविदादाताओं की सूची सिस्टम में संबंधित समाहर्त्ता द्वारा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि	ई–नीलामी प्रारंभ होने की तिथि एवं समय	ई–नीलामी समाप्ति की तिथि एवं समय
01	गायघाट पत्थर ब्लॉक संख्या – 01	06.10.2026 समाहरणालय, सासाराम सभाकक्ष में समय 11:00 बजे पूर्वाह्न से 01:00 बजे अपराह्न तक	08.10.2026	19.11.2026	20.11.2026	27.11.2026	30.11.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से	30.11.2026 अपराह्न 01:00 बजे तक
02	गिजवाही पत्थर ब्लॉक संख्या – 02						30.11.2026 अपराह्न 03:00 बजे से	30.11.2026 अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक

2. पत्थर भूखण्डों की विस्तृत विवरणी अनुलग्नक–6 के रूप में संलग्न है। साथ ही पत्थर भूखण्डों की विवरणी एवं KML File जिला के वेबसाईट–https://rohtas.bih.nic.in एवं MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com पर भी उपलब्ध है।
3. पत्थर भूखण्डों की बंदोबस्ती ई–नीलामी प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com से करायी जाएगी।
4. ई–नीलामी द्वारा कराई जा रही बंदोबस्ती में भाग लेने वाले निविदादाता को MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com पर पंजीयन कराना अनिवार्य होगा।
5. एतद् संबंधी समस्त सूचना (यथा– नीलामी कार्यक्रम, सुरक्षित जमा राशि, अग्रधन राशि, नीलामी प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क इत्यादि) विस्तृत रूप से जिला के वेबसाईट https://rohtas.bih.nic.in विभागीय वेबसाईट https://state.bihar.gov.in/mines/ CitizenHome.html एवं MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com पर उपलब्ध है।
6. ई–नीलामी कार्यक्रम को रद्द/स्थगित/संशोधित करने का अधिकार समाहर्त्ता, रोहतास (सासाराम) के पास सुरक्षित होगा।
7. एतद् संबंधी समस्त सूचना हेतु MSTC, दारोगा राय पथ, पटना–800001 के दूरभाष संख्या/मोबाईल–8269000225/9899972556, Toll Free/ Help Desk Number.:–0612–2506169/7969066600/समाहर्त्ता द्वारा प्राधिकृत पदाधिकारी के मो0 सं0–8544510737, आई0टी0 मैनेजर, रोहतास (सासाराम) के मो0 सं0–9771459354 से सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

❖ विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** पर देखा जा सकता है।

समाहर्त्ता,
रोहतास (सासाराम)

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR. No.012672 (Mine) 2026-27

नशे से बनानी दूरी है, क्योंकि परिवार जरूरी है।

Government of Jharkhand Jharkhand Flying Institute
Department of Cabinet Secretariat & Vigilance (Civil Aviation Division) State Hangar,
Birsa Munda Airport Road,
Hinoo Ranchi-834002, E-mail-jfi.govtfly@gmail.com,Website-www.jharkhandaviation.in

RefNo:-A/c-GT/JFI/69/2025-846, /Ranchi,Dated.-25.09.2026

e-GLOBAL SHORT TENDER NOTICE

Jharkhand Flying Institute (JFI) invites online e-Bids under the Two-Bid System from Aircraft Manufacturers/Authorized Distributor of Manufacturers/Authorized Vendors for the purchase of brand-new Two-Seater/ Four-Seater Trainee Aircraft for its Flying Training Organization.

The Request for Proposal (RFP) containing detailed scheduled of events & terms and conditions is available on the Jharkhand Government e-Procurement Portal:-http:// www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Sd/-
(Capt. S. P. Sinha)
Managing Director,Jharkhand Flying Institute

PR 390620 Civil Aviation (26-27) D"

Bihar Medical Services & Infrastructure Corporation Limited
Govt. of Bihar
3rd floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura
Adjacent to State Health Society, Patna 800014,
Phone/Fax: +91612 2283287,+ 91612 2283288

(Notice Inviting E-Bids)
Tender for the Procurement, Rate Contract and Supply of Medical Equipment for different Govt. Health Institutions of Bihar.
Notice Inviting Tender No.-BMSICL/2026-27/ME-517

(Only through E- Tender on website:-https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

The Bihar Medical Services and Infrastructure Corporation Limited, Patna invites e-bids from interested parties for Procurement, Rate Contract and supply of Medical Equipment for different Government Health Institutions of Bihar as listed below:-

1	BIPAP Machine

Tender Schedule

Re-Tender Reference No.	BMSICL/2026-27/ME-517
Date of Pre- Bid Meeting	06th October 2026 at 15:00 Hrs in Conference hall of BMSICL, 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, IGIMS Campus, Sheikhpura, Patna (Bihar) **All Pre-bid queries to be submitted through e-mail on** bmsicltenderequipment@gmail.com **Upto 08th October 2026 till 17:00 Hrs.** **(Note:- No Pre-bid queries would be entertained after the above mentioned dead line)**
Last date and time of submission of online bids	29th October 2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.
Last date and time for submission of original documents of EMD.	30th October 2026 upto 14:00 Hrs.
Date, Time and Place of opening of Technical Bid	30th October 2026 (at 15:00 Hrs.) on the website of **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** the office of BMSICL
Date and time of opening of financial Bids	To be announced later on **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
Validity of Tender	180 Days
Cost of the tender document	Rs.11,800/- (Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees only) Non-refundable.
Tender Processing Fee	Rs 1180/- (on the website of **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**)

1. To participate in E -Tendering the tenderer will have to be registered with E -Tendering service provider. For this help desk – mjunction services limited RJ complex, 2 nd Floor, Canara Bank, Campus, khajpura, Ashiana Road, P.S–Shastri Nagar, Patna -800014, Toll Free No.- 18005726571, Email-ID: eproc2support@bihar.gov.in can be approached.
2. The cost of tender document is acceptable as only **Online mode (On the website: https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)** and it is non-refundable.
3. Any queries and questions regarding the tender should be addressed to MD BMSICL (either through letter or through e-mail:- md-bmsicl-bih@nic.inand/or bmsicl.equipment@gmail.com or contact no. 0612-2219634/35) up to 7 days before of closing of online bid registration. —
4. All communication, addendum/corrigendum related to this tender will be issued on the website of http://.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
Managing Director, BMSICL reserves the right to reject any or all the applications without

GM (Procurement)
BMSICL, Patna

PR- 012687 (B & C) 2026-27
For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

Light on truth

No government intent on working for the people should fear transparency

Protests by political parties and transparency activists have derailed the surreptitious rollout, in Tamil Nadu, of a regressive decision to exempt the Public (Law and Order) Department from the purview of the Right to Information Act, 2005. On September 21, the State government issued a Government Order (G.O.) exercising powers under Section 24 (4) of the RTI Act to notify the department as an "intelligence and security organisation" to which the provisions of the Act shall not apply. While the G.O. surfaced in the public domain only on September 27, strikingly, the Public Department's designated authorities under the RTI Act had instantly begun citing it to deny information to applicants as early as September 22. This betrayed a system that is shy of investing in transparency. Unsurprisingly, State Law Minister C.T.R. Nirmalkumar was initially defensive about the government's unilateral decision, which, in any case, required the State to have it placed before the legislature (Section 24 (5), RTI Act). He claimed that the ambit of the exemption was not sweeping enough to shield the entire department, but was intended to prevent the sharing of sensitive information relating to district-level inquiries into incidents of communal clashes and the like. However, shortly thereafter, he announced the G.O.'s withdrawal, without explaining why.

While the State's afterthought is welcome, the episode has again exposed the political class's penchant for maintaining secrecy in administrative affairs. Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, whose promise of change came as a breath of fresh air, should have known better. It is concerning that the establishment desired to insulate itself from transparency by amending an Act which, in any case, emphatically enables non-disclosure of information through a long list of exemptions under Section 8. Even otherwise, designated information officers of central/State institutions have displayed an uncanny skill in being economical with the truth, delaying responses or bouncing off queries from RTI Act applicants, citing vague reasons. Besides, concerns about the Digital Personal Data Protection Act diluting the RTI Act further have been widely articulated. It is worrying that the Satrak Nagrik Sangathan's 2024-25 report card on Information Commissions found a backlog of over 41,000 appeals and complaints before the Tamil Nadu State Information Commission (TNSIC), as of June last year. Yet, the TNSIC is functioning with only half of its sanctioned eight Information Commissioners and has no Chief Information Commissioner. Instead of seeking to defeat the intent of a piece of legislation enacted to empower citizens with access to information, the Tamil Nadu government would do well to strengthen the TNSIC. After all, only an administration that does not fear transparency can be the true harbinger of change.

Waves of rain

Odisha must prepare for repeated bouts of intense downpour

Odisha is experiencing one of its most intense monsoons, recording 1,453 mm of rainfall between June and September 25 this year, a 29% excess. The reason is the unusually large number of atmospheric systems, including 11 over the Bay of Bengal, the latest making landfall near Kalingapatnam on September 23. The IMD had forecast that India would receive 90% of the long-period average partly because an El Niño was expected to develop; the State had finished June itself with a 47% deficit. However, rainfall in the region came to be dominated by the weather systems, which also repeatedly delivered rain without giving locals time to recover. By the State's estimates, 5.2 lakh people had been affected by July 30 and another 13.5 lakh by August 27. At least 60 locations have so far received more than 100 mm of rain in 24 hours, with the runoff swelling multiple rivers and threatening more floods downstream, including in Bhadrak and Jajpur, and landslides in hilly areas. When a previous bout of rain has already saturated the soil and topped local storage, a new bout could lead more immediately to runoff. While the State's south is predominantly highland and confronts slope failure risks, its coast is a depositional plain of multiple deltas, rendering a terrain with low gradient through which water does not readily drain into the sea.

The efficacy of the State's long-standing policy to have zero casualties remains to be seen, especially given the extent to which the ongoing season will stress the drain design and maintenance deficiencies that the CAG had flagged in 2024. Other important data include the eventual crop and infrastructure damage assessments and the peak levels of the Baitarani, Budhabalanga, Jalaka, and Rushikulya rivers after the 11th system fades. A study in May by the Odisha University of Agriculture and Technology, based on data from 1901-2020, reported that both maximum one-day and five-day rainfall bursts were becoming more common even as the frequency of heavy-rain days was dipping. The State has been renowned for its disaster management protocols. However, the recurrent waterlogging in urban hubs such as Berhampur and the disruption of inter-State highways and rail networks suggest that its evacuation protocols outpace its civic engineering, with significant room to improve socio-economic and infrastructural resilience. Climate change is also increasingly correlated with more protracted monsoon withdrawal and intense rain events. Taken together, Odisha needs to pivot from anticipating isolated seasonal anomalies to preparing for repeated intense downpours.

Time runs short for Iran and America

Mahesh Sachdev

Retired Indian Ambassador, specialising in West Asian and oil issues

It may be tempting to see the recent jerky resumption of negotiations between the Islamic Republic of Iran (IRI) and the United States as *déjà vu*. Similar attempts resulted in the June 17 Memorandum that unravelled within weeks, and the two belligerents resumed their respective blockades of the Strait of Hormuz and Iranian ports.

A different moment now

So, what is different this time? They have both realised that time is not on their side. Their respective domestic considerations make continuation of the seven-month-old war costly and unsustainable. In the short run, going by the past pattern, September 26 saw United States President Trump's dismissal of Iran's seven-point proposal, which may be an opening gambit seeking better terms and sequencing. While the Iranian initiative may betray their economic desperation, it also showcases their reasonableness to the Trump sceptics in America and the region who regard his "War of Choice" against Iran as ill-begotten.

The November 3 mid-term congressional elections could upend Mr. Trump as a lame duck. Iranian hardliners, too, need to exhaust this option to justify their aggressiveness. In the longer run, Mr. Trump needs to salvage his legacy to match his extravagant promises. Similarly, the Iranian theocrats need to keep Gen Z engaged and avoid regional blowback from the coagulating mistrust. Thus, while retaining their braggadocio about final victory, each needs to move away from its maximalist obduracy and seek a "Hudna" or temporary peace. The impact of the unfolding imbroglio on the two belligerents as well as on Israel and Gulf states must be examined.

Statistically, the U.S. has a quantitative premium and staying power *vis-à-vis* Iran: It has three times the population, 85 times the GDP and 20 times the military budget. Iran is also at a disadvantage in quality and modernity of weaponry, although its asymmetric strategy has blunted that edge. Washington has weaponised 'Operation Economic Outcast' against the already "maximum sanctioned" Iranian economy. Yet, the IRI has not "capitulated", and the U.S. itself faces inflation, ammunition depletion and isolation. Battle asymmetry aside, their respective combat histories are relevant. The Iran war has been an outlier from the usual U.S. military doctrine of battle dominance through "shock-and-awe", tech superiority, and leveraging its global primacy through the global politico-financial architecture. The last battle that the U.S. fought as an underdog was its war of independence nearly 250 years ago, and hubris haunts it now. In contrast, Iranians have often been the underdogs to Greeks, Byzantines, Arabs and Ottomans. More recently, British and American manipulation for oil, and Iraq's 1980 invasion of a fledgling IRI, still frame Iranian political discourse. Their Shia sect being a minority among the Sunni Muslims reinforces their sense of virtues in suffering and martyrdom. The legacy has made the IRI more determined to face enemies with grit, guile and gumption.

> Both Tehran and Washington must hear the bells toll as mistrust grows and global economies falter

The political ecosystem in Iran is hardened, with dissent stifled and externalised to demonised America and Israel as the two Satans. Mr. Trump has been less successful in getting Americans and the allies abroad behind his trenchant anti-Iran rhetoric. This is partly due to his divisiveness, lack of coherent endgame strategy and inability to protect his allies' security and economy. Triggering a decapitating war that ignored Iranian politico-military resilience and retaliatory capacity was a strategic blunder. It risked the closure of the two vital maritime choke points, rising hydrocarbon prices, and threatened to push American "hyperpower" into a forever conflict against a middle-ranked, but determined, Iran. Similarly, his recent strategy of inflicting economic pain on Iranians may also fail by making them rally around the flag. Occasional tanker attacks and the ongoing Yemen-Saudi scrimmage notwithstanding, seven months on, the two belligerents are currently licking their wounds.

Uncertain path ahead

Two formidable unknowns loom before some educated projections can be made about the U.S.-Iran conundrum. First, although the Iranian seven-point proposal is based on the June 17 Islamabad memorandum, its precise contents are foggy. Second, the failure of the Islamabad memorandum, subsequent tit-for-tat attacks, the U.S. blockade, Operation Economic Outcast and fire-eating rhetoric since June 17 have deepened mutual mistrust, raising the bar for the modus vivendi required for a peace deal. These negatives are balanced by awareness that the continued stalemate would lead to a shared perdition of a hostile Congress blockading Mr. Trump and anti-establishment demonstrations pulling the rug under the Mullahs.

Under a positive scenario, both sides can breathe easier and develop greater mutual empathy. Failure of the June 17 Grand Bargain would have presumably made them more realistic and incremental. So, instead of a race to the bottom, each would need to reluctantly adopt a "Live and Let Live" approach. Despite Mr. Trump's rejection, signs, such as the Iranian leaders extending their stay in New York, Tehran's flexibility about controlling the Strait of Hormuz and the use of Qatari mediation instead of alacritous Pakistani generals, seem tentatively positive. To be effective and beneficial to both sides, the deal would have to last at least till November 3, the election date.

Even if this band-aid deal allows the two belligerents to staunch the haemorrhage temporarily, what guarantees its long-term sequel, say, after the Congressional elections? The IRI and the U.S. are certain to use the interregnum to "recharge their batteries" and get ready for the next round. Their mutual scepticism and contentious issues such as the nuclear and missile programmes, and the proxy non-state actors could impede any progress towards permanent normalisation. A "high noon" can be expected by mid-November.

The sequel would depend on which of the two belligerents is able to hold his flock together. An inherently unpredictable Mr. Trump may only suspend the gamut of anti-Iran measures and keep his forces deployed in the region. Similarly, Iran is unlikely to let go of control of the Strait of Hormuz as future deterrence. To dissuade him from resuming military kinetics, Iran has already unveiled its possible escalatory ladder that includes advanced weaponry, a possible al-Houthi blockade of Bab al-Mandeb, retaliatory attacks on America's Gulf allies and hints of pre-emptive strikes. Simultaneously, Tehran has sought a regional diplomatic reset through an interim supervisory arrangement with Oman on the Strait of Hormuz, to be endorsed by other Gulf littoral states.

Wider regional consequences

The past two years have brought Israel and Iran into two direct no-holds-barred wars. Intense drone and missile attacks have convinced Israeli public opinion that Iran constitutes an existential threat. On its part, Iran is unlikely to forgive the Lesser Satan for the assassination of its last Supreme Leader. Their resultant intense regional geopolitical competition, particularly in the Levant, would outlast any Tehran-Washington peace deal, giving their two-millennia-old civilisational animus a new edge. Although the October 27 Knesset elections may see hawkish anti-Iran Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu replaced, any successor is likely to be hostile to an Iran pursuing a nuclear duality. Iran can be expected to rely on its proxies and asymmetric arsenal to create a balance of power with Israel equipped with state-of-the-art U.S. weapons. In the long run, time would favour the one with better innovative skills. While Israel is a "Startup Nation", Iran has also been impressively inventive under pressure.

Other regional countries in the Arabian Peninsula, Iraq and Jordan, were caught in the crossfire and suffered considerable collateral damage under Iranian retaliation. Their hydrocarbon exports and other economic activities have been stifled. In most cases, their extensive forex reserves are likely to help them tide over the turbulence. However, their long-standing security reliance on the U.S. would call for a thorough reappraisal. Among the uncertainties they need to tackle is the future of oil, now more tightly tied to geopolitics than the supply-demand equilibrium.

In this war, "time" has emerged as an element even more slippery and opaque than oil.

Tackling food loss and waste — India's opportunity

Konda Reddy Chavva

Officer-in-Charge, FAO Representation in India

Food loss and waste remain one of the world's most persistent challenges, with severe consequences for climate, food security, economic costs, and sustainable use of natural resources. India produces enough to feed its population of 1.4 billion, yet a significant share of its produce is lost across the value chain. As the country advances towards more resilient, sustainable and efficient agrifood systems, tackling food loss and waste can deliver a triple win: strengthening food security and nutrition, reducing pressure on natural resources and emissions, and improving incomes and productivity. The International Day of Awareness of Food Loss and Waste, observed annually on September 29, highlights this opportunity for India.

India has already taken the first step by generating nationally representative data.

India's evidence base, a global first

India is the only country to have conducted three national post-harvest loss surveys. The Ministry of Food Processing Industries assessed losses across 45, 45 and 54 commodities in 2005-07, 2012-14 and 2020-22, respectively, covering the supply chain from farm to retail. The process for a fourth round is now under way.

This sustained effort supports its reporting of the Food Loss Index under the Sustainable Development Goals. However, these estimates cover mainly losses on the farm and in the supply chain. Data on food waste in retail, in hotels and restaurants, and at household level remains far less developed.

The Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) is working with the government, research and financial institutions across India's agrifood systems to translate the triple win from theme to practice. Generating evidence, testing technologies and mobilising investment from farm to market to the city have been the core of these initiatives.

> Cutting food losses can strengthen food security, conserve resources and advance climate goals

When food is lost, so are the resources used to produce it. Reducing losses can help India meet its climate and resource-efficiency goals while strengthening food security. The scope for reducing losses is greatest with better storage, drying, cooling, moisture management and processing. Digital tools such as traceability systems can further improve how food is moved and managed through the supply chain.

Food loss and waste need to be integrated more systematically into agricultural planning, food-processing strategies, climate action and investment decisions. This means directing finance towards technologies and infrastructure where they can have the greatest impact, while ensuring that solutions remain affordable and accessible to farmers, producer organisations and small businesses. Circular approaches can add another dimension. Surplus food can be redistributed, while unavoidable organic residues can be converted into compost, biogas or energy, reducing waste and creating additional economic value.

Wholesale markets, overlooked opportunity

Assessments by the FAO and the National Council of Agriculture Marketing Boards (COSAMB) have found that major wholesale markets can generate up to 100 tonnes of organic waste a day; in some cities as much as a fifth of all urban organic waste reaches landfills. Nationally, this adds up to an estimated 3.5 million tonnes a year. It is no waste stream but a resource base, which if treated, can offset roughly 3.3 million tonnes of CO_2-equivalent emissions annually, or close to $30 million in carbon credits.

A 50-tonne-a-day bio-CNG plant in Surat, Gujarat, has been run through a private-sector partnership for over five years and reportedly cuts methane-related emissions by about 7,500 tonnes a year.

India can adapt such models to local conditions, including the commodity mix and infrastructure of different markets. Municipalities and market committees can also improve organic-waste segregation, collection and treatment, while developing markets for compost, biogas and other recovered materials.

Investment and innovation

India must move from individual interventions to a more connected national approach with financing at its core. The FAO and the Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) are linking identified food-loss hotspots with climate-resilient technologies such as drying, moisture control, energy-efficient cooling and storage, while SIDBI is arranging finance to help small and medium enterprises adopt them.

The FAO is also working to equip Indian cities with a practical "Package of Practices" for urban food loss and waste management, giving municipalities the tools to measure, prevent, reduce, redistribute and valorise waste across households, wholesale markets, retail and food service.

India now has the data, technology and viable models to reduce food loss and waste. The priority is to close data gaps, direct investment and make loss reduction part of agricultural, food-processing, urban and climate policy.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Institutions face pressure

There is now a widespread public perception across the country that India's democracy is facing pressures — institutions such as the Election Commission of India, the judiciary, the Enforcement Directorate, the Central Bureau of Investigation and the IAS and IPS machinery seem to be struggling to discharge their constitutional duties sincerely, for reasons best known to them. The way the selection process for the Chief Election Commissioner has been diluted to have a pliant person in the chair has, obviously, paved the way for the botched operation of the Special Intensive Revision, which seems intended to manipulate electoral outcomes to the advantage of a political group. Indian citizens can no longer afford to be mute spectators to the growing tendency of constitutional functionaries to seek the goodwill of their political bosses rather than remain loyal to the country. And, of course, fearless and meaningful journalism is expected of the Indian media, whose image badly needs to be restored.

Ravindrababu,
Hyderabad

Banking sector issues

The deferment of the proposed three-day bank strike by the bank unions following discussions with bank managements is a welcome step. A five-day working week was agreed upon in the last settlement two and a half years ago, but it is yet to be implemented. The unions have also expressed deep concern over the lack of unilateral implementation. The IBA should come forward and resolve all outstanding issues expeditiously, considering the importance of the banking sector to the nation's economy.

J. Anantha Padmanabhan,
Tiruchi, Tamil Nadu

Justice delayed

The 'Data Point' (Opinion page, September 28), on pendencies in cases of assault, was an eye-opener on the issue of women's safety. Women in India are often revered as mothers and goddesses, yet remain vulnerable to gender-based inequalities. While women are being empowered on the one hand, the continuing crimes against them on the other are deeply disturbing. The judiciary needs to work on a war footing to ensure that cases involving crimes against women are not delayed.

Balasubramaniam Pavani,
Secunderabad

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The 80s nostalgia holds caste bias

Rejimon Kuttappan
is a workers rights advocate

On July 17, 1985, an argument at a drinking water tank in Karamchedu, in coastal Andhra Pradesh, turned into a massacre. A Madiga woman objected to a Kamma youth soiling the public drinking water tank her family drank from. By nightfall, six Madiga men were dead and three Dalit women had been raped. The police called it a riot. A civil liberties fact-finding team called it a one-sided massacre. The killings birthed the Andhra Pradesh Dalit Mahasabha and a four-decade argument over whether the Constitution reaches inside a village.

Forty-one years later, our feeds are full of the past; AI-generated images of the 80s. Chiffon sarees against sunlit walls, Ambassadors and Contessas. Thus, India became the No. 1 country for Google's Nano Banana image-generation model, and its signature trend was retro-Bollywood portraits. However, where did this aesthetic come from?

Model or mood board, the source material is the same – film stills, magazine spreads, studio portraits, and family albums. However, in the India of the 1980s, all four belonged to households with money and standing; overwhelmingly *savarna*, urban or landed. In 1983, by the Planning Commission's own estimates, 44.5% of Indians, some 323 million people, lived below the poverty line. In 1980, only about a quarter of households lit their homes with electricity. Parliament enacted the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act only in 1989.

It is not that Dalit and Adivasi lives were not photographed; they were, but by others – the state took pictures for its welfare files, activists after an atrocity, as well as anthropologists. The family photograph, which is taken simply to be seen, and is the genre nostalgia runs on, was the one the poor could least afford. Those who could reach a photo studio posed before a painted Swiss chalet; the colony and the forbidden tap remained outside the frame.

A model trained on such an archive reproduces the silence, and hardens it. Tests by MIT Technology Review found that GPT-5 chooses the stereotypical answer in 80 of 105 sentences: the clever man is upper caste, and the sewage cleaner is Dalit. A study presented at the ACM's FAccT conference this year analysed 1,536 images from Gemini's image model, the engine behind Nano Banana, prompted with Indian names and no caste labels. Caste surfaced anyway, through food, neighbourhood, work and worship. One image placed a sanitation worker beneath a banner reading "Bhangi Colony".

Ask the machine for the 1980s and it gives you an upper-caste version. Ask it for a Dalit and it reaches for dirt. The machine did not invent this prejudice; it inherited it and now industrialises it.

A state that looks away

Nobody outside the companies knows what is in the training sets. Nor do those who label them (often South Asian workers paid per task to judge which faces look Indian enough). Can a labeller who has never seen a colony flag a model that has never rendered one?

And the government? The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)'s AI Governance Guidelines name bias and discrimination as risks, and then leans on voluntary codes and self-certification. The Centre has told the Rajya Sabha that no new horizontal AI law is needed at this stage. Meanwhile, the ₹10,371-crore IndiaAI Mission subsidises "sovereign" models. Moreover, Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw has promised that Indian-trained models will be free of "the bias of many other models". Which bias? Tested how?

A committee is reportedly drafting firmer rules; caste must be written into them. Additionally, the MeitY and the IndiaAI Safety Institute should answer these four questions – what is in the training data? who labelled it? has a caste-bias evaluation been done? will relevant date be published? Anything short of mandatory, public answers is consent by silence.

The counter-evidence is on our screens through films such as *Fandry*, *Kammattipaadam*, *Pariyerum Perumal*, *Vaazhai* etc. What they share is not budget, but authorship. The person remembering has stood on the other side of the water tank. Caste vanishes from nostalgia not because it is subtle but because it is not an object. Caste is who sits where, and who draws from which tap. You cannot buy it as a prop; you will miss it unless it has not shaped your life.

So, do not ban the filter. Go upstream. Ask Dalit, Adivasi, Muslim and working-class families what images they hold from 1975 to 1995, who took them, and what was kept out of frame. Fund community photo archives as seriously as we fund film restoration.

Tests by MIT Technology Review found that GPT-5 chooses the stereotypical answer in 80 of 105 sentences: the clever man is upper caste, and the sewage cleaner is Dalit

Revisiting the farmer question

Priyambada Jayakumar
Historian, public speaker, columnist, handloom advocate, and the author of 'The Man Who Fed India'

India may no longer be an agriculture dominated economy, but it remains deeply dependent on it. While only about 15-18% of GDP now comes from agriculture, the sector continues to employ around 46% of India's workforce. A large part of rural India depends directly on farming and allied activities for its livelihood. This creates an uncomfortable paradox: while India has transformed into an economy driven by industry and services, the economic viability of farming has not kept pace. This is why, as we observe M. S. Swaminathan's death anniversary, the recommendations of the National Commission on Farmers (NCF), which he chaired, need to be revisited.

One of the biggest challenges in Indian agriculture is small landholdings; about 86% of farmers own less than two hectares. Small plots constrain economies of scale, crop diversification and the adoption of new technologies and farming practices. Water is another structural constraint. Around half of all farmed land relies entirely on unpredictable rain, exposing farmers to drought and erratic monsoons. Elsewhere, intensive irrigation has created the opposite problem: groundwater depletion. The Cauvery dispute is ultimately a manifestation of competing demands on a finite resource.

Moreover, climate change is intensifying these vulnerabilities. Erratic rainfall, floods, droughts, and heat waves are increasingly translating into crop losses, while, rising costs of seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, and fuel squeeze farm margins.

Farmers often receive only a miniscule share of the final value of what they produce. Weak storage and processing infrastructure, fragmented supply chains and multiple intermediaries often leave cultivators with little bargaining power.

What the NCF got right

The NCF offered a comprehensive response to many of these problems. Its central insight was that agricultural distress was fundamentally an income and livelihood problem, not merely a productivity problem. Farmer policy, it argued, should be judged by the economic well-being of farmers rather than by increases in production or yield. The Commission, therefore, looked beyond land ownership to timely access to productive resources such as water, credit, technology, livestock, fisheries and other natural resources. It called for closer links between research institutions and cultivators.

Its approach also emphasised ecological sustainability. Higher productivity could not come at the cost of soil health and water security. Efficient water use, sustainable farming practices and conservation of natural resources were integral to agricultural policy.

The NCF also recognised that farmers were at the wrong end of an unequal value chain. It proposed district-level agricultural infrastructure; direct marketing linkages; stronger integration between agriculture and rural industry; and better storage, grading, packaging, processing and transportation. It sought to strengthen farmers' bargaining power. Importantly, the Commission did not assume that everyone dependent on rural India could or should remain solely dependent on cultivation. It proposed a broader livelihood-security framework encompassing agriculture and allied activities, rural enterprises and non-farm employment.

Over the last two decades, several of NCF's recommendations have been implemented through separate schemes and missions. However, the Commission's larger vision of making farming economically viable, reducing risk, strengthening farmers' bargaining power and integrating production with markets has not been implemented as an integrated framework.

The NCF also anticipated a dilemma that is in sharp focus today: Indian agriculture cannot remain insulated from global markets, but neither can small farmers be exposed to those markets without adequate protection. With India now implementing Free Trade Agreements while also dealing with tariff pressures from the U.S., NCF's ideas have renewed relevance. The challenge is to ensure that greater integration with global markets becomes an opportunity for Indian farmers rather than another source of vulnerability.

The answer is not protectionism, but a combination of remunerative prices, risk management, farmer aggregation, productivity enhancement, value addition, and carefully designed trade safeguards. The task today is not to mechanically reproduce the recommendations, but to update and complete their underlying vision for the agriculture sector.

The challenge is to ensure that greater integration with global markets becomes an opportunity for Indian farmers rather than another source of vulnerability

Gender disparities in contraceptive use and sterilisation

In contrast to 36.5% women reporting sterilisation, only a meagre 0.5% men reported male sterilisation in NFHS-6

DATA POINT

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
Nitika Francis

The World Health Organization (WHO) has issued new guidelines on expanding contraceptive options and, for the first time, set out the benchmarks for a new generation of reversible male contraceptives that could give men more alternatives.

The timing of the announcement is significant for India. After focussing on family-planning policies for decades, fertility has fallen below the replacement level **(Chart 1)**. Figures from the latest National Family Health Survey (NFHS-6) for 2023-24, show a decline in the share of married women who have an unmet need for family planning by one percentage point from NFHS-5 for 2019-21.

Yet, the NFHS-6 also shows that the demographic achievement has not altered the gender imbalance in contraceptive responsibility, with both temporary and permanent contraception measures increasingly used/taken by women.

Chart 2 shows an increase in the proportion of currently married women aged 15-49 using any contraceptive method, from 66.7% as per the NFHS-5 (for 2019-21) to 69.1% in 2023-24. Though majority of these women used modern methods of contraception, their use has fallen from 56.4% to 52.7%, while traditional methods – principally rhythm/fertility-awareness and withdrawal – have risen sharply by 6 percentage points between NFHS-5 and NFHS-6, which is the largest increase in the reported use of any contraceptive method between the two surveys.

While the NFHS data do not establish the reason for this increase, possible factors include concerns about side-effects, convenience, privacy, partner preferences, access and a desire to avoid hormonal or invasive methods, with women being the principal users of such methods.

The decline in the use of modern methods is reflected in female sterilisation as well. Women who are married and reporting female sterilisation came down marginally from 37.9% in NFHS-5 to 36.5% in NFHS-6. Importantly, sterilisation also remains overwhelmingly female. In contrast to 36.5% reporting female sterilisation, only a meagre 0.5% men reported male sterilisation in NFHS-6 – a miniscule increase from 0.3% in NFHS-5. The disparity becomes more striking when the data is viewed over three decades **(Chart 3)**. Female sterilisation climbed rapidly between NFHS-1 and NFHS-3 and has remained at around 36-38%; male sterilisation fell from 3.4% in NFHS-1 to 0.5% in NFHS-6.

A look at State-wise figures on male sterilisation shows that even the States that achieved low Total Fertility Rate (TFR) early were not exceptions to this trend. The share of men who used sterilisation as their preferred contraceptive method increased between NFHS-5 and NFHS-6 in 22 States. And yet, none of these States, barring Telangana, saw an increase of more than one percentage point, as shown in **Chart 4**. Numbers indicate that as India moved towards replacement-level fertility, vasectomy or male sterilisation went from a visible component of family planning to a marginal one.

While the sterilisation process for females is not inherently unsafe, the physical intervention required to end fertility is less invasive for men and can be performed under local anaesthesia.

"Choice is a gender equality issue," said Pascale Allotey, Director of WHO's Department of Sexual, Reproductive, Maternal, Child and Adolescent Health and Ageing, while releasing the new guidelines. WHO said its own research has challenged a longstanding assumption that men would not use new contraceptives. India should leverage the new WHO guidelines to address the gender imbalance.

Unequal responsibility

The data for the charts were sourced from the National Family Health Survey reports released by the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare and Sample Registration System statistical reports. With inputs from Gandla Sneha, who is interning with The Hindu's Data Team

CHART 1: India achieved the goal set in the National Population Policy 2000 for its Total Fertility Rate (TFR) of 2.0 in 2021. It fell to 1.9 in 2025, below replacement level

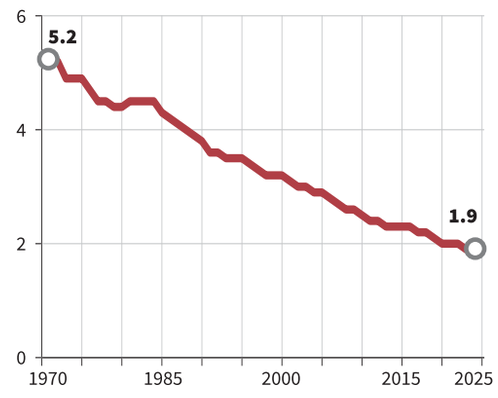


CHART 2: A majority of married women used modern methods of contraception, but use of traditional methods have risen sharply. Values outside the bars show the totals

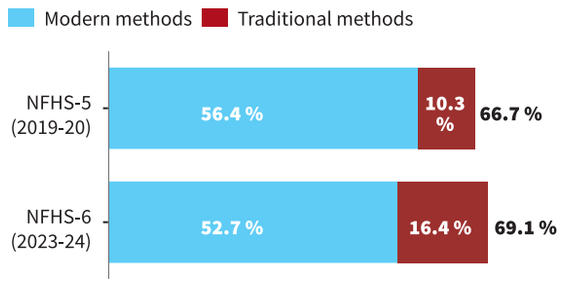
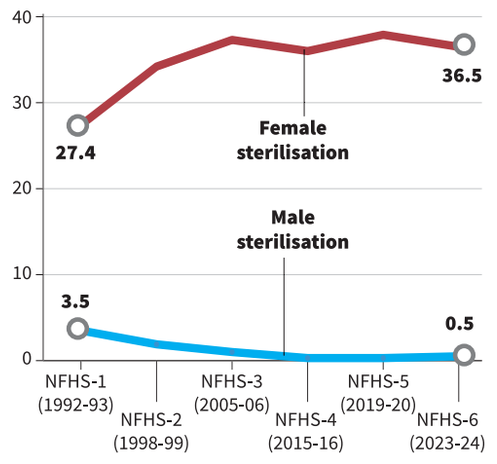
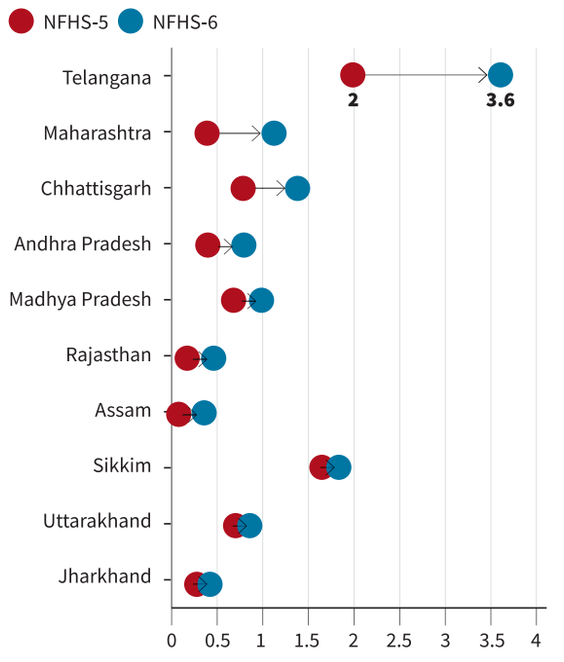


CHART 3: While the share of women undergoing sterilisation has increased, the same has dropped for men from the already abysmal level



WHO has developed its first "Target Product Profile" for male contraceptive methods, setting out the characteristics methods should aim to meet, including safety, effectiveness, acceptability and affordability

CHART 4: The 10 States that recorded the highest increase in the share (%) of men using sterilisation as their method of contraception. The increase is miniscule as the chart shows



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 29, 1976

Shukla's tribute to Bharathi

Madras, September 28: The State Government has decided to acquire the house at Triplicane in Madras where the Tamil poet Subrahmanya Bharathi lived during his last days and also to rename Pycrofts Road as Bharathi Salai.

This was announced to-day by the Governor, Mr. Mohanlal Sukhadia, while inaugurating a month-long Son et Lumiere programme on Bharathi at a function presided over by the Minister for Information and Broadcasting, Mr. V.C. Shukla.

The sound and light spectacle entitled "Oru Sakthi Pirakuthu Moochinile" in the courtyard of Rajaji Hall portrays different facets of the poet as a nationalist, journalist, social reformed and devotee. Mr. Shukla said that though the programme was to run for a month, if the response was encouraging, it would not only be prolonged but extended to other parts.

Tamil Nadu had every reason to be proud of Bharathi and the part played by him during the freedom struggle was written in letters of gold. The Governor said that though the poet had lived only for 39 years he has bequeathed to the people a priceless treasure of patriotic poetry which had immortalised him. His patriotic fervour was so great that he poured out his heart in soul-stirring poems. His songs were even-to-day in the lips of young and old of Tamil Nadu and elsewhere. Mr. Sukhadia said that efforts were now being made by the UNESCO to publish a translation of some of Bharathi's important poems.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 29, 1926

Supply of safety razors to British Army

London, September 27: The decision of the War Office to serve out safety razors to soldiers instead of open blades, was raised in Parliament in connection with a contract for the supply of the former made by a company bearing a well-known American name.

Captain King, for the Government, explained that the company with which the arrangement was made was the offshoot of an entirely British character. He mentioned that one condition of the contract was that the Company should take over the War Officer stocks of over hundred thousand long-bandled razors in exchange for safety razors.

From Page One

SC: Authorities lax in ensuring women safety

Expressing serious concern over the gang-rape of a 17-year-old girl in a moving bus that travelled nearly 47 km from Greater Noida to Kashmere Gate without being stopped at a single police picket earlier this month, the apex court said it could not help but "draw painful parallels with the 2012 Nirbhaya case". The incident, it said, raised questions over whether systemic law-enforcement mechanisms had made any "meaningful progress" in the years since then.

The Bench also took note of statements by public authorities and elected representatives expressing concern over such incidents, but said expressions of solidarity without accountability failed to address larger institutional failures that transcended individual cases.

"Expressing solidarity is not the solution to this social evil. What is required is a measurable response, with responsibility and accountability fixed upon the authorities entrusted with prevention of crime, maintenance of public order, and protection of vulnerable persons," it said.

As an interim measure, the court directed the Delhi Police Commissioner to constitute dedicated teams for each police district to immediately survey and inspect vulnerable pockets, including isolated stretches, parks, transport hubs, markets and areas around educational institutions.

It also ordered the preparation of district-wise vulnerability maps to be shared among adjoining police stations, so that information on recurring patterns of crime and habitual offenders is not confined to individual police station jurisdictions.

The Bench called for increased patrolling and security arrangements at identified public parks and other vulnerable areas, particularly during evening and early morning hours, or at other times identified through the vulnerability assessment.

An immediate audit of lighting and CCTV coverage has also been ordered across public parks and other vulnerable areas to identify and eliminate blind spots.

"Non-functional CCTV cameras and lighting infrastructure shall be repaired or restored in an expeditious manner. Additional lights and CCTVs [are] to be installed wherever inadequacy is sensed or reported by citizens," the Bench directed.

Panel's religion-wise queries stump States

The high-level panel has also sought intelligence assessments and commission reports on religious conversions among Scheduled Tribe communities, and details of operational detention centres, among other information.

Other than birth registration, where the religion of the newborn is mentioned on the certificate, and the number of undocumented migrants apprehended or deported, the religion-wise data on all other categories were unavailable, said State government officials.

As the principal Opposition in 2006, the BJP had opposed the Sachar Commission recommendations and questioned its constitutional validity, stating that it promoted religious quota and was socially divisive. The commission was appointed by the Congress-led United Progressive Alliance government in 2005 to look into the social, economic, and educational status of the Muslim community.

One of the questions of the HLCDC reads: "Details of districts showing unusual school enrolment trends inconsistent with historical birth rates, along with reasons". Another seeks district-wise data on religious structures established in the past 15 years, including details of any GIS mapping or other technology used for their identification.

The committee had also sought data on district-, religion-, and year-wise voter registration data of the last 15 years for individuals "without prior-generation birth certificates or familial legacy records, including observed trends and concentrations".

The committee has sought district-wise data on changes in religious composition, particularly in cities, industrial centres, border districts, tribal areas and Fifth/Sixth Schedule areas. It has also asked for State studies, intelligence assessments, commission reports and White Papers examining demographic changes.

States have been asked for information on changes in the religious composition of Scheduled Tribe populations and any studies or intelligence assessments concerning religious conversion among tribal communities. The panel also sought religion-wise and district-wise information on birth registrations, including delayed registrations and institutional/non-institutional births. It also sought data on unusual increases in Aadhaar enrolments, voter IDs and ration cards, and cases involving forged identity documents. The questionnaire requested 15 years of religion-wise and district-wise data on transport and non-transport vehicle registrations.

The committee has asked for religion-wise details of property transactions and information on unusual land acquisition, demographic clustering and ownership patterns. States have also been asked to provide information on religion-wise distribution of ration cards and school enrolments, fraudulent access to welfare schemes, unusual school-enrolment patterns, and government, private and religious educational institutions in tribal-dominated districts. The questionnaire also asks about GIS mapping of religious educational institutions, including madrasas.

SC questions govt.'s power to levy UPI merchant fees

If it is not a tax or fee, what is the executive scope of making this expropriation, Justice Joymalya Bagchi asks; Supreme Court refuses repeated pleas to grant an interim stay on its implementation

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Taking a toll: Centre has introduced a merchant discount rate fee of 0.4% on person-to-merchant UPI payments over ₹2,000. REUTERS

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned the government's legal authority to "expropriate" 0.4% charge from merchants for specified UPI person-to-merchant transactions in excess of ₹2,000.

A three-judge Bench headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant issued notice to the Union of India, the Reserve Bank of India, and the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) on a petition alleging that the UPI merchant discount rate (MDR) charges would trigger a return to cash transactions, and the bane of black money.

But the court refused petitioner Anjan Datta's repeated pleas to grant an interim stay on the implementation of the September 14, 2026 notification. The Bench directed the government, the Central banker and the NPCI, which will introduce the UPI MDR charges from October 15, 2026.

"We are on the legal incidence of your notification. If it is not a tax or fee, what is the executive scope of making this expropriation? We want an explanation in an affidavit... If not a fee, what is its character?" Justice Joymalya Bagchi asked Additional Solicitor General N. Venkataraman, appearing for the Centre.

An MDR of 0.4% would be introduced on Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000, according to the government. For transactions of ₹75,000 and above, the MDR would be capped at ₹300 per transaction.

Mr. Venkataraman submitted that the charges would touch a "scarce, thin" population.

"This [UPI MDR charges] is yet to come. It is likely to come on October 15. I have to say that 96% of people using the gateway are exempted. Amongst the remaining 4%, essential services are capped at ₹5. There is also a value cap – any threshold to the merchant beyond ₹75,000 is capped at ₹300. Collection charges are less than 0.5% with all these limitations," he submitted.

But the law officer said the MDR charges would be limited to only the aggregators and banks. The government hardly had a role.

"Aggregators and banks are the entities that ensure instantaneous credit and debit happen, to avoid cash transactions in the economy. It is their ecosystem. They alone operate there. The government does not take anything. This is a purely administrative mechanism. The government is several steps away from this money. My Lords have to bear all this in mind," Mr. Venkataraman submitted.

The Bench gave the respondents four weeks to file their counter affidavits.

The petition has also challenged the constitutional validity of the amended Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, alleging that it gave unguided powers to the Executive to decide which electronic payment modes would receive the no-charge protection. The petitioner pointed out that the no-charge protection for RuPay debit cards would continue without a monetary ceiling.

Ease third language evaluation norms for Class 6, says SC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The third language will be assessed only through internal school-based evaluation. FILE

The Supreme Court (SC) on Monday directed the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) to extend to Class 6 students the same relaxation available to those in Class 7 regarding evaluation under the three-language formula.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant passed the order after Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta representing the Union government and the CBSE along with Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati, submitted that the Centre would attempt to persuade the court to allow implementation for Class 6 itself.

Class 7 students, along with those in Classes 8 and 9, have been granted a transitional relaxation from the CBSE Board exam in the third language when they reach Class 10. The third language will be assessed only through internal school-based evaluation, with no pass or fail linked to Board results.

Hearing the petitions challenging the three-language scheme, the court had, in previous hearings, asked the law officers to seek instructions on whether the current batch of Class 6 students could be exempted from the scheme.

Mr. Mehta, on Monday, said the impact of the scheme would be minimal. He said except for 1.2% of 28,819 schools, the others had attuned themselves to the demands of the scheme. The Solicitor-General said the children would "adapt". But Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on the Bench, responded that it was not about children's prowess to adapt, but they should be "comfortable".

Justice Bagchi said if any school held back a student in internal assessment, the court would intervene.

Coast Guard averts major oil spill off Odisha's coast, rescues Belize-flagged ship

The Hindu Bureau
BHUBANESWAR

MT Seagull 9. @INDIACOASTGUARD

The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) on Monday said it averted a major incident off the Odisha coast, rescuing a distressed foreign vessel, *MT Seagull 9*, approximately 37 nautical miles east-southeast of Paradip and prevented a major oil spill.

The Belize-flagged vessel, carrying 9,000 tonnes of palm oil with 23 crew members aboard, issued a distress call at 7.30 a.m. on September 27 following the main engine failure and rapid ballast tank flooding, which caused the ship to tilt dangerously, the ICG said in a statement.

ICGS Vishwast was immediately pressed into service. "A specialist ICG damage control team boarded the unstable vessel under challenging conditions. Deploying submersible de-flooding pumps and advanced damage-control equipment, the team swiftly arrested the leakage, blanked two damaged seawater pipelines, and contained a third fractured line," it said.

The ICG had also diverted a Pollution Control Vessel (PCV) and an additional Offshore Patrol Vessel (OPV) to the location for augmented pollution response and round-the-clock monitoring of the situation.

ICGS Vishwast's specialised team, in coordination with the vessel's crew, carried out concurrent cargo transfer and de-flooding operations, effectively stabilising the tanker and eliminating the threat of capsizing.

Aerial surveillance

A Dornier aircraft was used for real-time aerial surveillance. "A minor palm oil sheen initially observed near the vessel on September 27 was confirmed fully dissipated during the follow-up aerial sorties on September 28. Strict pollution-response protocols remain active to safeguard the marine ecosystem," the ICG said.

"In a synchronised multi-agency effort, Paradip Port Authority tug Dolphin took the stabilised *MT Seagull 9* under tow towards the anchorage area off Paradip," it added.

Pace of India's bullet train project failed to meet early expectations: Japan official

Kallol Bhattacherjee
TOKYO

The rate of progress on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed rail corridor project has not "lived up to" Japan's initial expectations, a senior official of Japan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs said on Monday. India's first bullet train project is being supported, financially and technically, by Japan.

Speaking exclusively to *The Hindu*, the official said that Japan is not in a position to declare when the project will be completed, but maintained that, despite the delay, the project is now making "steady progress".

India and Japan will convene the "two plus two" dialogue by the end of the year, the official said.

On the issue of disputed territories, the Japanese official asserted that all countries "must respect international maritime laws in the South China Sea and the East China Sea", including in the Senkaku islands that Japan claims as part of its sovereign territories and China claims as the Diaoyu islands.

No concrete timeline

"I have to admit the timeline has not lived up to our expectations as originally envisaged," the Japanese official said, with regard to the Mumbai-Ahmedabad rail project. However, he expressed confidence that the project is now "moving forward".

After years of feasibility studies and multiple-level reviews, the project was kicked off on September 14, 2017, when Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the late Japanese PM Shinzo Abe laid its foundation stone in Ahmedabad.

"Both sides are committed to bringing high-speed trains to India, among other things. Construction of high-speed infrastructure is also developing steadily on the ground both in Mumbai and Gujarat, and we hope high-speed trains will start to move in a few years in India," the official said, without giving a concrete timeline for the project's completion.

His comments come months after former Japanese Minister Hideki Makihara blamed the delay on the "sheer recklessness" of Indian officials.

Asked by *The Hindu* about Mr. Makihara's remarks, the official said, "I don't want to endorse any comments outside of the negotiation." He said Japan was going ahead with works on the "signal system, rail structure."

Cong. leaders arrested for defacing wall of CEC's home

Press Trust of India
AGRA

Two Congress leaders were arrested on Monday for allegedly defacing the wall and the main gate of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's home in Agra with the words "*Gyanesh Gaddar, Gyanesh Chor*" (Gyanesh traitor, Gyanesh thief), the police said.

Agra Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Bajrang Prasad said a case was registered at the Hari Parvat police station and Congress leaders Mukesh Dhangar and Anil Yadav were arrested.

Visuals of the Congress protest and the defacement were shared on social media.

J&K Assembly passes resolution on Statehood; BJP MLAs stage walkout

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

BJP MLAs walk out of the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly on Monday after the House passed a resolution on Statehood. PTI

Amid uproar from BJP legislators and opposing "official communiques from the J&K Law Secretary and the Chief Secretary", the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly on Monday passed a resolution seeking the restoration of "full Statehood", with around 60 of the 90 legislators supporting it.

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah warned against linking the restoration of Statehood to the end of militancy, saying it "unfortunately leaves our case before Islamabad and not New Delhi".

Sloganeering, protests in the well of the House, disruptions and a walkout by the 29 BJP legislators marked the proceedings. The Assembly met in the morning to discuss the resolution moved by Mr. Abdullah on September 25. BJP legislator R.S. Pathania submitted a notice to Speaker Abdul Rahim Rather and sought his removal, saying that "if the greater autonomy resolution was passed he (Mr. Rather) would no longer be eligible to occupy the chair".

Except for the BJP, all political parties, including the ruling National Conference (NC) ally Congress and the CPI(M) and non-allies the Peoples Democratic Party (PDP), the J&K Peoples Conference (JKPC), the Awami Ittehad Party (AIP) and the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), supported the resolution.

Mr. Abdullah said the resolution was "only on Statehood". "It's a carefully written resolution because we knew the BJP would try to disrupt the House and not participate in voting. Where in the resolution do we seek voting on Article 370, 35A or special status? We are seeking a vote on Statehood. Unfortunately, my own colleagues, who brought amendments to insert Article 370 and 35A, fall for the BJP's trap. I urge them not to press for amendments. It provides an excuse to the BJP," he said.

40 modules of Shahzad Bhatti gang busted: Shah

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

More than 40 modules linked to the Shahzad Bhatti network, allegedly involved in cross-border smuggling of weapons, explosives and narcotics, have been busted and 350 people arrested across 15 States, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said on Monday.

Mr. Shah said more than 100 First Information Reports had been registered against members of the network and that the Union government had declared the Shahzad Bhatti network a terrorist organisation under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA). Bhatti is a Pakistani social media influencer.

Bengal Cong. leader moves SC seeking a stay on SIR

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

An application was filed in the Supreme Court on Monday to constitute an independent panel with former judges of the top court, retired Chief Election Commissioners/Election Commissioners and experts to conduct a time-bound inquiry into the implementation of the special intensive revision (SIR) across 20 States and Union Territories.

The plea by Prasenjit Bose, petitioner in the West Bengal SIR case and chairperson of the West Bengal Pradesh Congress Committee's SIR panel, sought a stay of further proceedings on the SIR during the inquiry.

He sought to restore in the electoral roll the names of electors who had preferred appeals against their deletion before the Appellate Tribunals in West Bengal. Of the 22 lakh applications filed by deleted electors in West Bengal, only 1,607 electors had been reinstated in time to vote in April.

Gyanesh Kumar must step down, says Congress chief

CWC to discuss 'internal differences' in the EC, SIR exercise at meeting today; Kharge says issue concerns the entire country and 'existence of our democracy', and the party will fight it seriously

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Police use water cannons on Congress workers protesting alleged irregularities in the SIR of poll rolls, in Bhopal on Monday. PTI

The allegations against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the Election Commission are serious issues and linked to the survival of democracy in the country, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said on Monday.

Mr. Kharge has convened a meeting of the Congress Working Committee on Tuesday to discuss the "internal differences" in the EC, the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, and changes to Form 6 for new voter enrolment.

The meeting, the Congress president said, would also discuss the party's demand for Mr. Kumar's removal.

"The Election Commission's own people have exposed them," Mr. Kharge told presspersons, referring to concerns raised by the two Election Commissioners over aspects of the SIR exercise.

Mr. Kharge also flagged additions and deletions from the electoral rolls, and what he described as centralised control over the electoral roll database.

"I have called a Congress Working Committee meeting for tomorrow, where we will discuss the issue, and all the Working Committee members will give their suggestions. We are going to fight this seriously. This issue concerns the entire country, the existence of our democracy, and the survival of our country," he said.

The Congress has alleged that the SIR process could result in the exclusion of Gen Z voters, and has demanded Mr. Kumar's resignation. "Gyanesh Kumar should resign. We have to take action against him, even after his resignation," he said.

"The Election Commission is compromised and the Chief Election Commissioner is acting like a dictator. Without consulting his colleagues, Election Commissioners, and taking their views, the Chief Election Commissioner is acting like a dictator for the BJP, [Prime Minister] Narendra Modi and [Union Home Minister] Amit Shah. It's proved as it is not a Congress allegation, it's a statement by the Election Commissioners," Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said. "Gyanesh Kumar does not have any authority to continue and without any delay, he should resign," he added.

The party is also expected to discuss its strategy for intensifying pressure on the government over the issue, and preparations for the upcoming elections.

The Opposition Indian National Democratic, Inclusive Alliance is scheduled to meet on Wednesday to work out a joint strategy, and is likely to consider moving another removal notice against Mr. Kumar in Parliament.

SC, ST MPs from BJP took part in fewer debates in LS than party peers: data

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Days after Union Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi wrote to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla asking for more floor time for Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe MPs from the ruling National Democratic Alliance (NDA), an analysis reveals that BJP MPs elected from SC and ST seats have taken part in fewer Lok Sabha debates than the House average and than their own party colleagues.

An analysis of the PRS Legislative Research's MP Track data, from June 24, 2024, to August 23, 2026, by *The Hindu* reveals that the 24 BJP MPs from SC seats averaged 14.67 debates. The data exclude six Ministers from SC/ST constituencies. The 22 MPs from ST seats averaged 13.05. Together, the 46 MPs averaged 13.89, against 21.53 for all 483 sitting MPs.

Party colleagues from other seats did more. The 145 BJP MPs outside SC and ST seats averaged 19.68.

Jitan Ram Manjhi

Compared with all BJP MPs elected on non-reserved seats, SC-seat BJP MPs averaged 4.14 fewer debates (14.67 against 18.80). ST-seat BJP MPs averaged 5.92 fewer (13.05 against 18.96).

The 42-year-old Mahendra Singh Solanky, elected for a second time from Dewas, is the only one among the 46 MPs who has not participated in any debate.

An all-party problem

Nine are above the House average, with BJP MP from Palamau, Vishnu Dayal Ram, leading with 44 debates and Hemant Vishnu Savara of Palghar a close second with 43.

The pattern is not limited to the BJP. Across all parties, SC-seat MPs averaged 18.22 debates compared with 22.15 for others, and ST-seat MPs averaged 17.67 against 21.91.

The principal Opposition party Congress also recorded a gap, with MPs from SC seats averaging 19 against 23.38 for party peers. The Congress MPs from ST seats averaged 24.42, above the 22.22 of their peers.

In his letter dated September 16, Mr. Manjhi referred to an '*NDA sansad samooh samvaad baithak*' (NDA MP group dialogue meeting) held at his residence on August 5.

He said BJP Lok Sabha MP Gajendra Singh Patel, who represents Khargone, a reserved tribal constituency in Madhya Pradesh, had pointed out that MPs from SC/ST communities were not being given adequate time to speak during discussions on important Bills. Mr. Manjhi urged the Speaker to take steps to rectify the situation.

Civil society groups seek SIR rollback, say polls must use previous voter list

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Civil society members under banner 'Together We Stand' address a press conference on SIR in Delhi on Monday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Senior lawyers and civil society members on Monday demanded that the Election Commission (EC) roll back the special intensive revision (SIR) of voter lists across the country and restore every elector removed from the rolls as they existed prior to the SIR.

Addressing the media under the banner of "Together We Stand", they said that all forthcoming elections must happen on the basis of pre-SIR voter rolls, after a summary revision, if required, as was the practice prior to the SIR.

They also demanded the immediate resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, failing which proceedings to remove him should commence. "Now the time has come that the Supreme Court should scrap all decisions of the EC, as we know that they are not the decisions of the full Commission," senior lawyer Kapil Sibal said, referring to the recent report showing that the other two Election Commissioners had objected to a number of the poll body's decisions during the conduct of the SIR.

He added that the pre-SIR voter lists should be used for upcoming elections.

The activists also demanded a public social audit of the electoral roll as provided for in the Manual on Electoral Rolls issued in December 2023. "No voter must be removed without an open and public verification process at the level of gram sabha/ward sabha/booth, in the presence of [a block-level officer] BLO and [Electoral Registration Officer] ERO with facilities for immediate corrections of wrongful deletions," the manual says.

The groups also demanded the repeal of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023. An independent and credible inquiry must be conducted on the constitutionality and legality of all decisions taken under Mr. Gyanesh Kumar, they said.

They asked for every SIR-related document to be placed in the public domain, and also demanded restoration of welfare benefits to those who were wrongfully denied them because their names were deleted from the revised electoral rolls.

Opposition is harbouring a 'toolkit mentality', says BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

J.P. Nadda

Senior BJP leader and Union Minister J.P. Nadda on Monday accused the Opposition of harbouring a "toolkit mentality" and attempting to derail the country's progress.

At a press briefing, Mr. Nadda said Opposition leaders, specifically Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal, Samajwadi Party's Akhilesh Yadav, and Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee, had a "toolkit mentality".

He accused them of attempting to defame constitutional institutions and derail India's progress towards a Viksit Bharat. He said "their political strategy relies on fabricating falsehoods and vitiating the national atmosphere".

Expressing confidence that the people would continue to see through the "disruptive conspiracies", he said citizens would "decisively reject" such Opposition leaders.

'Fabricated allegations'

The BJP leader said that when the country was fulfilling the resolve of a Viksit Bharat through the tireless efforts of 140 crore Indians and India's achievements were being recognised across the globe, the Congress and its allies were "frustrated and disheartened".

He said that "all the fabricated allegations made by the Opposition have repeatedly collapsed when tested against facts".

"Lacking both policy and vision, they are now devising new conspiracies to spread confusion and disorder in the country. A few days ago, a completely fabricated story was used to create turmoil across the nation. Now, when all the members of the Election Commission have exposed each and every one of their false allegations, they have once again begun making fresh attempts to vitiate the atmosphere," the BJP leader alleged.

Ashamed to be part of Bihar govt., says Chirag

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Union Minister and Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) leader Chirag Paswan, an alliance partner of the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government in Bihar and the Centre, has attacked the State government over rising crimes against women.

Referring to the recent cases of molestation of minor girls in Jamui, Samastipur, Banka, and other districts, Mr. Paswan said these incidents brought shame to Bihar. Mr. Paswan said the government should set such a precedent that "the hands of criminals should shake" before committing any crime against girls.

'No fear'

"There is no fear of the police, and if there would be no fear, what kind of law and order is it? As an alliance partner, you can send me a notice; you can remove me from the government; it makes no difference to me, but I will raise this question," Mr. Paswan said at a private event on September 26.

"...I feel ashamed when I think about the fact that I am part of a government under which such incidents are taking place. This is a matter of concern," he added. After the BJP and Janata Dal (United), the LJP (RV) is the third-largest constituent of the Samrat Choudhary-led NDA government in Bihar, with 19 MLAs. It also has five MPs.

SC gives EC three months to settle Trinamool dispute

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court directed the Election Commission of India (EC) on Monday to decide the leadership dispute between former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, and Ritabrata Banerjee, who leads a rival camp of Trinamool Congress legislators, in three months, after the parties complete their pleadings.

The top court also gave the rival Trinamool Congress factions four weeks to file pleadings

A three-judge Bench headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant gave the rival factions four weeks from September 28 to file any additional responses, affidavits, counter-affidavits and other pleadings before the poll body.

Thereafter, the Bench ordered, the EC would take three months to "decide the controversy". The court refused repeated requests made by senior advocate D.S. Naidu, for the poll body, to at least give five or six months instead of the three-month window.

"In case of extreme exigencies, come before us," Justice Joymalya Bagchi addressed Mr. Naidu.

Decide disqualification petitions against MLAs by Oct. 8, SC tells Bengal Speaker

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday told the West Bengal Legislative Assembly Speaker to conclude by October 8 the disqualification proceedings initiated by former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee's Trinamool Congress faction against the rival Ritabrata Banerjee faction under the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution for alleged defection.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocates Kapil Sibal, Vivek Tankha and advocate Preetika Dwivedi, for the Mamata camp, said the top court had held in the *Keisham Meghachandra Singh versus Speaker, Manipur Legislative Assembly* judgment that the Speaker, acting as a Tribunal under the anti-defection law of the Tenth Schedule of Constitution, must decide disqualification petitions within a "reasonable time".

The court had suggested three months to be a reasonable time unless exceptional circumstances exist.

"The three months expire on October 8. This has become a pattern. The Speaker does not deal with the disqualification petitions. The rebel MLAs go to the Election Commission (EC) and get an interim order," Mr. Sibal submitted.

He was referring to an interim order of the EC on September 17 freezing the Trinamool party symbol.

But the Chief Justice expressed reluctance to intervene, saying it would instead pass an order expressing "hope that the Speaker will follow the law laid down in the *Meghachandra* judgement."

Mr. Sibal said the court must examine this "pattern" or it would create "political havoc".

BENGALURU SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT LIMITED
Office of the Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML, 1st Floor, BBMP Building, Thimmaiah Road, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 052
No: DGM-1/BSWML/PR/1079/2026-27 Date: 28.09.2026
TENDER CANCELLATION NOTIFICATION (Only through GOK KPP Portal Only)
This is to inform the general public and all concerned that Tender Notification No: **DGM-1/BSWML/TEND/25/2026-27**, issued by Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML on **23.09.2026** has been cancelled due to technical reasons.
Sd/-
Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML.
DIPR/CP/2975/Shirdi Sai/2026-27

Government of Odisha
"e" procurement Notice No-04
PH. No. 0674–2540603, E-mail Id: senhcnorth_bbsr@rediffmail.com
Identification No.04/CCE NH, NORTHERN of 2026-27

Sl. No.	Name of the Work	Value of Work (Rs. in lakh)	Period of completion (in calendar months)	Last date / Time for receipt of bids	Date of opening of tender	Name and address of the officer inviting tender
01	S/R to NH-57 from Km. 282/900 to 285/800 Km. in the State of Odisha for the year 2026-27.	186.67	04 (Four)	21.10.2026 upto 17.30 hours.	22.10.2026 AT 12.00 hours	Chief Construction Engineer, O/o the Chief Construction Engineer, Northern NH Circle, Unit-IX (Flat), Bhubaneswar-22.

02. Further details can be seen from the "e" procurement **website www.tendersodisha.gov.in** with effect **from 10.00 hours of 03.10.2026.**
03. Addendum / Corrigendum / Cancellation of tender if required shall be hosted in the aforesaid website only.
04. The authority reserves the right to cancel any / all bids without assigning any reason.
Chief Construction Engineer, Northern N.H.Circle, Bhubaneswar.
34001/891/2627 OIPR-34001/34188/1/26-27/0003

MAHATRANSCO Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
SRM E-Tender Notice (2nd Call)
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Company Ltd, EHV PC O&M Zone Vashi invites bids through SRM e-Tender in two bid system (Techno-commercial Bid & Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for following works;

RFx No./ Tender No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost
7000041507 T-12/2026-27	Augmentation of substation by addition of 50MVA, 220/22kV PTR along with 1X 220kV GIS bay and 22kV GIS Consisting 6X 22kV feeder bay, 1X 22kV Incomer Bay, 1X 22kV PT bay, 1X 22kV Bus Coupler bay & interconnector bay along with allied Civil works at 220/22kV Kamba Substation under EHV (O&M) Division, Kalwa Vashi Zone (Transformer will be supplied by MSETCL).	Rs 1577.41 Lakhs excluding GST Rs 1861.35 Lakhs including GST

E.M.D. in Rs. 15,77,415/-, **Tender Fees:** Rs. 29,500/- including GST, **Sale period:** 28.09.2026 to 08.10.2026, **Last Date of Submission:** 08.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs, **Date of opening (Tech. bid):** 08.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. (if possible). **Contact person:** Executive Engineer, EHV PC O&M Zone, Vashi. Phone No. (022) 27666010 (P) / 27665994. For further details please visit to **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in**
Sd/-
Chief Engineer
EHV PC (O&M) Zone, MSETCL, Vashi

INBRIEF

Court seeks Brij Bhushan's reply on plea by wrestlers

A Delhi court on Monday sought responses from former BJP MP and ex-Wrestling Federation of India president Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh and co-accused Vinod Tomar on an appeal filed by four women wrestlers against their acquittal in a sexual harassment case. Special Judge Digvinay Singh of the Rouse Avenue Court issued notices to the two. The wrestlers have challenged the trial court's August 3, 2026, verdict acquitting Mr. Singh and Mr. Tomar of the charges of sexual harassment. The wrestlers have questioned the reasoning behind the verdict, alleging that the court relied on assumptions and overlooked important aspects of the prosecution's evidence.

Doctor assault: court cancels bail of Shiv Sena corporator

The Supreme Court on Monday cancelled the bail of Shiv Sena corporator Ramesh Sukrya Mhatre, who is facing trial for allegedly attacking three municipal doctors in Thane, Maharashtra, and directed him to surrender before the police within three days. The case stems from an alleged assault on three doctors at Shastri Nagar Hospital in Dombivli on July 6. "The message should go out loud and clear that the medical fraternity cannot be touched," a Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta said while hearing the Maharashtra government's appeal seeking cancellation of his bail.

Collegium proposes 3 HC Chief Justices for elevation to SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Justice Sunita Agarwal

The Supreme Court Collegium, headed by the Chief Justice of India, Surya Kant, on Monday recommended Gujarat High Court Chief Justice Sunita Agarwal for appointment as a Supreme Court judge.

The September 28 recommendation makes it the second time in 2026 that a woman has been proposed to serve on the Supreme Court Bench. The last time the court saw multiple appointments of women in the same year was in 2021, when Justices Hima Kohli, B.V. Nagarathna, and Bela M. Trivedi were recommended and appointed together.

In May 2026, Chief Justice Kant's Collegium had successfully recommended then senior advocate V. Mohana's direct elevation from the Bar to an apex court judgeship. Justice Mohana was appointed along with four other judges to the Supreme Court, the sanctioned strength of which has been increased to 38 judges, including the Chief Justice of India.

Chief Justice Kant's Collegium also has Justice B.V. Nagarathna among its five members. Justice Nagarathna is in the line of seniority to be the first woman Chief Justice of India in 2027. Justice Agarwal has been recommended first among the batch of three recommended by the Collegium on Monday. The other two are Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya, the Chief Justice of Delhi High Court, and Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh, the Chief Justice of the Telangana High Court.

Justice Upadhyaya had conducted the preliminary enquiry into allegations against former Delhi HC judge, Justice Yashwant Varma, after sacks of half-burnt currency were allegedly found at his official residence Justice Singh's parent High Court is Jharkhand while that of both Justices Agarwal and Upadhyaya is the Allahabad High Court.

15 arrested after clashes over razing portion of M.P. mosque

Clashes flared up when a group began removing an overhang, triggering protests; Ujjain police say tensions were fuelled by rumours that authorities were using bulldozers to demolish the mosque

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

Security arrangements are in place across sensitive areas in Ujjain; officials say the situation remains peaceful and under control. ANI

The police arrested 15 persons, including five content creators, and filed eight FIRs in Madhya Pradesh's Ujjain on Monday after a group clashed with security personnel ahead of the demolition of a portion of the Shahi Mosque for a road-widening project, as part of preparations for the Simhastha Kumbh Mela in 2028.

The situation is now peaceful, but heavy security arrangements remain in place in sensitive areas, officials told *The Hindu*.

Clashes erupted when a few community members began removing a three-foot overhang of the mosque near the Mahakaleshwar Temple following an agreement with the administration on Sunday night. But another section started protesting. Some security personnel were injured in stone-throwing.

Later in the day, a Division Bench of the Madhya Pradesh High Court in Indore disposed of two petitions from Muslim representatives after they informed the court that the matter had been settled with the Ujjain Municipal Corporation.

Ujjain Inspector-General of Police, Rakesh Gupta, told *The Hindu* that the situation was brought under control by using mild force, including baton charge, and tear gas.

A group also protested outside the residence of the city qazi Khaliq-ur-Rahman and threw stones, he said.

Mr. Gupta said tensions were caused by a rumour that the administration was using bulldozers on the mosque. "Several meetings had been held with the representatives of the Muslim community in the past few days and on Sunday night, it had been agreed upon that they themselves will remove the necessary portions. But members of the community had started to gather on their roofs in the morning and when the community representatives started to break the portions, a section of the community, mostly youth, tried to march toward the mosque and created nuisance," he said.

Superintendent of Police Pradeep Sharma said the situation was brought under control before 9 a.m., after which demolition work started.

An FIR was lodged on a complaint from Mr. Rahman, he said. "Eleven people, including three named accused, have been booked under non-bailable warrant in this FIR."

He said that five FIRs have been lodged against five content creators and more than 100 social media posts have been blocked. Two FIRs have been lodged in connection with the clashes with the police.

"About 20 named accused have been identified so far in the cases and about 15 of them have been arrested. Other suspects are being identified with CCTV and other footage and they will be taken into custody soon. The social media cell has been monitoring content for the past several days and will continue to do so," Mr. Sharma added.

He also said that more than 2,500 personnel are currently deployed in the area, and the demolition is being carried out by the community members.

How can children have social media accounts, asks court

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned how Indian children can have accounts on social media platforms, given that these accounts are activated on the basis of contracts drawn up between the children and the platforms despite the fact that minors are legally incompetent to enter contracts under Indian law.

Such contracts are completely void from the beginning or void *ab initio*, noted a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

"What are these social media platforms doing? Are they permitting children as young as 12 years to 15 years to have accounts? And what is an 'account'? It is a contract between the social media platform and a child," Justice Joymalya Bagchi said, addressing the Union government side, represented by Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta.

Digital safeguards

The court was hearing a plea filed by the NGO Just Rights for Children Alliance (JRCA), represented by senior advocate H.S. Phoolka, seeking safeguards for children accessing social media.

The Solicitor-General submitted that the issue raised in the petition was, *prima facie*, covered by the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, but Mr. Phoolka argued that they come into force only in 2027.

Justice Bagchi, addressing the law officer, said that the government should pass some directions under the Intermediary Rules, ensuring that platforms conform to the 18-year minimum threshold.

SC questions food safety regulator over delay in warning label roll-out

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) over its proposed timeline of nearly two years for implementing front-of-pack warning labels (FoPL) on packaged foods, asking why it wanted to "waste so much time" on fresh public and industry consultations when the issue concerned citizens' health.

The court's remarks came as it pressed the food safety regulator to expedite the introduction of warning labels on packaged foods high in sugar, salt, and saturated fat.

Responding to the court's September 10 order, the FSSAI said in an affidavit filed last week that the draft regulations would require a four-month process of consultation and finalisation.

> Why voluntary compliance for a year? Why do you need so much time? Why do you want to start afresh with the exercise of hearing and calling for objections? You started in 2022. What did you do in the last four years?
>
> SUPREME COURT

It proposed notifying the labelling norms by July 1 next year, following which food business operators would be given another 365 days to transition to the new regime to ensure minimal hardship.

"Why voluntary compliance for a year? Why do you need so much time? Why do you want to start afresh with the exercise of hearing and calling for objections? You started in 2022. What did you do in the last four years," a Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran asked while reserving its order in the matter.

PIL petition

The top court was hearing a public interest litigation (PIL) petition filed by the non-profit organisation 3S and Our Health Society, seeking the introduction of FoPL guidelines on the lines of those in force in foreign jurisdictions.

The petitioner, represented by advocate Rajiv Shankar Dwivedi, has argued that such labels are necessary to warn children and other consumers about packaged foods containing high levels of salt, sugar, and saturated fat, and their potential adverse health effects.

Additional Solicitor-General Brijender Chahar, appearing for the Centre and the FSSAI, explained that the exercise initiated in 2022 concerned the Indian Nutrition Rating (star-rating) system and was based on a different yardstick from the warning-label regime now under consideration.

The Bench further made it clear that its forthcoming directions would be binding on the regulator, and said it expected the FSSAI to implement them "scrupulously" and in their "true spirit". The court also indicated that it would keep the matter pending to monitor compliance with its directions.

"Do not disappoint us on the day when the matter comes up for reporting compliance," the Bench said.

HC refuses to review order on micro, nano plastics warning

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Monday dismissed a petition filed by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), urging the court to review its order mandating drinking water, sugar, and salt sold in plastic bottles and packets to contain a warning in bold and red letters that read: "This water/sugar/salt may contain micro/nano plastics."

A special Division Bench of Justices N. Sathish Kumar and D. Bharatha Chakravarthy dismissed the review application after observing that the court had not concluded that water, sugar or salt becomes unsafe because of the plastic packaging but had only ordered issuance of a warning on the labels so that the consumers could take an informed decision before consumption.

Filing the application through Central government senior panel counsel V. Chandrasekaran, FSSAI had contended that research on the subject remained inconclusive, and hence, it may not be appropriate to cause "public panic" by displaying such warnings.

It also said a report relied upon by the court to issue such a direction on February 6, 2026, was only a review of various papers written by different scholars worldwide and that the review does not conclusively establish harmful effects on the human body.

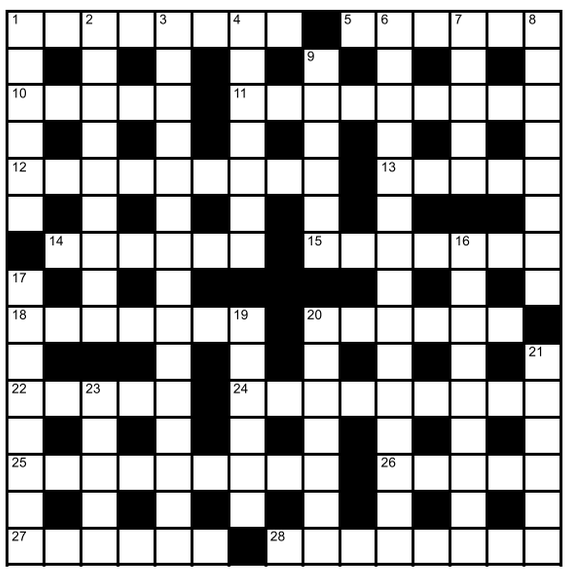
The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and the FSSAI had initially approached the Supreme Court challenging the High Court's direction. However, the top court on May 18 had dismissed the special leave petition.

TH CROSSWORD + 14910

(set by Dr. X)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Girl eating ham rolls with bit of hummus in mess (8)
5 Posh, expensive fur is available (6)
10 Turns reel back (5)
11 Need information about Latin winner of a beauty contest (4,5)
12 Private investigator's imperfect, time to replace fellow (9)
13 Cancel extremely outspoken former US president (5)
14 Kneels and proposes finally with ring in revolutionary scene (6)
15 Lame boy saved by remarkable ladies (7)
18 Fretted with limited parking inside (7)
20 Control British director overwhelmed by anger (6)
22 Deserves angry answer after ignoring wife (5)
24 Patch filled with weed destroyed flowering plant (9)
25 I catch associate on date cuddling wife! Getting very upset (2,1,3,3)
26 Order a large gin on the rocks (5)
27 Small note about special metamorphic rock (6)
28 Ass hadn't changed receptacle used by smokers (3-5)

Down

1 Married woman has a complaint (6)
2 Baseball fielder in thigh-length trousers and T-shirt (9)
3 Very pleasing information that DJ will bring? (5,2,4,4)
4 Discussions with executives about money matters at inauguration (7)
6 Swilling wine, lass woos date to indulge in youthful dissipation (3,4,4,4)
7 Mineral in container contains radium (5)
8 Break off with indignation and threaten (8)
9 Climb with foremost of climbers in Andes easily (6)
16 Dancer is bare in rave, captivating everyone (9)
17 Gifts new Frisbee to entertain teens at centre (8)
19 Abandon ideals on vacation, enthralled by drink (6)
20 Sleep beside babe on vacation in retreat? Certainly! (3-4)
21 Copied single in compact disc (6)
23 Insect egg in vehicle repulsed husband (5)

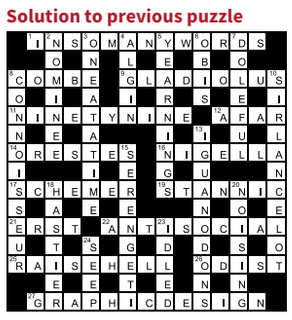
SUDOKU

			9					
5	7			3	6			
9				8		2		
	1		6	9				7
	6	9				4	1	
7				5	3		6	
		6		4				9
			3	1			7	2
					5			

No.SS7017 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

5	6	7	9	8	3	2	4	1
4	9	3	2	5	1	6	7	8
2	8	1	6	4	7	9	3	5
3	4	8	5	6	2	7	1	9
9	7	2	3	1	8	5	6	4
1	5	6	7	9	4	3	8	2
8	2	9	1	7	6	4	5	3
7	1	5	4	3	9	8	2	6
6	3	4	8	2	5	1	9	7

FAITH

Open heart to Perumal

Perumal is the epitome of forgiveness and when one beseeches Him to forgive one's mistakes with full contrition, He obliges. The legend of the three asuras – Thanjagan, Thandakan and Gajamugan – is a case in point. All three undertook severe penance, received Siva's blessings and went on to harass everyone. When sages prayed to Vishnu, He descended on earth, vanquished them and remained on earth as three different resident deities, Neelamega Perumal, Manikundra Perumal and Veera Nrisimha Perumal, with all three temples falling under one Divya Desam called Thanjai Mamani Koil, said Tirukkudanthai Dr. Venkatesh.

Coming out of his hideout, with an elephant face, Gajamugan began to torture devotees. Perumal took the form of a lion-faced man and destroyed Gajamugan, in the manner that He vanquished Hiranyakasipu. He then stood with one foot planted on the ground and the other resting firmly upon a rock, His two hands on His knees. The minute His fingernails touched his skin, Gajamugan's entire life flashed in front of his eyes and he asked Perumal to forgive his sins. Veera Nrisimha used His nails to incise and remove the sins attached to Gajamugan. Perumal came to be celebrated as Thanjaiyali Perumal (Yali refers to one who rules over everyone). Both Tirumangai Azhwar and Boothathazhwar have sung verses on Thanjaiyali Perumal. Why did Perumal come here to reside as archa murti? Perumal wanted to reside in the hearts of the devotees who come here, with their thoughts fully focused on Him. For God to reside in one's heart, one should keep the door (heart) open for Him to walk in.

INBRIEF

UAE signals another $25 bn investment in India: Goyal

The UAE has indicated its intent to invest an additional $25 billion in India in the near future, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal said on Monday, as the two countries agreed to deepen cooperation across ports, shipbuilding, energy security, space technology and financial services. Speaking after co-chairing the 14th India-UAE High-Level Joint Task Force on Investments with Abu Dhabi Investment Authority MD Sheikh Hamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Mr. Goyal said the UAE has already invested around $25 billion in India and has a longer-term objective of taking its investments in the country to $100 billion. The discussions at the task force meeting covered investments, trade facilitation, taxation, logistics, energy, market access and financial cooperation, including use of local currency for bilateral trade.

NMDC commissions 2 MTPA pellet plant in Nagarnar

NMDC has commissioned a 2 million tonne per annum pellet plant in Nagarnar, Chhattisgarh, as part of a ₹5,427-crore integrated iron ore processing, pipeline and pellet making project connecting its iron ore operations in Bacheli with the company's steel plant in Nagarnar. The project includes a new iron ore processing plant in Bacheli, a 15 MTPA slurry pipeline besides the 2 MTPA pellet plant. The 135 km slurry pipeline carries processed iron ore concentrate from Bacheli to Nagarnar, providing an alternative to transporting the material by road, the company said on Sunday. The slurry pipeline passes through 61 villages in Bastar and Dantewada districts and is designed to reduce the movement of processed ore by road, provide alternate mode of evacuation and lower dependency on railways and ensures a dedicated link between Bacheli operations and Nagarnar, NMDC said.

Industrial growth quickens to 8% in Aug.

The growth in August is the second-highest for the period going back to April 2024, for which the new series of the IIP has data

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Industrial growth in India quickened to 8% in August 2026 from 7.35% a month earlier, driven by a strong performance in the manufacturing, electricity, capital goods, and consumer goods sectors.

Growth in the Index of Industrial Production, data on which was released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation on Monday, was last quicker in June 2026 when it touched 8.8%.

The growth in August is the second-highest for the period going back to April 2024 for which the new series of the IIP has data.

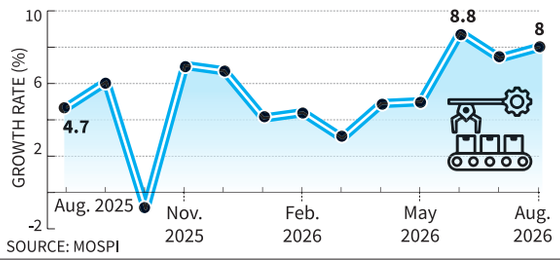
"This [August growth] was aided by sharp growth in capital goods, intermediate, infrastructure, and consumer durable goods," Madan Sabnavis, chief economist at the Bank of Baroda said. "For the five months period, growth was at 6.7%," Mr. Sabnavis added. "If this is maintained, India can register growth of 7-8% for the year on the back of higher growth during the festival season with demand building up. This makes the third quarter very critical for industry." The manufacturing sector grew at 8.95% in August 2026, the second-highest in the history of the new series of the IIP after the 9.5% seen in June 2026. A deeper look showed that the growth in the sector was driven by motor vehicles, electric and non-electric machinery, electronics, textiles, beverages, rubber, and non-metallic products.

The electricity sector saw growth quicken to a 27-month-high of 12.3% in August 2026, which, according to Mr. Sabnavis, was supported by growth in both conventional and renewable electricity.

The capital goods sector grew by 16.9%, which was however a three-month low.

Growth uptick

India's industrial growth in August 2026 is the second-highest since April 2024, the earliest period for which there is data



SOURCE: MOSPI

Tata Trusts proposes recast of Tata Sons to avoid listing

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Tata Trusts, the majority shareholder of Tata Sons Private Limited with a 66% stake, has proposed a restructuring plan aimed at retaining the holding company's private status and avoiding a potential listing requirement under Reserve Bank of India (RBI) regulations.

The plan involves merging two Tata Group entities – Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Private Limited (TESS) and Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE) – with Tata Sons, thereby changing its regulatory classification. Tata Trusts has written to the Tata Sons board seeking approval of the proposal and initiating the process of obtaining the RBI's no-objection certificate. The proposed reorganisation is aimed at ensuring that Tata Sons ceases to qualify as either a Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC) or a Core Investment Company (CIC), categories that bring additional regulatory obligations, including compliance with listing norms for certain entities.

A view of Bombay House, the headquarters of the Tata Group

According to Tata Trusts, the merged entity would have operating revenues of ₹1.05 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026, significantly higher than income from financial assets at ₹40,072 crore. This would ensure that financial investments do not constitute the dominant source of income, helping Tata Sons move outside the principal business criteria for an NBFC. The Trusts said the amalgamated entity would also not meet the criteria for a CIC. Its net assets would stand at ₹2 lakh crore, with investments in group companies accounting for ₹1.77 lakh crore – below the 90% threshold required for CIC classification.

The restructuring marks a return to Tata Sons' earlier operating model, where the holding company also housed businesses and generated operating revenues. Tata Trusts pointed out that for nearly eight decades of its 100-year history, Tata Sons had operated businesses alongside its role as the group's holding entity.

"Tata Consultancy Services was a business division of Tata Sons until 2004 before being demerged into a separate subsidiary," the Trusts said, adding that several other Tata businesses followed a similar structure in the past.

The move comes amid regulatory pressure on Tata Sons after RBI classified it as an upper-layer NBFC and mandated enhanced compliance requirements.

The company had been exploring various options, including a possible public listing, to meet regulatory obligations.

West Asia worries send benchmark indices to six-month low

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Indian equity markets came under renewed selling pressure on Monday as escalating uncertainty over the West Asia conflict weighed on investor sentiment after the U.S. rejected proposals for a ceasefire.

The benchmark Sensex fell 1.52% to close at 72,771.72 points, while the Nifty50 declined 1.6% to settle at 22,780.25, extending losses from the previous session.

The indices opened nearly 100 points below their previous closes and slipped further during morning trade, with the Sensex briefly nearing the 72,000 mark and the Nifty approaching 22,000 levels by around 10:30 am. The benchmarks remained largely range-bound near the day's lows before closing lower. Monday's decline marked the second instance in the past five trading sessions and the third in the last ten sessions when the benchmark indices fell more than 1%, highlighting renewed weakness after a prolonged phase of range-bound movement.

Selling pressure was broad-based, with all 21 sectoral indices on the NSE ending in the red. The Nifty Bank index declined nearly 2%, reflecting pressure across financial stocks. Of the 3,676 stocks traded on the NSE, more than 2,700 ended lower, while only around 896 stocks advanced, signalling a broad negative sentiment. Market participants attributed the sharp decline to concerns that the rejection of a ceasefire proposal by the U.S. could prolong tensions in West Asia.

Tewolde's flight plan: cost saving, deeper AI–AI Express synergies

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

Cost cutting and deeper integration between Air India (AI) and low-cost arm Air India Express (AI Express) will be at the centre of CEO-designate Tewolde Gebremariam's agenda, with the new AI chief calling for shared services, greater asset utilisation and organisation-wide focus on cutting duplication and improving efficiency.

In his first town hall with staff, Mr. Gebremariam said AI and AI Express should operate as 'multiple brands with a single unit of production,' with the two airlines retaining distinct customer-facing identities while sharing resources wherever possible, sources said.

Tewolde Gebremariam

While AI will continue as a full-service carrier and AI Express as low-cost carrier, he said customer-facing functions would remain distinct while areas such as IT, HRD, finance and engineering could be streamlined and shared.

"The objective would be to reduce costs and strengthen the airlines' competitiveness," he said.

Whether the two airlines ultimately operate with one Air Operator Certificate (AOC) or retain two was "secondary" to achieving operational synergies.

"Cost saving is top on the agenda," he said, urging staff to identify and propose cost-saving opportunities and help build a stronger culture of cost consciousness.

'No burning cash'

He also linked cost agenda with the wider financial challenge, saying, "We cannot continue to lose money. We cannot continue to burn cash."

On revenue, he called for an urgent improvement in revenue/available seat kilometre (RASK) and greater use of cargo as a revenue stream, saying AI was losing to foreign freighters.

Safety and reliability, meanwhile, stay core priorities, with Mr. Gebremariam calling for consistent operational performance, including clean and safe aircraft, on-time departures and arrivals, baggage travelling with passengers and better disruption recovery.

He also described growth as 'the oxygen of business' while stressing it must be profitable and sustainable. The CEO further called for a "One Air India" approach, a leaner and flatter organisation, fewer silos and reviews of outsourcing, IT systems and internal processes.

SEBI clears Vinod Adani of charges in shareholding case

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) cleared Vinod Adani, elder brother of Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani, of allegations relating to the violation of minimum public shareholding (MPS) norms and Prohibition of Fraudulent and Unfair Trade Practices (PFUTP) regulations.

In its final order, SEBI said the "foundational allegations" of effective control by Vinod Adani over two foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) and Opal Investment Pvt. Ltd. were not established. Consequently, the regulator did not uphold the allegation the MPS norms of listed Adani Group firms were violated.

SEBI said the role played by Vinod Adani was advisory.

The case involved allegations against 30 noticees, including individuals, foreign investment funds and Adani Group entities. The primary charge was Mr. Vinod Adani exercised control over investments made by two FPIs – Excel Investment and Global Opportunities Management Ltd (GMAML) – in three Adani Group firms: Adani Enterprises, Adani Power and Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone.

The allegation was this investment was in violation of SEBI regulations, which do not allow promoters to hold more than 25% in listed entities.

Rejecting the charge, SEBI said the role played by Vinod Adani in relation to the two FPIs was advisory in nature and based on non-binding pacts. Separately, SEBI settled alleged MPS violations involving 18 noticees named in the order. The settlement included Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani.

India has over 80 days of fuel reserve, says Minister Puri

Saptaparno Ghosh
KOLKATA

India has more than 80 days of fuel reserves, said Hardeep Singh Puri, Union Petroleum Minister at an event here.

"The number of refineries has grown, import terminals have grown and I am sometimes asked why isn't the country's SPR bigger?" he stated, adding,

"Please combine everything, we have more than eighty plus days [worth] of capacity to store," the Minister added.

(The reporter is in Kolkata at the invitation of the Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas)

Indian Overseas Bank
Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, ANNA SALAI, CHENNAI-600002
www.iob.bank.in

Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:

GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - TECHNOLOGY UPGRADATION OF TRENDMICRO INTRUSION PREVENTION SYSTEM (IPS) SOLUTION.

BID NO: GEM/2026/B/8074775
DATED 23.09.2026

The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE
Office of the Chief Engineer (Commercial & Tariff),
Vydyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram
Inviting Long term Power procurement of 500 MW RTC Power (Coal linkage under B(1V) of SHAKTI Policy), through e-bidding portal (DEEP) only
DEEP portal e -Tender No – KSEBL/Long/Coal from CIL/26-27/ET/RFQ/75 & KSEBL/Long/Coal from CIL/26-27/ET/RFP/76 dtd 23.09.2026.
Last Date for submission of queries - 17.10.2026
Submission of the Request for Proposal (RFP) through the DEEP Portal – 29.12.2026.
For more details visit www.kseb.in
Ref : PR/MC1/F-402 /2026

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, R.S.A.M.B., DIVISION BIKANER
Rajkaj Ref No. :- 24702245 Date :- 25/09/2026
NOTICE INVITING BID- 08/2026-27
Bids for Link Roads under KUMS Nokha, Bikaner (Grain), Pugal Road Grain Bikaner, Sridungargarh and Repair Works of Office Building, KUMS Bikaner F&V amounting from Rs. 15.50 to 508.37 Lakhs are invited from eligible interested bidders upto dated 14.10.2026/26.10.2026, 06.00 PM. Other particulars of the bids may be visited on the procurement portal (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in) and RSAMB website http://agriculture.rajasthan.gov.in/rsamb for detailed NIB.
UBN : AGM2627WSOB00866 to 870
Raj.Samwad/C/26/10818 EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LIMITED
CIN:- U40102RJ2000SGCO16484 (A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
O/o SE(TD-III), 604, Investment Building, Lalkothi, Tonk Road, Jaipur
E-TENDER NOTICE
Online tenders are invited for TN-38(RVU2627GLOB01315) Procurement of MILD STEEL/ CARBON STEEL ITEMS INCLUDING PLATE, ANGLE, CHANNEL AND BEAM etc. FOR VARIOUS RVUN POWER STATIONS & 39(RVU2627GLOB01311) Procurement of SS items including plate, bar items etc. FOR VARIOUS RVUN POWER STATIONS. Tender details are available on http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in (for e-tender), www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/rvunl & www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/10860 RVUN/PR-4476 Superintending Engineer (TD-III)

कार्यालय नगर परिषद बून्दी
क्रमांकः— 7032 दिनांकः— 24.09.2026
-:: Corrigendum ::-
नगर परिषद बून्दी द्वारा जारी निविदा संः न0प0बू0/निर्माण/2026–27 /5456 दिनांक 10/08/2026 की निविदा दिनांक 17/08/2026 से दिनांक 02/09/2026 06.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन विक्रय की जानी थी। निविदा दिनांक 08/09/2026 को 04.00 बजे ऑनलाईन खोली जानी थी। उक्त निविदा में संशोधन करते हुए निविदा दिनांक 21.10.2026 को 6.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन विक्रय की जावेगी। उक्त कार्य की BG (Bank Guarantee) दिनांक 22.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे दिनांक 23.10.2026 को 6.00 बजे तक जमा करवाई जा सकती है। निविदा दिनांक 26.10.2026 को 4.00 बजे ऑनलाईन खोली जावेगी। विस्तृत शर्ते व विवरण निविदा sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर DLB2627WLOB18533 (Tender ID 2026_DLB_588804_1) तथा कार्यालय समय मे किसी भी कार्यदिवस को नगर परिषद मे देखा जा सकता है।
आयुक्त
नगर परिषद, बून्दी
राज.संवाद/सी/26/10792

ANDHRA PRADESH POWER COORDINATION COMMITTEE
VIDYUTH SOUDHA : VIJAYAWADA
TENDER NOTICE
APPCC on behalf of the APDISCOMs inviting bids in single stage, two enveloped followed by e-RA through Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal vide Tender No: APPCC/BESS-01/2026-27 for Procurement of 1,000 MW / 4,000 MWh (4-hour) storage capacity from fully commissioned Standalone BESS projects located anywhere in India through a tariff-based competitive bidding process, on-demand utilization by APDISCOMs, for a period of 2 years extendable for another period of 2 years with input power from APDISCOMs. The Interested and eligible applicants may participate in the bidding process through the ISN-ETS (Bharat Electronic e-Tendering) Portal and the Bid documents are available after 29.09.2026 at 19:00 hrs. The due date for submission of bids is 14.10.2026. For complete details and tender access visit: https://www.bharat-electronictender.com Ph: 9493120085.
Sd/- Chief General Manager/APPCC
Power Purchase & Legal
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/159/26-27

APPOINTMENT

Indian Overseas Bank
Central Office, 763, Anna Salai, Chennai – 600002
www.iob.bank.in
ENGAGEMENT OF ADVISOR – CUSTOMER SERVICE ON CONTRACT BASIS
Indian Overseas Bank, a leading Public Sector Bank with headquarters in Chennai having geographical presence all over India and abroad, invites applications from **eligible candidates retired from Public Sector Banks** for the captioned recruitment process. The detailed advertisement regarding eligibility such as Age, Qualification, Experience & Other requirements are available in the Bank's website www.iob.bank.in under "Careers" page. APPLY ONLINE.
Online Registration: 29.09.2026 – 09.10.2026 (Both days inclusive)

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(CIN:U40109KA1999SGC025521)
No. CEE/T&P/SEE-1/2026-27/6887-902 Date:28.09.2026
BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)
KPTCL Invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on **Partial Turnkey basis.**

Sl. No.	Enquiry Nos. and Name of the works
1	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4234 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at **KHB Irubanahalli (Halalu)** with associated 66kV LILO line for a distance of **0.235km** in Nagamangala Taluk, Mandya District.
2	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4240 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at **Beerihundi (K. Hemmanhally)** with associated 66kV LILO line for a distance of **6.376kms** in Mysuru Taluk & District.
3	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4239 Establishing 2x31.5MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at **Singanayakanahalli (Madappanahalli)** along with running of 66kV 1000sqmm UG Cable from existing 220/66/11kV Puttenahalli (Yelahanka) sub-station to the proposed 66/11kV Singanayakanahalli (Madappana halli) sub-station for a distance of **6.35kms** & Modification of 66kV Terminal Bay at existing 220/66/11kV Puttenahalli (Yelahanka) sub-station in Bengaluru North Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District.

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website **https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in** with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** on or after **01.10.2026 @ 15:00hrs. Last date & time for receipt of Bids and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP portal.** Any details required in this regard can also be obtained from the office of the undersigned during office hours.
All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.
Sd/- Chief Engineer,(Electy),
Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor,
Indhana Bhavan, A. R. Circle, Bengaluru-560 009.

KYAUKTAW

33 killed in military air strike in Myanmar's Rakhine: rebel group

AFP

A military air strike on a market in the town of Kyauktaw in Myanmar's Rakhine State killed 33 people on Monday and wounded 36 more, according to Arakan Army, the rebel faction which controls the area. Nearly half-a-million people are living displaced in the State due to the civil war unleashed by a 2021 military coup. AFP

FAIRFORD

Iran denies link to alleged bomb plot at U.S.-operated airbase in U.K.

AFP

Iran on Monday denied involvement in a suspected bomb plot at U.K.'s Royal Air Force Fairford base used by the U.S, as police said five men arrested nearby were all London-based Britons. Tehran's denial, issued via its embassy in London, followed widespread U.K. media reports that police were probing possible Iranian links. AFP

JERUSALEM

Netanyahu met UAE President in unannounced trip: Israeli media

REUTERS

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu had made an unannounced trip to the UAE to meet President Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Israeli media reported on Sunday. The visit follows reports that the Emirati leader warned Mr. Netanyahu ahead of Hamas's October 7 attack, but the Israeli premier failed to inform security services. AFP

WASHINGTON

Trump offered to sell weapons to China during Xi visit: U.S. envoy

AFP

U.S. President Donald Trump offered to sell arms to his Chinese counterpart Xi Jinping in response to concern over weapons sales to Taiwan. "President Trump said, 'Hey, we sell arms to people around the world.' He actually asked President Xi would he like to buy some?" U.S. Ambassador to China David Perdue told Fox News. AFP

U.S. will be forced out, says Mojtaba as mediators work to broker a deal

Iran's Supreme Leader says 'enemy forces suffered painful blows' in first remarks since Trump rejected Tehran's proposal; Qatari mediators are expected to hold separate discussions with Iranian Minister Araghchi in New York and the U.S. side

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei said on Monday the United States would be forced to leave West Asia after suffering "painful blows", according to a statement carried by state television.

Mr. Khamenei made the remarks despite attempts to revive talks aimed at ending the fighting.

"Today, having suffered painful blows at the hands of valiant fighters and the guardians of the Strait of Hormuz, they (the enemies) do not venture beyond the Arabian Sea," Mr. Khamenei said in the written statement attributed to him, without explicitly mentioning the U.S.

Tehran transit: Commuters drive past a portrait of Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei at Baharestan Square in Iran's capital. AFP

"Whenever they have braved this risk, they have only brought harm upon themselves. It will not be long before the Arabian Sea, too, would rid itself of their presence," he added.

Iran and the U.S have been vying for control over Hormuz since the war started with U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran in February. Before the war began, the strategic shipping route carried about a fifth of the world's oil and gas.

Meanwhile, Qatari mediators are expected to hold separate talks with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi in New York and with the U.S. side on Monday or Tuesday, an official briefed on the negotiations said.

Iran's semi-official ISNA news agency also confirmed that Mr. Araghchi would meet the mediators.

Seven-day proposal

The talks are expected to focus on an amended version of a seven-day proposal that Iran presented last week on the sidelines of the the UN General Assembly. Iran's plan envisages ending all hostilities in Iran and Lebanon, unfreezing of its foreign assets, lifting sanctions on its oil sector, and an end to the U.S. naval blockade. Tehran would then reopen Hormuz, and the two sides would resume talks on Iran's nuclear programme.

U.S. President Donald Trump said on Saturday he had rejected Iran's proposal, saying Tehran wanted a swift agreement because of the crippling economic pressure it is under. However, he also told Axios on Sunday that he expected U.S. negotiators to engage in further talks this week.

(With inputs from Reuters)

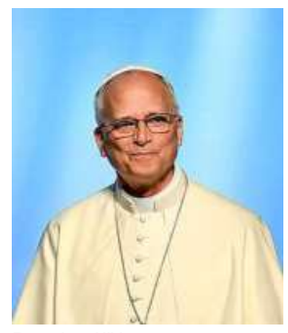
Pope urges Europeans to welcome migrants as family

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

Pope Leo XIV called for a more welcoming attitude towards migrants in Europe as he concluded a four-day visit to France.

Speaking in Metz, once the home of Robert Schuman, one of the European Union's founding fathers and a proponent of reconciliation after the Second World War, the Pope criticised calls by leaders to increase arms expenditure, saying it was contrary to the process of peace through dialogue. The head of the Catholic Church was accompanied to Metz by French President Emmanuel Macron.

"We see many men and women fleeing war and persecution," the Pope said, citing the case of the Canary Islands, which has seen an influx of migrants from Africa.



Pope Leo XIV

"We need to welcome people. We need to integrate them as a member of our own family, giving them the possibility to develop their skills and live according to their values," he added.

In an apparent nod to the EU's official policies, the Pope acknowledged the need to fight human trafficking and to implement policies that will allow people to live on their own lands. He also said that migrants needed to be taught the history of the lands they are joining, and he called for dialogue between different groups.

His remarks come as the far right in Europe is making surges. France's own nativist party, National Rally, won a record 14 seats in the Senate over the weekend, giving it the right to form a legislative caucus.

The Pope also made veiled references to his opposition to abortion and the assisted dying, asking people to "love life at every moment" and to "fight for life". Speaking on Sunday in Lourdes, the Pope had pushed back against abortion rights and French laws on assisted dying, calling the process "false compassion".

Seoul seeks apology from Ukraine in row over N. Korean POWs

Agence France-Presse
SEOUL

South Korea's presidential office has demanded an apology from Ukraine for denying an agreement to keep the transfer of two North Korean prisoners of war to Seoul confidential.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy disclosed last week that his country had sent two North Korean soldiers to the South, saying they were "not easy to capture alive".

Hours after Zelenskyy's remarks at the UN, South Korea's President Lee Jae Myung expressed his dismay. "I do not know why the Ukrainian side broke the agreement and made the matter public, but it is very disappointing," he wrote on X.

Seoul said confidentiality was key to protect the POWs' relatives from repercussions in North Korea.

Mr. Zelensky's aide Dmytro Lytvyn sought to play down the disclosure, saying that the President did not share any personal details. But Seoul condemned what it viewed as a breach of trust, noting that Mr. Zelenskyy's press office had denied there was a confidentiality deal.

The dispute risks complicating Kyiv's efforts to obtain weapons from allies including South Korea to fight off Russian attacks.

Russia carries out drone strikes across Ukraine; seven killed

Associated Press
KYIV

Russia's round-the-clock bombardment of targets in Ukraine killed at least seven people and wounded 80 more, officials said on Monday.

Moscow's forces pounded apartment blocks, data centres and a building of the National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine in Kyiv, among other targets.

Russian drone attacks on the Kyiv region killed four people, officials said.

A woman was killed in a Russian strike on Kyiv's Shevchenkivskyi district. The strike hit the National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine, the latest cultural landmark in the capital to be damaged.

One drone struck an office centre in central Dnipro, killing three people, local authorities said.

Russia's Defense Ministry said its forces struck two data centres as well as several gas stations in Kyiv, a distribution hub belonging to the Nova Poshta postal service in Odesa, a cargo ship in the Black Sea and another one in the port of Chornomorsk.

'Gains in Donetsk'

Meanwhile, Ukraine's Third Army Corps said on Monday it had recaptured 51 square kilometres from the Russians in the Donetsk region.

U.S., China unveil list of 'non-sensitive' products under $30 billion tariff cut

Associated Press
HONG KONG

The U.S. and China on Monday released reciprocal lists of non-sensitive products worth about $30 billion each that will see tariff cuts, in a deal expected to help bolster bilateral trade.

The details came days after Chinese President Xi Jinping met with U.S. President Donald Trump in Washington in his first state visit to the U.S. since 2015.

China's Commerce Ministry said in a statement the agreement will help strengthen trade cooperation.

The lists included 1,619 items of U.S. goods entering China, ranging from agricultural items (excluding soybeans), hair and personal care products to timber and medical equipment. Coal from the U.S. will also be included.

Trade diplomacy: The details come days after Chinese President Xi Jinping met with U.S. President Donald Trump in Washington. AFP

For Chinese goods exported to the U.S., 77 categories were covered, including fireworks, tableware, toys like dolls and puzzles, glass and wooden Christmas ornaments and soccer balls.

Tariff rates on over 90% of the products would be subject to "most-favoured-nation" levels, the Chinese Ministry said, meaning that country-specific tariffs will effectively be eliminated.

U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said the product lists focused on "non-sensitive goods on each side that could benefit from more favourable tariff treatment." The deal could help secure market access for U.S. farmers, manufacturers, businesses and workers, while benefiting American consumers with imports from China including household goods and toys, Mr. Greer said.

Sectors of strategic importance, such as chips, electric vehicles and batteries, were not covered under the agreement.

BIG BOOST

Gulveer terms 1,500m silver as an important one in his career

R.V. MOORTHY

This is a very important medal in my career. I have no problem in running as many events and I want to win medals in them. I could not maintain my final kick speed till the end as I am normally a long-distance runner — India's Gulveer Singh, *right in pic,* who clinched a silver in men's 1500m.

OVERCOMING HURDLES

Getting a personal best in tough conditions is satisfying: Yashvir

R.V. MOORTHY

Indian javelin thrower Yashvir Singh expressed "satisfaction" at delivering his personal best in challenging conditions at the Asian Games in Nagoya. "The grip was slippery in the rain and it was difficult to find the rhythm or speed during run up. Getting a PB amidst all this is satisfying," Yashvir said after his silver show.

MARQUEE CLASH

India drubs Bangladesh, meets Pakistan in men's hockey semifinal

AHF

India blanked Bangladesh 10-0 in its final pool game of the men's hockey competition at the Asian Games on Monday. The defending champion topped Pool A with five wins from as many games. India plays Pakistan in the first semifinal on Thursday while Malaysia takes on South Korea in the other last-four clash on the same day.

BITTER ENDING

Kazakhstan race walker loses gold medal over footwear breach

REUTERS

Kazakhstan's Yasmina Toxanbayeva suffered Asian Games heartbreak in Nagoya on Monday after her victory in women's marathon race walk was scrubbed out on a footwear technicality. Danzeng Quzong was elevated to the gold-medal spot in a China one-two with Ma Li while Japan's Yukiko Umeno was third.

Yashvir, Gulveer and Sreeshankar secure silver

Rohit makes it a double podium for India in javelin; Vithya breaks the National record en route her third-place finish in 400m hurdles; Parul bags a bronze for the second successive day

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

A National record was broken and some personal marks were bested at the Paloma Mizuho Athletics Stadium as the Indians added more medals to their kitty on Monday, of both hues except the golden one the country desperately craved.

Three years ago, Vithya Ramraj ran the 400m hurdles in 55.42 seconds, equalling the longest standing Indian track record held by the legendary P.T. Usha for 39 long years since 1984. It helped her top the group before eventually winning bronze in Hangzhou. On Monday, the 28-year-old won another bronze but this one was a lot more special – the 54.75 seconds finally made her the sole National record holder, in the presence of Usha, now the IOA president. Anu Raghavan, meanwhile, also ran an individual best 55.88 seconds to finish fifth.

If Vithya found herself in elite company, the javelin throw continued to be the country's reliable medal-earners with India managing a double podium finish. In Neeraj Chopra's absence, Rohit Yadav and Yashvir Singh were expected to shoulder the burden and both stepped up on the big stage.

Yashvir, in particular, justified his last-minute inclusion as Neeraj's replacement, throwing 85.72m for a personal best and silver. Yashvir went hard to match up to leader Rumesh Pathirage but the Sri Lankan world leader and pre-tournament favourite dug deep in wet and challenging conditions for 88.55m in his final throw and won the gold. Rohit managed 84.35m for bronze.

Gulveer Singh, too, added a second silver to his tally here with a new personal mark of 3:36.72s in the 1500m – after leading for more than 1.5 laps and looking set for the top spot before Kazuto Iizawa overtook him in the final 20m. Long jumper M. Sreeshankar, too, got his second silver in as many Games with an effort of 8.07m.

Unfortunately, the constant downpour meant the track and the take-off board were extremely slippery and Sreeshankar's left leg slipped dangerously in his fourth attempt, the 27-year-old landing awkwardly on the pit and twisting his ankle. He skipped his last two attempts but the second jump was good enough to ensure him the second spot behind China's Shi Yuhao's 8.17m.

India missed out on a podium for the first time in 32 years in women's discus throw.

Field day: Gulveer picked up his second silver in this edition. Sreeshankar took the second spot for the second straight Games. Parul earned another bronze while Yashvir and Rohit made it a 2-3 for India. R.V. MOORTHY

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	132	53	45	230
2	Japan	41	68	63	172
3	South Korea	21	26	44	91
4	Uzbekistan	12	17	13	42
5	Kazakhstan	9	13	23	45
12	**India**	**4**	**20**	**21**	**45**

Seema fourth

Seema Kaliramna's personal best of 59.88m fetched her only a fourth position. Seema, who had won bronze at the Commonwealth Games recently, was unable to emulate another Seema (Punia), a legend of the sport with five consecutive medals from 2006-2022.

The biggest upset, however, was defending champion and favourite Avinash Sable finishing fourth in 8:21.67s in the 3,000m steeplechase. It was only his second race this year and a far cry from the Games record of 8:19.50 last time around. Parul Chaudhary took home a second bronze in the 5,000m.

Pleased as punch: Vithya clinched the 400m hurdles bronze with a National record. R.V. MOORTHY

Vithya happy to go past Usha's mark

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

For close to four decades, P.T. Usha remained the undisputed queen of the Indian track, no one able to better her in clearing hurdles, both literally and figuratively. On a wet and humid Monday evening at the Asian Games, Vithya Ramraj finally rewrote the 400m hurdles National record and the 28-year-old couldn't have been happier, or Usha more proud.

She finished third with 54.75s but that was immaterial for someone who equalled Usha's record of 55.42 set at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics in the last Asiad. She had been trying to go past ever since. "I met Usha ma'am a year ago and she said, go for 54 seconds. She encouraged me. So doing this today makes me so happy. Everyone's been asking me for the past three years when I will do 55.4 seconds again, there was pressure," she admitted.

The conditions were tricky and Vithya agreed things could have been even better. "Back home we never train in the rain for hurdles because there is always a concern about getting injured. Thankfully it stopped during the race but it was pouring during warm-up and I was only praying it to stop, if only for the race duration".

Esha guns down silver

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Five consecutive shoot-offs and a silver to show for it at the end of a gruelling competition that witnessed drama, courage, confusion, controversy and heartbreak. India's shooting campaign at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games continued to give hope and despair, this time in the women's 25m pistol event on Monday.

Esha Singh, sneaking into the final as the eighth and final qualifier, kept her nerve till the last shot before succumbing to pressure and finishing second after being level with China's Xiao Jiaruixuan at the end of the regulation series. The two were tied on an Asian Games record equalling 38 points and entered the shoot-off, scoring identical fours. The second shoot-off saw Xiao score another four while Esha could manage only three.

Only one round earlier, Esha had held off North Korea's Kim Hyon Suk in three consecutive bronze-medal shoot-offs, after being tied on 34, to stay in contention for the gold. The 21-year-old reigning World No. 1 had earlier finished with 580 in the two-day qualifying – 290 each in precision and rapid – edging past Taiwan's Cheng Yen-Ching by virtue of more shots closer to the centre – 22 to Cheng's 20.

It was perhaps a fitting end to a day that saw India slip into fifth spot as team and Rahi Sarnobat, the most experienced member of the shooting contingent, missing a shot completely and hitting the target frame as per the judges to end any chance of advancing.

Rahi, who was 15th with a score of 287 after the precision round on day one on Sunday, shot an 86 in the first series of rapid on Monday. Her very first shot was adjudged as having hit the frame, the Indians immediately filed an official protest but the result stood. It left her with no chance of making up in the remaining 29 shots and although the senior pro tried her best, scoring 99 and 96 in the remaining two rounds, she finished at 30th with a total of 568.

Manu Bhaker, meanwhile, finished her rapid series with a 99 but it wasn't enough for her to make the top-eight in the individual event, scoring 579. Rahi's missed shot also cost India a team medal. Third after the opening day, India eventually ended with a total of 1,727, just seven off third-placed Taiwan.

Steely display: Esha showed plenty of fight to finish second. PTI

'Confusion': Rahi on technical issues

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Esha Singh won Asian Games silver in 25m pistol on Monday. While the youngster deservedly got the appreciation, the spotlight was taken by technical issues and scoring controversies involving Rahi Sarnobat that perhaps cost the Indian team a gold.

Rahi's first shot of the first series on the day was declared on the frame, resulting in a zero.

"When you hit the frame, there is a different sound from when you hit the target. I didn't hear that and a few shooters from other countries also said they did not hear a different sound. Secondly, target 21 showed there was an extra shot but then showed an extra shot on target 20 as well. So, there was some confusion".

INDIANS IN ACTION TODAY

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Tuesday (all times IST):

Athletics: Men's pole vault final (Dev, Kuldeep), 2.50 p.m.; Women's high jump final (Pooja, Supriya), 3.35 p.m.; Women's hammer throw final (Tanya, Anushka), 4.05 p.m.; Women's 800m final (Pooja), 4.20 p.m.; Men's 800m final (Afsal), 4.35 p.m.; Men's 5000m final (Sable, Gulveer), 4.45 p.m.; Mixed 4x100m relay final, 5.15 p.m.; Women's 4x400m relay final, 5.35 p.m.; Men's 4x400m relay final, 5.45 p.m.

Boxing: Semifinals: Women's 65kg: Parveen vs Shu (Chn), 10.15 a.m.; Men's 80kg: Ankush vs. Erkinboev (Uzb), 11 a.m.; Men's +90kg: Narender vs. Oralbay (Kaz), 11.30 a.m.

Shooting: Trap individual qualification and team final (day 3, 6.30 a.m.): Men (Ahvar, Kynan, Shapath); Women (Manisha, Aashima, Neeru); Trap individual final: Women (10.30 a.m.); Men (noon).

Squash: Women's team (Pool C): vs. Iran, 6.30 a.m.

Tennis: Second round: Men: Dhakshineswar vs. Gunawan (Ina), 10 a.m.; Nagal vs. Hong (Kor), not before 12.30 p.m.; Doubles: Anirudh & Sriram Balaji vs. Abhishek & Pradip (Nep), not before 12.30 p.m.; Yuki & Dhakshineswar vs. Yevseyev & Zhukayev (Kaz), not before 12.30 p.m.; First round: Mixed doubles: Ankita & Sriram Balaji vs. Chong & Thompson (Hkg), not before 3.30 p.m.

Volleyball: Men (Pool C): vs. Qatar, 12.30 p.m.

Pincky wins bronze in kurash

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

She became the most successful Indian kurash athlete in the Asian Games with a bronze on Monday, but Pincky Balhara was sobbing at the end of her semifinal bout, not because she was overwhelmed by emotion but because a battered knee had denied her a better finish.

Pincky revealed that she was struck on the right knee during the quarterfinal win over Korea's Lim Garam. Taking on another Korean Sumin Mo in the last four of the -78kg category, Pincky said the hurting knee could not take the fresh onslaught and hampered her performance.

"I was attacking but she was attacking me there again and again. I lost on penalty," said Pincky, who won the silver in the -52kg section in Jakarta 2018.

Kurash is an Uzbek form of wrestling in which grapplers are not allowed to punch or kick their opponents or grab their legs.

The bouts are conducted in upright position and the competitors have to throw each other on their backs with full control and force to earn points.

Creditable effort: Pincky claimed her second Asiad medal. AP

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Monday:

Athletics: Men: Javelin throw final: Yashvir (silver), Rohit (bronze); Long jump final: Sreeshankar (silver), David (seventh); 1500m final: Gulveer (silver), Yoonus (ninth); 3000m steeplechase final: Sable (fourth); 400m hurdles final: Santhosh (seventh); 4x400m relay: First in heat 2, advanced to the final.

Women: 400m hurdles final: Vithya (bronze), Anu (fifth); 5000m final: Parul (bronze), Seema (sixth); Discus throw final: Seema Kaliramna (fourth), Sanya (eighth); 4x100m relay final: Fourth; 800m: Pooja (fifth in heat 2 and seventh overall), qualified for the final, Gowthami (fourth in heat 1 and ninth overall), DNQ for final.

4x100m mixed relay: Second in heat 2, advanced to the final.

Boxing: Quarterfinals: Women's 75kg: Lovlina bt Seong (Kor); 60kg: Priya bt Samadova (Tjk); Men's 90kg: Kapil bt Kim (Kor).

Cricket: Men (quarterfinal): vs. Afghanistan (Match abandoned. India advanced by virtue of being the higher-seeded team).

Hockey: Men (Pool A): bt Bangladesh 10-0.

Kurash: Women -78kg (semifinal): Pincky lost to Sumin (Kor), bagged bronze.

Shooting: 25m pistol women individual final: Esha (silver); Team final: Fifth (Manu, Esha, Rahi); Trap individual qualification (day 2): Men: Shapath (fifth), Kynan (19th), Ahvar (32nd); Women: Neeru (first), Manisha (21st), Aashima (23rd).

Squash: Women's team (Pool C): bt China 2-1, bt Japan 2-1; Men's team (Pool A): bt China 3-0, bt South Korea 3-0.

Tennis: Women's doubles (first round): Ankita & Rutuja lost to Danilina & Putintseva (Kaz) 7-5, 3-6, [5-10].

Volleyball: Men (Pool C): bt Hong Kong 3-0.

INBRIEF

Greece stuns Germany in a losing home debut for Klopp

Greece scored a 74th-minute goal through Dimitris Kourbelis to stun host Germany 1-0 in their Nations League Group A match on Sunday to top the group and spoil coach Juergen Klopp's home debut on the German bench. It was the first ever victory for the Greeks in 11 matches against the Germans, and they now lead their group on six points from two matches. Germany is on one point.

The results: League A: Serbia 1 (Jovic 46) lost to Netherlands 2 (Meerdink 30-pen, 69); Germany 0 lost to Greece 1 (Kourbelis 74); Denmark 2 (Davies 53-og, Isaksen 66) bt Wales 0; Norway 1 (Haaland 51) lost to Portugal 2 (Felix 17, Ramos 54). **League B:** Austria 3 (Affengruber 23, Adamu 45+2, Chukwuemeka 61) bt Kosovo 1 (Zhegrova 83-pen); Israel 0 lost to Rep. of Ireland 3 (Parrott 13, Idah 16, Moylan 25).

League D: Gibraltar 0 drew with Andorra 0; Lithuania 1 (A. Kucys 9-pen) drew with Azerbaijan 1 (Emreli 14).

Unadkat sizzles again with a seven-wicket match haul

Left-arm pacer Jaydev Unadkat earned seven wickets, including a five-wicket haul in the first innings, as Sussex ended its English county championship first-division campaign with a 197-run victory over Hampshire in Southampton. Manav Suthar's Warwickshire clinched the title after defeating Leicestershire by an innings and 79 runs in Birmingham.

Indians in county action:
I div.: Jaydev Unadkat (Sussex): 5/32, 2/29 & 1 n.o., 17 n.o. Sussex beat Hampshire by 197 runs.
Mahipal Lomror (Surrey): 10, 16 n.o. & 4/212. Match drawn against Somerset.
Rahul Chahar (Surrey): 3. Match drawn versus Somerset.
Manav Suthar (Warwickshire): 0/6, 1/26 & 19. Warwickshire defeated Leicestershire by an innings and 79 runs.
II div.: R. Sai Kishore (Gloucestershire): 2/51, 1/27 & 0, 11. Gloucestershire lost to Kent by eight wickets.
Mayank Agarwal (Durham): 66. Match drawn against Lancashire.
Yuzvendra Chahal (Northamptonshire): 2/23, 0/34 & 0 n.o., 4 n.o. Northamptonshire lost to Middlesex by seven wickets.

Harris, Lee released; 63 players retained

Gujarat Giants keeps 15 from its present squad, the most among the five franchises, ahead of the fifth season; auction to be held in Kochi on Oct. 28

Foreign flavour: Bell, centre, and Voll, left, are two of the four overseas players that defending champion RCB has retained. FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

WPL

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

A total of 63 cricketers, including 23 overseas players, have been retained by the five Women's Premier League (WPL) franchises ahead of next month's auction. The deadline for the franchises to announce their retentions for the fifth season ended on Monday.

Gujarat Giants retained 15 players, the most among the five teams. Unsurprisingly, UP Warriorz, given its wretched record in the tournament, retained the fewest at 11.

Defending champion Royal Challengers Bengaluru has kept hold of 13 players. It includes four overseas retentions – Lauren Bell, Nadine de Klerk, Georgia Voll and Ellyse Perry. Among the players released by RCB is all-rounder Grace Harris.

Delhi Capitals, which has finished runner-up across all four seasons, has also retained 13 members.

The five overseas players that will continue to feature for DC are Annabel Sutherland, Chinelle Henry, Laura Wolvaardt, Lucy Hamilton and Marizanne Kapp. Former South Africa wicketkeeper-batter Lizelle Lee, who smashed 320 runs in 10 innings in 2026, has been released.

Mumbai Indians, meanwhile, has retained 11 players. The WPL auction will be held in Kochi on October 28.

Retained players: Delhi Capitals: Annabel Sutherland*, Chinelle Henry*, Deeya Yadav, Jemimah Rodriguez, Laura Wolvaardt*, Lucy Hamilton*, Mamatha Madiwala, Marizanne Kapp*, Minnu Mani, N Sree Charani, Nandni Sharma, Niki Prasad, Shafali Verma
Gujarat Giants: Anushka Sharma, Ashleigh Gardner*, Beth Mooney*, Bharti Fulmali, Georgia Wareham*, Happy Kumari, Jintimani Kalita, Kanika Ahuja, Kashvee Gautam, Kim Garth*, Rajeshwari Gayakwad, Renuka Singh, Sophie Devine*, Tanuja Kanwer, Yastika Bhatia.
Mumbai Indians: Amanjot Kaur, Amelia Kerr*, Harmanpreet Kaur, Hayley Matthews*, Nat Sciver-Brunt*, Nicola Carey*, Rahila Firdous, Sajeevan Sajana, Sanskriti Gupta, Shabnim Ismail*, Vaishnavi Sharma
Royal Challengers Bengaluru: Arundhati Reddy, Ellyse Perry*, Georgia Voll*, Lauren Bell*, Nadine De Klerk*, Pooja Vastrakar, Prathyoosha Kumar, Prema Rawat, Radha Yadav, Richa Ghosh, Sayali Satghare, Shreyanka Patil, Smriti Mandhana
UP Warriorz: Deepti Sharma, Harleen Deol, Kranti Gaud, Meg Lanning*, Phoebe Litchfield*, Pratika Rawal, Shikha Pandey, Shipra Giri, Simran Shaikh, Sophie Ecclestone*, Tara Norris*
*Overseas players.
Salary cap available: DC: ₹1.1 crore; **GG:** ₹1.25 crore; **MI:** ₹1 crore; **RCB:** ₹1.15 crore; **UPW:** ₹3.65 crore.
Available slots: DC: 5 (1 overseas); **GG:** 3 (1); **MI:** 7 (1); **RCB:** 5 (2); **UPW:** 7 (2).

Lakshya's unbeaten double ton puts India under-19 in the driver's seat

YOUTH TEST

Shayan Acharya
RAJKOT

Lakshya Raichandani carried his rich white-ball form into red-ball cricket, scoring an unbeaten 210 (256b, 20x4, 4x6) as India under-19 reached 430 for eight to take a 213-run lead over Australia under-19 on the second day of the first Youth Test. Lakshya stitched together a 124-run partnership with captain Yashbardhan Singh Chauhan (54, 81b, 7x4) for the third wicket to help India recover from 46 for two.

Yashbardhan was positive, playing in the V and rotating the strike, while Lakshya took his time before opening up. It seemed both batters would reach their centuries. But Yashbardhan was caught behind off Kasey Barton.

Lakshya held firm, adding 51 with Ayaan Akram, who replaced Pranav Ragavendra, before putting on an unbroken 137-run stand for the ninth wicket with local boy Mohit Ulva (58 batting, 56b, 5x4, 4x6).

The scores: Australia u-19 217 vs. India u-19 430/8 in 92 overs (Lakshya Raichandani 210 batting, Yashbardhan Singh 54, Mohit Ulva 58 batting, Kasey Barton 3/64).

Lakshya..
SAURASHTRA CRICKET ASSOCIATION

Racing Ruler pulls off a surprise in feature event

HYDERABAD: The 15-to-1 longshot Racing Ruler, ridden by Kuldeep Singh Sr., shocked hot favourite Love All in the Dr. Harish Chandra Memorial Trophy, the main event of Monday's races. The winner is owned by M/s. Bollineni Krishnaiah, Seshadri Reddy Pochana, Ashok Ranpise, K.S.V. Prasad Raju, Mukund Kakani, Teegala Vijender Reddy, Teegala Sumant Reddy, Harinath Reddy Teegala & Mrs. Smita Bajoria. K.S.V. Prasad Raju trains the winner. Prasad Raju saddled two more winners of the day.

1. NALGONDA PLATE (DIV. I) (1,200M): LION'S PRIDE (R.N. Darshan) 1, Mantle Plume (B.R. Kumar) 2, Menlo Park (Shivam) 3 and Night Whisper (Kuldeep Sr.) 4. 1-1/4, 1-1/2 and Neck. 1m, 14.50s. ₹17 (w), 12, 13 and 92 (p). SHP: 21, THP: 103, FP: 41, Q: 26, Tanala: 522. Favourite: Lion's Pride. Owner: Mr. Yadugiri Kiran Kumar. Trainer: Raza Shehzad.

2. TWIN CITIES PLATE (1,800M): EVANSVILLE (Akshay Kumar) 1, Aakarshaka (Md. Ismail) 2, Silver Arrow (Kuldeep Sr.) 3 and Hoping High (Mohit) 4. 4-1/2, 8-1/2 and 1-1/2. 1m, 54.68s. ₹11 (w), 13, 15 and 21 (p). SHP: 19, THP: 48, FP: 22, Q: 19, Tanala: 120. Favourite: Evansville. Owner: Mr. Rama Krishna Reddy. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju.

3. NALGONDA PLATE (DIV. II) (1,200M): N R I ROYAL POWER (Afroz Khan) 1, Goddess Of Light (Akshay K) 2, Sara (Mohit) 3 and My Day (Gaurav) 4. 2-3/4, 1/2 and 1. 1m, 14.36s. ₹122 (w), 23, 15 and 16 (p). SHP: 20, THP: 36, FP: 589, Q: 245, Tanala: 2,058. Favourite: Goddess Of Light. Owner: Mr. Ravinder Reddy Male. Trainer: D. Netto.

4. DR. HARISH CHANDRA MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,600M): RACING RULER (Kuldeep Singh Sr.) 1, Love All (Akshay K) 2, Authoritarian (M.S. Deora) 3 and Special Star (P. Sai K) 4. Neck, 3 and 3/4. 1m, 39.3s. ₹54 (w) 29 and 11 (p). SHP: 45, THP: 24, FP: 182, Q: 19, Tanala: 631. Favourite: Love All. Owners: M/s. Bollineni Krishnaiah, Seshadri Reddy Pochana, Ashok Ranpise, K.S.V. Prasad Raju, Mukund Kakani, Teegala Vijender Reddy, Teegala Sumant Reddy, Harinath Reddy Teegala & Mrs. Smita Bajoria. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju.

5. MAJOR MIR MUJTABA HUSSAIN MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200M): TORCHBEARER (Kuldeep Singh Jr.) 1, Clefairy (Akshay K) 2, Shoolin (D.S. Deora) 3 and Romantic Grey (Ashad Asabr) 4. Not run: Federer. 1/2, 1/2 and 1. 1m, 14.25s. ₹120 (w), 31, 10 and 34 (p). SHP: 37, THP: 79, FP: 777, Q: 419, Tanala: 8,772. Favourite: Clefairy. Owner: Col. S.B. Nair. Trainer: L.V.R. Deshmukh.

6. NOBLE QUEST PLATE (1,200M): REIGNING BEAUTY (Md. Ismail) 1, Knight Regent (Afroz K) 2, N R I High Power (Akshay K) 3 and Walking Thunder (Kuldeep Sr.) 4. Not run: D Minchu. Head, 2 and Neck. 1m, 14.03s. ₹130 (w), 29, 17 and 11 (p). SHP: 24, THP: 85, FP: 1,408, Q: 587, Tanala: 1,890. Favourite: N R I High Power. Owner: Estate of Late Mr. L. D' Silva. Trainer: Neelesh Rawal.

7. NAGARKURNOOL PLATE (1,400M): LA QUINTA (Akshay Kumar) 1, Konaseema (Md. Ekram) 2, Farsiris (Sohan) 3 and Dream To Fly (G. Naresh) 4. 2-3/4, Neck and 2. 1m, 27.02s. ₹27 (w), 18, 10 and 14 (p). SHP: 38, THP: 69, FP: 77, Q: 30, Tanala: 428. Favourite: La Quinta. Owners: Mr. M. Ramakrishna Reddy, Mr. Bharat Venkat Epur & Mrs. Rajini Meka. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju.

8. MAJOR MIR MUJTABA HUSSAIN MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,200M): DYANOOSH (Sonu Kumar) 1, Warwick (Ashad Asbar) 2, Lucky Zone (Kuldeep Jr.) 3 and Mix The Magic (D.S. Deora) 4. 3-1/2, Neck and 1. 1m, 13.56s. ₹112 (w), 54, 25 and 31 (p). SHP: 47, THP: 62, FP: 1,704, Q: 529, Tanala: 13, 047. Favourite: Arthisha. Owners: M/s. Sardar Jivtesh Singh, Md. Sultan & M. Praveen Kumar. Trainer: M.F. Ali Khan.

Jackpot: 70%: ₹5, 89,025 (c/o) & 30%: 28,048 (9 tkts.). Mini Jackpot: (i) 29, 804 (2 tkts.), (ii) 84, 228 (2 tkts.). Treble: (i) 463 (64 tkts.), (ii) 20,295 (1 tkt), (iii) 10,409 (6 tkts.).

TNCA LEAGUE

Bunts rides on Arun and Hunny's centuries

S.J. Arun Kumar (111) and Hunny Saini (100 n.o.) helped Bunts thrash India Pistons by 271 runs in a TNCA second division league match recently.

The scores:

II div: Coromandel 250/7 in 50 overs (V. Abishek 33, Sumant Jain 43, G. Sujith 64, R. Paul Johnson 53 n.o., P. Murugesan 4/54) lost to Rising Stars 251/8 in 49.2 overs (G. Navin 47, G.M. Gokul 32, P. Elaya Raja 43).

Alwarpet 251/8 in 50 overs (V. Hari Ragavendra 96 n.o., H. Dinesh 39, V. Varshwin 39, M. Karthik 3/37) bt Jupiter 180 in 44.3 overs (P. Kannan 34, C.K. Vishal 54, J. Gowri Sankar 33, A. Aasrit 3/31, Akshay V Srinivasan 3/35).

Crombest 222 in 46.3 overs (Arjun P. Murthy 56, N.D. Harishankar 51, M. Monish Raj 3/53, B. Jeswin Bradman 4/59) lost to MCC 226/5 in 47.5 overs (Ishaaq Mohammed 42, G. Surya Kanth 64, S. Ramnarayan 42 n.o.).

Bunts 378/7 in 50 overs (S. Dinesh Raj 86, M. Thamarai Selvan 48, S.J. Arun Kumar 111, Hunny Saini 100 n.o., R. Venkatesh 3/78) bt India Pistons 107 in 37 overs (R. Vigneshwaran 35, M. Bharath 30 n.o., R. Sasidharan 3/19).

Komaleeswarar 287 in 48.3 overs (J. Jeevanandham 82, Nitin R. Ramanan 31, PL. Harshavardhan Sai 85, S. Sanjay 4/44) lost to S. Rly. Inst. 291/3 in 45.1 overs (H.I. Waseem Ahmed 68, A. Sarathraj 124, K. Vishal 43, S. Sanjay 43 n.o.).

Egmore RC 148 in 46.1 overs lost to Garnet 152/7 in 28.4 overs. (M. Kaushik Gandhi 67, T. Sanjay 3/28).

V-C: Dorairaj MCC 222/7 in 50 overs (S. Yashraj 55 n.o., E. Jaivanth 4/72) lost to SBI 223/5 in 47.5 overs (A.M. Darnesh 62, N. Srivatsan. 41, Y. Ashwath Kumar 80 n.o.).

Gems 261/7 in 50.0 overs (R. Dhanush Adit 36, Suvayu Mandal 44, M.K. Siva Kumar 58, S. Shaam Prasath 50 n.o.) bt Nungambakkam SC 183 in 49.4 overs (K. Sathish 61, Shamalan 3/53, R. Rajarajan 6/46).

Varsity Occasionals 233/7 in 50 overs (Sai Shamrudh 37, P. Prasanth 71, T.R. Pavan Kumar 38, A. Akshat 32 n.o., R. Hema Harish 6/52) bt University Union 173 in 41.3 overs (N. Deva 32, R. Hema Harish 38, J. Rabin 5/36).

Sridhar 166 in 50 Overs (K.K. Giriharan 37, Abhinav Kaarthik 36 n.o., J. Tamilselvan 30) bt VAP 136 in 35.3 overs (M. Sakthivel 31, Abhinav Kaarthik 4/31).

Shivaji 108 in 36.5 overs (M. Kaleeswaran 35, S. Rajkumar 4/27, S. Inbarasu 3/10) bt Venkat 103 in 40 overs (Sharat Narayan 35, M. Kaleeswaran 4/32, A. Imran Khan Pathan 4/24).

Arun (Bunts, 111); Hunny (Bunts, 100 n.o.).

Sarathraj (S. Rly. Inst., 124); Rabin (Varsity Occasionals, 5/36).

Rajarajan (Gems, 6/46); Harish (University Union, 6/52).

Dhoni asked me to focus more on red-ball cricket, says young left-arm spinner Ishan

Shayan Acharya
RAJKOT

For Ishan Om, bowling to Mahendra Singh Dhoni is no longer the surreal experience it might be for another teenager.

The Ranchi youngster has done it often enough. Every year, before the IPL, Dhoni comes to the JSCA Stadium to prepare.

This year, the left-arm spinner, spent almost two weeks bowling to him at the nets.

It has given him more than a story to tell. It has given him advice from the man he grew up idolising.

"His main advice was that as a cricketer at this age, especially as an under-19 player, I should focus more on red-ball cricket.

"White-ball skills will gradually develop on their own, but his main message was that I should not ignore red-ball cricket," Ishan told *The Hindu*.

Ishan Om. SHAYAN ACHARYA

> Dhoni felt that white-ball skills will gradually develop on their own if I don't ignore red-ball cricket

On Sunday, he put that advice into action, claiming his maiden five-wicket haul for India under-19 against Australia-A on the opening day of the first youth Test.

His journey has been steady.

He started at an academy in Ranchi at eight, progressed through district and State cricket, captained Jharkhand under-19 last season and made his Ranji Trophy debut before earning his India under-19 call-up.

Cricket was not the only path open to him.

His father runs a power plant business and his two elder sisters are advocates. Ishan was good at studies, too.

For now, he is not looking too far ahead.

"I haven't set any specific target yet. My aim is that whatever match I play, whoever I play for and wherever I play, I should do well. I just want to enjoy my bowling".

LIVE TELECAST

India-A vs Australia-A: Second 'Test', day 1, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
Cricket: Asian Games (Men): Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.
Football: Nations League, Sony Sports Ten 2, 5 & LIV, 9.30 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Wednesday)
Asian Games: Sony Sports Ten 2, 3, 5 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Wednesday).

AROUND THE CITY

Young champs: The winners of the State-ranking table tennis tournament on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Top-notch show: Income Tax (Chennai) and KSEB (Thiruvananthapuram), winners of the men's and women's titles in the Mayor Radhakrishnan Memorial Basketball Club's first all-India tournament recently. IOB finished second and Indian Bank came third in the men's section while in the women's category, SCR (Secunderabad) was second and Southern Railway third. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Double delight for Ananya

M. Ananya (Chennai Achievers) won both the women's and under-19 girls' titles in the TNTTA sixth State-ranking table tennis tournament at the ICF Indoor Stadium on Sunday.

G. Vinodh, former Tamil Nadu State champion, gave away the prizes.

The results (finals):

Men: S. Tharun (RTTHPC) bt P.B. Abhinandh (Chennai Achievers) 11-3, 12-10, 2-11, 12-10, 6-11, 6-11, 11-9.

Boys, u-19: Abhinandh bt K. Umesh (RTTHPC) 11-6, 12-10, 11-5, 8-11, 11-4; **U-17:** M. Mohammed (SK Academy) bt K. Akshay Bhushan (Chennai) 11-9, 11-5, 11-9; U-15: M. Ashvajith (SK Academy) bt H. Srivanth (ACE TTA) 11-9, 12-10, 11-9; **U-13:** H. Tanish (SK Academy) bt R. Sujeeth (Bestshot TTA) 11-6, 11-8, 11-6;

U-11: M. Nibhish (SKJ, Salem) bt A.R. Sundaramurthy (SKJ, Salem) 11-8, 5-11, 12-10, 11-6.

U-9: S. Adhvik (MAK Chandra TTA) bt Divit Jain (SK Academy) 14-12, 11-9, 9-11, 11-6.

Women: M. Ananya (Chennai Achievers) bt S. Yashini (SK Academy) 11-6, 13-11, 7-11, 5-11, 6-11, 11-6, 11-9.

Girls, u-19: M. Ananya bt B.R. Nandhini (MVM) 13-11, 11-5, 16-18, 9-11, 11-8, 7-11, 11-5;

U-15: B. Varnica (SSA, Erode) bt O.P. Poojaashri (HTTA) 11-7, 11-2, 11-8; **U-13:** D. Pratika (SSA, Erode) bt V.G. Harshika (Madurai) 19-17, 11-9, 8-11, 13-11.

U-11: H. Dhiya (Bestshot TTA) bt Yashika Sasha (Udhagamandalam) 11-5, 11-9, 11-9; U-9: Sharadha Ramakrishnan (MST) bt Yanthi (Coimbatore) 12-10, 12-10, 11-5.

Corporate: Alex Pandian (Chennai Achievers) bt L. Vigneshwaran (SSHI) 9-11, 11-9, 11-6, 11-4.

Seven-wicket win for Varadharaja Perumal

Varadharaja Perumal CC scored a seven-wicket win over Swathi CC in the KDCA A-Zone league recently.

The scores:

A-Zone: Swathi 128 in 26.4 overs (P. Kothandapani 35, Kamlesh 4/35) lost to Varadharaja Perumal 129/3 in 13 overs (Saravanan 55, Sujatharan 51).

B-Zone: Budding Star 87 in 23.1 overs (Pandiaraj 4/31) lost to Mugalivakkam 89/2 in 13 overs (Abishai 31 n.o.).

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA pre-round-robin u-14 tournament, City-I vs. City-III (St. Bede's 'B'); City-IV vs. City-VI (St. Bede's 'A'), 9 a.m.

U-20 WOMEN'S WORLD CUP

Spain won the FIFA under-20 Women's World Cup at Lodz (Poland) on Sunday. Goalkeeper Laia Lopez saved two penalties in a 4-3 shootout win over defending champion North Korea in the final. The game had ended 0-0. Colombia beat Italy 4-3 on penalties to win the bronze medal match.

WORLD HEART DAY

SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

ADVERTISEMENT

MSN
Research for Better Medicines

Heart to Heart Promise
— A Patient Awareness Initiative —

YOUNGER WOMEN ARE NOT IMMUNE TO HEART ATTACK RISKS

Dr. N.Sivakadaksham
Cardiologist

Younger women are not immune to heart attack risks, despite the common belief that heart disease affects only older age groups. Heart attacks in women under fifty are increasing due to smoking, diabetes, obesity, stress, and family history. Because heart disease is often considered unlikely in younger women, symptoms may be ignored or misdiagnosed. This delay can lead to serious complications and higher risk of death. Warning signs may include chest discomfort, shortness of breath, nausea, jaw pain, or extreme fatigue. Early awareness, regular health checkups, and healthy lifestyle choices can significantly reduce risk. Younger women should take symptoms seriously and seek immediate medical care when something feels wrong.

DIABETES RAISES HEART ATTACK RISK MORE IN WOMEN

Diabetes raises the risk of heart attack more in women than in men, making it a serious concern for women s health. Diabetes removes the natural cardiovascular protection women usually have before menopause. High blood sugar damages blood vessels, increases inflammation, and accelerates plaque buildup in arteries. Women with diabetes are also more likely to have additional risk factors such as obesity, high blood pressure, and abnormal cholesterol levels. Symptoms of heart disease may be subtle, leading to delayed diagnosis and treatment. Strict blood sugar control, regular monitoring, healthy eating, physical activity, and timely medical care can lower risk. Women with diabetes should prioritize heart checkups and preventive care.

Dr. S.Manoj
Cardiologist

MAINTAINING A HEALTHY WEIGHT IN HEART FAILURE

Weight changes can indicate changes in heart failure condition, so monitoring weight is crucial. Sudden weight loss can be serious, potentially due to inadequate calorie intake or muscle loss. Report unexpected weight loss to your doctor, who may recommend a high-calorie, high-protein diet and frequent meals. Sudden weight gain can be due to fluid retention or overeating, both of which can worsen symptoms. Inform your doctor immediately if you experience rapid weight gain. To monitor your weight, weigh yourself daily at the same time, wearing the same clothes, and report any noticeable changes to your doctor. This helps identify potential issues and adjust treatment plans accordingly.

Dr. S Ramesh
Cardiologist

PROTECT YOUR HEART BY MASTERING LIFES ESSENTIAL EIGHT.

Dr. D Prabhakar
Cardiologist

Tackle the Big Four: manage hypertension, diabetes, and hypercholesterolemia, and stop smoking. Prioritize the Neglected Four: wholesome diet, daily exercise, healthy weight, and 7 to 9 hours of sleep. Knowledge alone saves no lives”action does. This World Heart Day, use heart for action.

MSN
Research for Better Medicines
Presents
Heart to Heart Promise
A Patient Awareness Initiative

THE SIGNS THAT YOUR HEART FAILURE IS GETTING WORSE

Dr. B.Vinod Kumar
Cardiologist

Heart failure occurs when the heart doesn't pump blood efficiently, leading to fluid buildup and various symptoms. Common symptoms include:
Shortness of breath, initially during exercise, but progressing to difficulty walking or performing daily activities
Coughing, worsened by lying down
Fluid accumulation and swelling in the legs, liver, kidneys, and gut
Stomach pain and weight gain due to fluid retention
Fatigue and decreased ability to perform daily activities
Heart failure is a chronic condition, but working with your doctor can help manage symptoms and potentially improve the disease's progression. By recognizing these symptoms, you can seek medical attention and develop a treatment plan to improve your quality of life.

HEART FAILURE: FOLLOWING A LOW SODIUM DIET

A low-sodium diet limits daily sodium intake to 2,000-3,000 milligrams (mg). To put this into perspective, 1 teaspoon of salt equals approximately 2,300 mg of sodium. Heart failure patients are advised to follow these guidelines:
- Mild heart failure: Limit sodium to 3,000 mg/day
- Moderate to severe heart failure: Limit sodium to 2,000 mg/day
To start a low-sodium diet:
- Make gradual changes
- Adapt favorite recipes to lower sodium
- Keep a list of low-sodium foods handy
- Avoid buying high-sodium foods
- Limit high-sodium foods to one per meal
- Track sodium intake for a few days to monitor progress.

Dr. R Ramesh
Cardiologist

KNOW ABOUT EDEMA (SWELLING)

Dr. SU. Thillai Vallal
Cardiologist

Edema is the medical term for swelling caused by fluid accumulation in body tissues and organs. It can occur anywhere, but common sites include feet, legs, hands, abdomen, and rarely chest. Edema can be uncomfortable and may indicate a serious condition.Conditions associated with Edema include:
Chronic venous disease in legs
Blood clots in legs
Pregnancy
Long Travel
Angioedema (a medical emergency)
Kidney Disease
liver cirrhosis
Heart failure
Treatment involves addressing the underlying cause, reducing salt and fluid intake, and medical monitoring with medication. If you experience swelling or difficulty in breathing, seek medical attention.

MANAGING YOUR STRESS IN HEART FAILURE

Dr. Sadhanandham
Cardiologist

Managing stress is crucial when living with heart failure. To reduce stress, try these tips:
- Avoid using food and alcohol as coping mechanisms - Set boundaries and prioritize your own needs
- Don't smoke or use nicotine products
- Engage in regular exercise, such as a enjoyable activity with realistic goals
- Practice good time management and set priorities
- Take time to relax and recover from stress
- Focus on what you can control and accept what you can't
- Boost your self-esteem by acknowledging your strengths
Remember to talk to your doctor for more ideas on managing stress. By taking these steps, you can reduce stress and improve your overall well-being.

CHOLESTEROL AWARENESS CAN PREVENT HEART ATTACKS IN WOMEN

Dr. A S Raguram
Cardiologist

Cholesterol awareness can prevent heart attacks in women by enabling early detection and timely treatment. Many women are unaware of their cholesterol levels and underestimate their cardiovascular risk. High levels of LDL cholesterol contribute to plaque buildup in arteries, increasing the chance of heart attacks and strokes. Hormonal changes during menopause can worsen cholesterol profiles, making monitoring even more important. Regular blood tests help identify problems before symptoms appear. Lifestyle changes such as healthy eating, regular exercise, and weight management can significantly improve cholesterol levels. Some women may also require medications to reach safe targets. Awareness, routine screening, and adherence to treatment plans greatly reduce heart attack risk.

STAYING SAFE IN HEART FAILURE

As we age, safety becomes increasingly important, especially for individuals with heart failure. To stay safe, consider the following precautions:
- Install a medical alert system and keep emergency contact numbers handy
- Ensure a safe home environment by installing smoke detectors, fire extinguishers, and sturdy rails on stairs
- Use walking aids, non-slip shoes, and improve lighting to prevent falls
- Remove clutter, use carpet runners, and install grab-bars in bathrooms
Additionally, consider using devices such as shower stools, wheelchairs, scooters, home oxygen, or ramps to enhance safety and mobility. By taking these steps, individuals with heart failure can reduce their risk of accidents and falls, and maintain their independence.

Dr. Prathap Kumar
Cardiologist

UNDERSTAND HEART FAILURE: WHAT DOES IT MEANS TO BE AT RISK

Heart failure means the heart isn't pumping blood efficiently, not that it's about to stop. Common symptoms include shortness of breath, fatigue, weight gain, and swelling in the feet and legs.
Medical conditions that increase the risk of heart failure include coronary artery disease, diabetes, high blood pressure, obesity, and valvular heart disease. Unhealthy behaviors like smoking, poor diet, lack of exercise, and excessive alcohol consumption also raise the risk.

Dr. Arun Ranganadhan
Cardiologist

While heart failure can't be cured, careful management can control its symptoms. This includes taking prescribed medications, following a low-sodium diet, quitting tobacco, staying physically active, losing weight if needed, and monitoring for signs of worsening heart failure.

SHORTNESS OF BREATH OR DYSPNEA

Dr. V E Dhandapani
Cardiologist

Shortness of breath, or dyspnea, can manifest differently in people, ranging from feeling unable to take deep breaths to experiencing chest tightness. It can develop suddenly or over time, from weeks to months. Common medical conditions that cause shortness of breath include lung infections, heart problems like heart attack or heart failure, and severe allergic reactions.
If you experience shortness of breath, seek medical attention. Treatment depends on the underlying cause, but may involve quitting smoking, avoiding pollutants, taking prescribed medications, and addressing anxiety. In emergency situations, call for an ambulance. It's essential to consult a doctor to determine the cause and receive proper treatment for shortness of breath.

This is patient awareness initiative by MSN labs. The views and opinions expressed here are based on the expertise of the doctors and is not endorsed by MSN labs. Reader's are advised to seek to necessary medical advised from a qualified medical practitioner

Chasemaster Kohli truly in a league of his own

The constant desire to become even better than he already is, along with the devotion to fitness, ensures the 37-year-old remains the best; his numbers in the ODI format are simply sensational

CRICKET

P.K. Ajith Kumar
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Vintage stuff: Kohli put on a show in the series opener against the West Indies. NIRMAL HARINDRAN

Virat Kohli could chase down even a wild goose.

Cricket's greatest chaser was at it again, on Sunday night. And he was spectacular, again.

He was even more spectacular than usual, actually. He reached his fifty with a six. He reached his hundred with a six. He took India home with a six.

He hit nine sixes in all in that 88-ball, unbeaten 139. There were 10 fours as well.

And yes, Kohli reached a major milestone, too. He became the first batter after Sachin Tendulkar to make 15,000 ODI runs.

It was the 55th ODI hundred for Kohli. It has to be one of his best.

The target wasn't big by modern standards, the bowling wasn't threatening, the track wasn't treacherous. Given the freedom and the supreme self-confidence he batted with, the result would have been the same regardless of the conditions.

When Kohli is in that kind of touch, there is nothing he cannot do. Remember that extraordinary six he scored off Haris Rauf in India's T20 World Cup match against Pakistan at the Melbourne Cricket Ground in 2022?

And he played that shot, over the fast bowler's head, when India was under pressure, chasing. It is remarkable how he has turned chasing into fine art.

His numbers in ODIs, overall, are just as remarkable. His 15,080 runs have come at an average of 59.13 and a strike-rate of 94.30. Apart from 55 centuries, he has hit 79 fifties.

The numbers, of course, don't tell the entire story. They don't speak of his fierce determination, which gives an insight into his batting while chasing. They don't speak of his drive; no, not those exquisite ones he plays through the covers. It is difficult to imagine a more driven athlete, in any sport.

The constant desire to become even better than he already is, along with the devotion to fitness, ensures he remains the perfection of ODI batting. He has of late been batting with more aggression. He is keener to dominate from the start.

After powering India to victory with 50 balls to spare, Kohli spoke of how he has been working to unlock a new version of himself, to up the ante, and how it has helped him play with a free mind. He is truly in a league of his own.

It is not difficult to understand why a cricketer of A.B. de Villiers' outrageous talent called Kohli ODI cricket's greatest batter.

Powerhouse: India receives the Gaprindashvili Cup for the best combined result in the Olympiad. FIDE

Gukesh and Savitha stand out

CHESS OLYMPIAD

P.K. Ajith Kumar

There was no repeat of the glory of Budapest, but India's men and women managed to climb the podium nevertheless.

India had arrived in Samarkand as the defending champion in both the open and women's sections of the Chess Olympiad. In 2024, India had indeed created history with a show that underlined its status as a powerhouse in the mind game.

So the expectations about India retaining both the crowns were high. And the country had players to do the job. Yes, there were concerns about the form of D. Gukesh. But, the World champion opted to play on the fourth board, and not on the first, which he did at Budapest and before that at home in Chennai (Mamallapuram) in 2022.

He was brilliant in both those tournaments and won the individual gold medal, too. He clinched silver this time around, and contributed significantly to his team almost as if on demand. She would either win or at least draw whenever her team needed.

Divya with the inaugural Best Chess Player (Female) award. FIDE

It is no small feat to win eight out of the 10 games at an Olympiad. Savitha has always shown promise. Now she seems to be ready for bigger things. This could be a turning point in her career.

Savitha wasn't the only member of the Indian women's team to win an individual medal. Koneru Humpy, Divya Deshmukh and the often underrated Vantika Agrawal also excelled on their respective boards. The only one to miss out was R. Vaishali.

Her younger brother R. Praggnanandhaa claimed bronze in the open section. He had the difficult task of playing on the top board. But the Indian team management's decision to assign him for the games against the strongest players at the Olympiad was hardly surprising. He had been in fantastic form.

But, it wasn't the perfect Olympiad for him. Just as it wasn't for India, but that is because the bar keeps rising for Indian chess.

Amazing performance, says Savita

C. Shyam Sundar
CHENNAI

It was all quiet at Terminal 4 of the airport here even a good 10 minutes before the members of the Indian chess teams walked out. In a jiffy, there was a small crowd which included well-wishers and fans, all wanting a now-mandatory selfie with the players.

For a change, the spotlight wasn't on R. Praggnanandhaa and R. Vaishali but on B. Savitha Shri, the new kid on the block, who dazzled with an unbeaten, gold-medal winning run (nine points from 10 games) as the women's team clinched bronze.

The 19-year-old Chennai WGM, picked as the reserve board player in her Olympiad debut, proved her worth in gold as she kept notching up victories.

"It was an amazing performance. After I started with four wins, I thought I should carry on the good form," said Savitha Shri.

Savitha and Praggnanandhaa on arrival in Chennai on Monday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Think Logistics , Think CONCOR

Seamless End-to-End Logistics across Rail, Road & Sea

Double Stack Container Train on Dedicated Freight Corridor

Specialized Tank Containers for Bulk Cement Loading

Road Transportation through LNG Trucks

Global Shipping Services

Shri Ajit Kumar Panda
Chairman and Managing Director

EXCERPTS FROM CHAIRMAN'S SPEECH AT 38th AGM OF CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.

Held on 28.09.2026

Dear Fellow Shareholders,

Good afternoon and a very warm welcome to each one of you to the 38th Annual General Meeting of your Company. At the outset, I am very happy to state that your company, with its strong performance, continues to retain its position as the undisputed market leader in India's rail logistics sector.

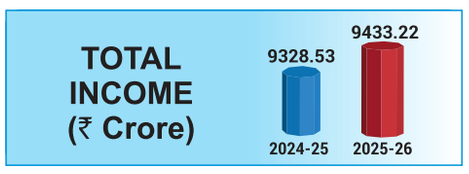
BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT AND ECONOMIC SCENARIO

At present, the World is at the crossroads of extraordinary uncertainties with various geopolitical conflicts and tensions. There is growing tendency of protectionism by nations, lack of trust and weaponisation of trade and supply chain.

On the other hand with the progressive Government policies for inclusive development, rising consumption, disposable income, credit growth, demographics advantage and competitive business environment, our Country is well positioned to face any challenge. The Indian economy has continued to demonstrate remarkable resilience with GDP growth of 7.1% achieved for 2024-25 and an estimate of 7.7% for 2025–26. The GDP growth of 7.8% in the first quarter of the current year establishes that India remains a growth engine for the world economy.

Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi ji has said and I quote "Today, India is the world's fastest-growing major economy. We are in a position to help lift the world out of slow growth."

The progress across several underlying economic indicators like



controlled inflation, strong corporate balance sheets, lower debt levels, political stability and all time low NPAs of banks set India apart from turbulent global markets. India's growth story is steadily transitioning from a consumption-led narrative to one increasingly anchored in manufacturing and industrial capability.

SECTORAL OUTLOOK

The Government's commitment for infrastructure-led growth is continuing with budgetary allocation of Rs. 12.2 lakh crores in 2026-27, including Rs. 2.78 lakh crores for Railways. India's ranking in world logistics performance index has improved from 54 in 2014 to 38 in 2023 and the target is to reach 25 by 2030.

Indian Railways' originating loading of cargo rose to 1,669.9 million tonnes in FY 2025-26, a growth of 3.3% over the previous year, while containerised cargo carried by rail increased to 93.7 million tonnes, up by 5.6%. Container handling across all Indian ports touched 24.8 million TEUs registering healthy growth of 6.5% over the previous year.

The most significant development of the year has been the long awaited commissioning of 1506 km long Western DFC. It has enabled movement of Double Stack Container (DSC) trains with higher axle load, faster access of northern hinterland and development of industries and new terminals along the DFC. A new DFC connecting Dankuni in East to Surat in West has been announced in the Budget 2026.

Rate rationalisations have been done for moving bulk cement in tank containers and for fertilizer, fly ash, food grains and salt. A single unified license regime for Container Train Operators has been notified.

It is estimated that, the per ton km cost of movement of goods by rail is Rs.1.96 vs 3.78 by road and CO_2 emission per ton km by rail is 11.5 gm vs 101 gm by road. The Dedicated Freight Corridors (DFCs) and assured transit time trains are moving goods faster now. Thus, rail transportation, when duly supported by conducive infrastructure offers distinct advantages over road in terms of cost, speed and environment and hence it is bound for gaining market share.

Your Company continues to place itself firmly at the intersection of above growth drivers deepening its business and creating enduring value for all its stakeholders

PERFORMANCE HIGHLIGHTS

On the operational front, your Company handled highest ever throughput of 5.58 million TEUs during 2025 -26 , registering a growth of 9.56% over the previous year. The EXIM growth was 8% and domestic 14.6%. CONCOR's share of containerised cargo carried by rail rose to 51.02 million tonnes, up 2.82% over the previous year.

In financial terms, total income was the highest ever at Rs.9,443 crores. The net consolidated profit for the year stood at Rs.1,246 crores. Despite rising competition, it is gratifying that business efficiency has improved resulting in better operating margins.

I am of the firm belief that logistics is a sunrise sector and your company is firmly positioned to capitalize on many emerging business opportunities. To further expand the infrastructure, capital expenditure of Rs.1,085 crores has been incurred during FY 2025-26 on expansion of its terminal network, acquisition of indigenous wagons, containers, handling equipment and expanding IT systems.

Your company has a strong balance sheet to support its sustainable future growth. At the end of the year, the net worth of the Company was Rs.13,052 crores. In keeping with the consistent policy of rewarding our shareholders, dividend was paid every quarter totalling to Rs.8.6 per shares (i.e.172%) and amounting to Rs.655 crores, which is 53.6% of net profit.

STRATEGIES AND INITIATIVES

Your Company followed a focused approach and took many business initiatives during the year thereby strengthening its market position:

- New terminals developed at Mandalgarh in Rajasthan, Kadakola in Karnataka & Jajpur and Paradip in Odisha have started contributing to business. The terminals being set up at Salawas in Rajasthan and Charodi in Gurajat on Western DFC will improve double stack running.
- During 2025-26, CONCOR has operated 6,396 Double-stack container trains.
- Double Stack Container Train services have started directly between JNPT and our terminals at Dadri, Khatuwas and Varnama.
- In a significant step towards strengthening Atmanirbhar Bharat in the global logistics landscape, movement of export-import cargo in our own containers to overseas destinations has commenced. The company has developed its Shipping platform issuing Bill of Lading.
- Movement of 9.15 lakh TEUs was done through our own first mile and last mile services which is around 44% of the FMLM potential .
- CONCOR commenced assured transit time train services between Delhi and Kolkata and Bangalore and Delhi.
- Parcel train services commenced between Bhiwandi, Mumbai to Sankrail, Kolkata.
- Aushadhi Express, India's first dedicated refrigerated freight train service was launched to transport temperature-sensitive pharmaceutical cargo from Hyderabad to JNPT.
- Business Solution Services were provided with volumes of 41,030 TEUs during the year. This covers services like customs clearance, fumigation, palletization, lashing, clearance of containers and cargo bound for Bangladesh and Nepal.
- Air cargo business has been operationalised through CONCOR terminals at ICD Dadri and Ludhiana.
- Sonik Goods Shed, near Lucknow is being developed to cater to the burgeoning logistics needs of the Kanpur and Lucknow region.

- CONCOR sourced 79.13% of our procurements from Micro and Small Enterprises.
- The Company continues to be at the forefront of transition to sustainable logistics with 95% of cargo being moved by rail; thereby saving CO_2 emission of around 4 million ton during the year.
- 230 LNG Trucks have been procured and two LNG stations have been established at Dadri and Khatuwas.
- As part of a broader shift toward cleaner, quieter and more efficient yard operations, seven Electric Reach Stackers and two Electric Trucks & Trailers have been commissioned.
- Roof top solar power is being used at Barhi, Dadri and Kanakpura terminals and at the Corporate Office.
- AI/ML based terminal management system has been put at TKD enabling automated yard operations, real-time container tracking and smart rail handling and optimising gate-in/gate-out.
- GPS enabled tracking and predictive analytics is being deployed to improve train planning, container inventory management, faster movement and demand forecasting.

Our strategies and actions on the ground are fully aligned with the nation's vision of developing a world-class logistics ecosystem.

SUBSIDIARIES, JOINT VENTURES AND ALLIANCES

CONCOR has four Subsidiaries and eleven Joint Ventures doing businesses in the fields of sea port operations, last-mile connectivity, container freight stations, air cargo and cold-chain logistics. These entities have consistently contributed to our growth. The contribution of the subsidiaries and Joint Ventures in the profit of the company during the year was Rs.24 crores.

In order to tap huge potential in Shipping and to achieve the vision of the Government, during the year MOU has been signed for setting up Bharat Container Shipping Line (BCSL) in association with the Shipping Corporation of India, three major Port Authorities and Sagarmala Finance Corporation where CONCOR will have 30% share.

New alliances for optimal utilization of infrastructure as well as for expansion of business have been made through various MOUs / agreements:

TECHNOLOGY AND STANDARDISATION

All commercial and finance functions of the Company are system driven and are providing real time information for faster decision making. We are at the forefront of adopting new technology for the desired result. Some of our initiatives in this respect include:

- Electronic filing of documents extended to all EXIM terminals.
- Enterprise Dashboard functioning for Rake Monitoring.
- Customer interfaces strengthened through a dedicated web server and mobile app.
- Tools such as Know Your Container Location (KYCL), e-tendering and the First Mile–Last Mile (FMLM) mobile app continue to streamline operations and contribute to ease of doing business.
- Double Stack Loading Plan (DSLP) system has improved train loading leading to higher utilization and reduced rail haulage cost.
- Disaster recovery site and stand by systems at primary sites have been setup for commercial and business sensitive applications.

HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT

Doug Conant said and I qoute "To win in the marketplace you must first win in the workplace."

Your Company continues to regard its human capital as its greatest strength. The business is run by a lean and committed team of 1,238 CONCORians with a ratio of staff cost to revenue merely 5.73%.

Continuous in-house programmes, specialized and on-the-job learning has helped employees strengthen their capabilities and adapt to changing business needs.

CONCOR remains committed to building an inclusive workplace with women in leadership role heading Areas and key functions like banking, HR and terminal operations. The Company continues to invest in the physical and mental well-being of its team through workplace yoga and fitness facilities, participation in marathons and sports events.

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

Corporate governance, ethics and transparency continue to be deeply embedded in your Company's functioning underpinned by robust internal controls, clear delegation of authority and a strong culture of disclosure and accountability. There are robust systems and procedures in place so as to have efficient management of business and transparency and compliance in all functions.

During the year 2024-25, the Company has been rated "Outstanding" by the Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) on Corporate Governance parameters and in MOU performance it was rated 'Very Good'. The 'AAA' credit rating for the Non-Fund Based Facilities has been reaffirmed by ICRA, reflecting continued confidence in our financial strength and governance standards. On the financial statements for 2025-26 there are no audit qualifications and C&AG of India has issued nil comments.

Your Company's performance and leadership continue to be recognised through several prestigious awards and accolades received during the year.

SUSTAINABILITY AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

Your Company continues to conduct its business in a socially and environmentally responsible manner deepening its adoption of energy-efficient and ecofriendly systems and transportation solutions.

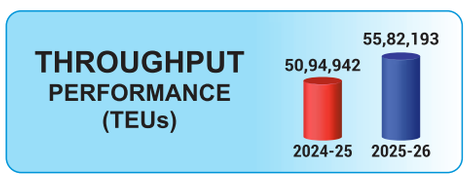
We firmly believe in the principles of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam which teaches us that World is one family and the responsibility to protect our mother earth rests with all of us. We have touched the lives of more than 1.25 million people during the year and spent an amount of Rs.40.59 crore through various CSR programs.

WAY FORWARD

We are working tirelessly to make our country a Viksit Bharat by 2047 coinciding with the centennial of our independence. Our dream is that India will emerge as a leading global power offering its citizens high standards of living and ensuring equitable growth for all. In today's World, a nation of 1.4 billion people is not merely a statistic but a wellspring of skill, ambition and enterprise.

With a strong asset base at present of 68 terminals, 444 rakes, 58,000, containers, and 232 LNG/EV trucks and a capable and committed team, your Company is well placed to retain its leadership position in the sector. Today, CONCOR stands stronger, more agile and uniquely placed to capitalize on numerous emerging opportunities in the logistics sector. With our motto of **"Think Logistics, Think CONCOR"** we remain steadfast in our commitment to innovate, serve with purpose and be a partner in the growth of our country. In our pursuit for relentless growth we shall focus on the following objectives.

- Expanding our terminal network to 100 and count of rakes and containers to 500 & 70,000 respectively .
- Diversification into new business verticals and extensive use of technology.
- Capturing new opportunities arising from the expected growth in EXIM and domestic container volumes with full commissioning of two DFCs.
- Promoting double stack trains and providing end-to-end logistics solutions.
- Rationalization of haulage charges to attract light weight cargo.
- Capturing bulk cement and liquid cargo in tank containers.
- Taping potential in shipping, air cargo and cold chain logistics.
- Expanding Green Logistics solutions and bouquet of value-added services.
- Operating 100% of FMLM throughput under our own first mile and last mile services.



- Scaling up overseas container movement under CONCOR's own Bill of Lading.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I acknowledge and appreciate the constructive support extended by the C&AG of India, our Auditors, Ministries of Railways, Shipping, Commerce and Industry, Finance as well as the Customs authorities, various State Governments, JV partners, value-chain partners, customers and regulators.

I extend my deepest appreciation to all shareholders for their continued trust and support and my sincere gratitude to my fellow Board members for their guidance and contributions. My heartfelt thanks are due to Team CONCOR whose sincerity and hard work continue to carry your Company to new heights.

I pray for the well-being of all of us and of our beloved Nation.

Thank You. Jai Hind.

Ajit Kumar Panda
Chairman and Managing Director
(DIN: 08221385)

28th September, 2026
New Delhi

Note: This does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the 38th Annual General Meeting of the Company.

CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
(CIN: L63011DL1988GOI030915)
Regd. Office & Investor Relations Centre: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Mathura Road, Opp. Apollo Hospital, New Delhi-110076
Email: investorrelations@concorindia.com
Website: www.concorindia.co.in, **Phone:** 011-41222500/600/700

A bank that India can deep dive into in the Africas

Perhaps now, the turnaround is imminent. Only time will tell, but watching Kuldeep run rings around the West Indian batters in Thiruvananthapuram on Sunday in the first ODI, you couldn't help but wonder why successive team managements haven't invested more in this now mature, seasoned 31-year-old.

NIRMAL HARINDRAN

R. Kaushik

Fast bowling is a very physically demanding and unnatural activity that places immense strain on various different parts of the body. The most affected, one might say, are the back, the knees and the ankles, but the shoulder bears a heavy burden too, as does the heel and the shin.

Fast bowling calls for sheer bloody-mindedness, especially in a country like India where, until perhaps a decade back, the pitches offered absolutely no assistance even in domestic cricket. The diktat to leave a few millimetres of grass, interestingly during Sourav Ganguly's tenure as the BCCI president, has had a domino effect with the medium-pacers and those slightly quicker than that having a field day at the expense of spin. But even so, it requires a certain mindset to want to embrace fast bowling in the subcontinent - perhaps with the exception of Pakistan, who somehow seem to throw up quicks a dime a dozen.

It's not as if spin bowling is an easier endeavour. It would seem to be an unequal contest, fast bowlers thundering in from 20 yards to hurl the cherry and the spinners trundling in from five or six yards - unless you were Derek Underwood or Ajantha Mendis - to let go of the ball. But anyone who thinks bowling spin comes easy clearly doesn't understand cricket enough.

And it's not as if spinners aren't putting themselves at the risk of picking up injuries, either. The seam cutting against the inside of the forefinger and the middle finger triggers such pain and discomfort that oftentimes, it's hard to even grip the ball and well nigh impossible to release it with the desired revs. But such is their devotion to their craft that the finger spinners make light of such terrible exigencies, determined to hoodwink batters in the air and off the surface while being mindful of how much the odds are stacked against them in modern-day cricket.

If the lot of quality finger-spinners is anything but straightforward, think of the wrist-spinner. There is arguably no other type of bowling that asks such probing questions as that of a wristie. For starters, they need to be encouraged to keep at it because a bad delivery is never far away, because such is the very nature of that craft. Especially in one's formative years, it is very easy to get disheartened, and more so if encouragement isn't forthcoming from coaches, captains, parents and peers. But even when one establishes themselves at the highest level, the gremlins of self-doubt never disappear completely.

Shane Warne might have made leg-spin look glamorous and ridiculously easy with his larger-than-life persona and a supreme command over how the ball left his hand but hey, how many wrist-spinners have taken 700 Test wickets? Or even 700 wickets in first-class cricket? Warne was the striking exception, the genius touched by greatness long before he made an eminently forgettable Test debut in Sydney in January 1992 against India. Figures of one for 150 - his lone success was double-centurion Ravi Shastri - were hardly flattering, but Warne wasn't the only to show that it isn't how you start, but how you develop and finish, that matters the most.

Generous with inputs

Warne wasn't just a great bowler, he was also generous with his inputs and advice, with his learnings and wisdom. In international cricket, they talk of a fast bowlers' club, and a spinners' club. For a long time, the latter was populated by three of the most successful tweakers of all time - Warne, Sri Lankan giant Muttiah Muralitharan (Test cricket's highest wicket-taker with 800 scalps) and our own Anil Kumble, with the temperament of a fast bowler and the heart of a champion that often took the sheen away from his not inconsiderable skillset.

It was probably little less than providential that two of these three members contributed to a rookie left-arm wrist-spinner - the term Chinaman is frowned upon these days, apparently because it is politically incorrect - announcing himself on the world stage more than nine and a half years back. Kumble was India's head coach for only one year - more the Indian team's loss than the towering Bengalurean's - but that was time enough for him to bequeath to Indian cricket that great rarity in the history of the game, a left-arm wrist-spinner.

Through the first three of Australia's four Tests in India in early 2017, Kuldeep Yadav was steadfastly ignored by Virat Kohli. An unfortunate shoulder injury to the captain forced him to miss the decider in Dharamsala - the series was tied 1-1 - and Ajinkya Rahane, the stand-in skipper, heeded his coach's words and opted to throw the 22-year-old from Kanpur into the deep end.

Master's advice

His first bowl is what we tend to call a 'dream debut'. On a decidedly pacer-friendly day-one strip at the HPCA Stadium, he made Australia's batters dance to his tune. Kumble had facilitated a conversation between Warne and Kuldeep before the match, and while English may not have been the latter's strongest suit at the time, he showed that language is hardly a barrier when it comes to cricket by putting the master's advice to great effect.

His first Test wicket was that of David Warner, with a flipper that Warne had talked about in detail. Then followed the sticks of Peter Handscomb, Glenn Maxwell - coming off a century in the previous game in Ranchi - and Nagpur as Kuldeep finished with four for 68 from 23 outstanding overs. A start had emerged, you told yourself, a star for whom the sky was the limit.

Kuldeep's career has, as has been well chronicled, not taken off along expected lines. Nine and a half years after that stirring debut, he has only 19 Test caps. Somehow, he has been the most expendable of the spinners, ostensibly at the altar of batting depth. For a type of bowler who relies on confidence, trust, encouragement and backing, to be forced to look over his shoulder and wonder if he will get a second Test on the trot isn't the ideal base from which to perform, as former India leg-spinner Narendra Hirwani agreed during a conversation with this writer a couple of weeks.

Pigeonholed more as a limited-overs bowler - 122 ODIs and 54 T20Is for 198 and 95 scalps respectively - Kuldeep has plugged away manfully in the two shorter formats. He must be hurting immensely at not playing more Tests, even on home patch, and sometimes, that feeling of hurt and maybe not being wanted has manifested itself in scratchy, underwhelming performances that infuriate because one knows that Kuldeep is capable of much, much more.

Turning a corner?

Perhaps now, the turnaround is imminent. Or perhaps, even now, that could be a false dawn. Only time will tell, but watching Kuldeep run rings around the West Indian batters in Thiruvananthapuram on Sunday in the first ODI, you couldn't help but wonder why successive team managements haven't invested more in this now mature, seasoned 31-year-old.

Put in on an excellent batting strip, the Caribbeans seemed on course for a total in excess of 350 on the back of sterling opening stand of 135 between Justin Greaves and John Campbell in just 19.2 overs. Enter Kuldeep, so send them tumbling to 198 for five, including wickets in successive deliveries of Greaves and Jewel Andrew, who had no answer to a ripping wrong 'un that caught the splice of his bat and lobbed to Rohit Sharma at slip.

Kuldeep finished with four for 40, his best ODI figures since September 2023, when he took five for 25 against Pakistan in the Asia Cup in Colombo. Only thrice subsequently in the next 34 ODIs until Sunday did he manage a four-wicket haul, but there was something different about how the ball left his left hand in Thiruvananthapuram.

Flow and confidence

The pace was optimal, the control impeccable, the rhythm very, very evident. It certainly helped that he got a wicket early on because more than anyone else, Kuldeep thrives on flow and confidence, and once he realised that he was hitting the areas that he was targeting, he appeared so dangerous as to threaten a wicket almost every delivery.

Kohli produced another one of his trademark centuries in a chase, seeing the team home by eight wickets with plenty to spare, and Shubman Gill dazzled with a pleasing hundred of his own, but there truly was only one candidate for the Player of the Match award.

Kuldeep had single-handedly downscaled the West Indian total by at least 50 runs and while there is no gainsaying what the outcome would have been even if Shai Hope's men had touched or crossed 350, the wrist-spinner pulled the chase down to little more than ordinary proportions with his mesmeric presence at the bowling crease.

Not the best of times

Across formats, Kuldeep hasn't had the best of times of late. He hasn't taken more than two wickets in a T20I innings for 12 months, while the last of his five five-fors in Test cricket came in October last year, also against West Indies. His last five bowls in the five-day game have brought him just four successes in 54.5 overs and he had a forgettable Galle Test last month, finishing with match figures of one for 103 from 25 overs as he was comprehensively shaded by finger-spinners Manav Suthar and Ravindra Jadeja.

Kuldeep has found himself at a crossroads so often in his nearly decade-long international career that he must experience a sense of déjà vu whenever he is pushed to a corner. He has found a way to spring back several times, and one can only hope that Sunday is a seminal moment in that it will lead to a sustained expression of tricks and sleight of hand.

Over the next week, in the next two ODIs, and in the five T20Is to follow, he will get further opportunities to build on this grand start to the home season. If he can snare a bagful of wickets, it will put him in an excellent state of mind as India head to New Zealand in three weeks' time for their first full tour there since January 2020.

Kuldeep is the kind of bowler who can make a decisive impact even on pitches that don't offer him much help, a bank India will hope to dip into at the 50-over World Cup in the Africas in 12 months' time.

For long, Kuldeep himself has been his worst enemy; that's something he and the think-tank must work assiduously to arrest as Indian cricket enters an exciting phase pregnant with glorious possibilities.

THE GIST

- Kuldeep's career has, as has been well chronicled, not taken off along expected lines. omehow, he has been the most expendable of the spinners, ostensibly at the altar of batting depth
- Kohli produced another one of his trademark centuries in a chase, seeing the team home by eight wickets with plenty to spare, and Gill dazzled with a pleasing hundred of his own, but there truly was only one candidate for the Player of the Match award
- Kuldeep had single-handedly downscaled the West Indian total by at least 50 runs
- The left-arm wrist spinner has found a way to spring back several times, and one can only hope that Sunday is a seminal moment in that it will lead to a sustained expression of tricks and sleight of hand

Rare-disease drugs can be India's next pharma frontier

After affordable drugs, India's next challenge is to show the world how to make rare-disease drugs accessible; with a streamlined regulatory pathway and government procurement, India could build a globally competitive rare-disease pharmaceutical sector

Gayatri Saberwal
Rakesh Mishra
Alok Bhattacharya

Each rare disease affects very few people. However, there are around 8,000 rare diseases, and they cumulatively affect hundreds of millions of people. In India, 1,004 rare genetic disorders have been reported so far.

It used to be that because the number of patients for a rare-disease drug was very small, so the pharmaceutical industry's interest in developing such drugs was limited. Therefore they were called orphan drugs.

In order to overcome this hesitancy, many governments have incentivised companies to develop orphan drugs. Examples include the Orphan Drug Act, which the U.S. passed in 1983 to provide tax incentives, seven years of market exclusivity for the first approved product for a given condition, grants, regulatory fee waivers, etc. That is, it reduced the costs of developing the drugs and enabled companies to make a good profit.

This allowed companies to diversify into rare-disease drugs. Before the passage of the Orphan Drug Act, only 38 relevant drugs had been approved in the U.S. But after that, by 2022, there had been 1,122 approvals. Subsequently, several countries and regions, including Japan, Australia, and the European Union had approved similar legislation encouraging pharmaceutical companies to develop and manufacture orphan drugs.

Because of the small market, companies tend to set very high prices for these medications, and it is not unusual for a rare disease patient to find that a year's worth of the drug costs around $100,000 (₹1 crore) or more. This puts the medication out of reach for virtually all patients around the world unless a health insurance scheme or government health service covers it.

Samples of such high-priced pharmaceuticals are described in the table.

Some expensive drugs for rare diseases

Drug	Generic name	Therapy type	Disease	One-time/Annual treatment	Price (USD)
Lenmeldy	Atidarsagene autotemcel	Stem cell gene therapy	Metachromatic leukodystrophy	One-time	4.25 million
Hemgenix	Etranacogene dezaparvovec	Gene therapy	Haemophilia B	One-time	3.5 million
Elevidys	Delandistrogene moxeparvovec	Gene therapy	Duchenne muscular dystrophy	One-time	3.2 million
Zokinvi	lonafarnib	Small molecule	Hutchinson-Gilford progeria and ultra-rare laminopathies	Annual	1-1.2 million/year
Skyclarys	Omaveloxolone	Small molecule	Friedreich's ataxia	Annual	370,000/year
Trikafta	Combination of elexacaftor, ivacaftor, tezacaftor	Small molecule	Cystic fibrosis	Annual	200,000-300,000/year

Source: Authors provided

The challenges

Although the Government of India supports rare disease patients with up to a total of ₹50 lakh for their treatment, this is often insufficient to cover the necessary costs even for a year, and patients may have to resort to crowdfunding to raise the required capital.

For example, in mid-2025, ₹9 crore was raised through crowdfunding to pay for gene therapy for a 16-month-old child in Kolkata. In fact, almost 4,000 children are listed on a Government of India crowdfunding platform, with the cumulative annual cost of treatment for these patients amounting to over ₹9,000 crore.

Many drugs for rare diseases have been developed, but they cater to only about 5% of rare diseases and associated conditions. Therefore, most patients lack suitable drugs, even those available at high cost.

The two key challenges in developing new orphan drugs are identifying a patient cohort for conducting clinical trials and determining endpoints in these trials. Once a drug is approved, undertaking small-scale manufacturing and distribution that is affordable and of high-quality are other major challenges.

In this article, the authors present here a possible solution to these issues. These solutions touch on how foreign companies that tend to develop novel drugs can work with India both for clinical trials and manufacturing.

Trials for new drugs

With an overall population exceeding 1.4 billion, India has a large number of patients with any given condition. And due to high rates of endogamy in certain social groups, the prevalence of a particular rare disease is even higher than might be expected based on its prevalence elsewhere.

For example, research has shown that in particular ethnic groups, the prevalence of beta-thalassemia in India can be 10.5% whereas, per a 2023 review, the prevalence in India's general population is 3.7%. Indian patients have also become increasingly organised in recent years, with a proliferation of patient advocacy groups focusing on specific diseases.

On the research front, for example, one longitudinal study has been tracking a group of 70 people with a rare condition called GNE myopathy. Patient groups pertaining to Rett syndrome have a registry of more than 400 patients. The gene pool of the Indian diaspora also has unique mutations, often across different ethnicities.

In India, the government supports rare disease patients with up to a total of ₹50 lakh for their treatment; however, this is often insufficient to cover the necessary costs and patients may have to resort to crowdfunding to raise the required capital

In all, there is a large number of rare disease patients, which should help in finding a suitable patient cohort for trials. However, patients from India are not usually participants in international trials for orphan drugs. Therefore, there is considerable scope to increase their involvement in such trials. The government could foster the collaboration of foreign companies and local organisations, as it does in the area of chip manufacturing. It also could invite multinational drug companies to set up drug-development centres vis-à-vis rare diseases in India, in collaboration with patient groups.

If Indian patients are important participants in developing such drugs, they are also likely to be more interested in accessing the resulting drugs than in any monetary compensation. Put another way, Indian patients may be willing to help drug development but only if they see themselves as beneficiaries of the approved drugs.

Overpriced drugs that they cannot access serve no local purpose. To this end, the authors propose that India decide on the price of drugs sold within the country or in the Global South. The company developing the drug can be free to set prices in the rest of the world.

The authors say this with reference to the concept of benefit-sharing. Recently, country representatives and medical experts discussed this concept in the context of the Pandemic Agreement of the World Health Organization (WHO). The idea is that in the event of a pandemic, countries will rapidly share information about pathogens, including their genetic information, with the rest of the world. That way, pharmaceutical and biotechnology companies can develop diagnostics, drugs, and vaccines as early as possible. The catch is such products must be shared across countries, fairly and equitably.

Notably, U.S. and Chinese companies are locked in a charged race to develop drugs for rare diseases. Chinese companies will usually have access to enough patients, and also to low-cost manufacturing. Likewise, companies from the Western nations may find it worthwhile to explore opportunities of collaboration in India.

Manufacturing in India

India has been called the "pharmacy of the world" due to its production of small molecule generics, which fill 47% of the prescriptions for generics in the U.S. India also has the largest number of manufacturing sites approved by U.S. regulators outside the U.S.

Indian firms also manufacture and export biosimilars to the U.S. and the European Union and supply 15% of all biosimilars sold in the U.S. Of late, facilities in the country have been producing a relatively novel therapy personalised to each patient for particular cancers, called CAR-T, to international standards.

In effect, India can manufacture various categories of high-quality drugs at low cost. Local manufacturers are also ready to do this for small volumes, whereas manufacturers in Western nations are often unwilling to do so.

Under Rule 101 of the New Drugs and Clinical Trials Rules 2019, the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has specified six countries – including the U.S. and the U.K.; if one of these countries approves a drug, the drug need not have a new clinical trial conducted in India before its maker seeking the Indian regulator's approval.

This provision can be a major incentive to manufacture and market certain generic drugs in India. However, this policy can benefit from greater transparency, including guidance documents to help drug developers and sponsors file applications to the regulator. Regulatory agencies abroad routinely develop such documents to ease the applications process.

As a rule, the approval of such drugs should be based on bioequivalence, i.e. their behaviour in the body should be the same as that of the original drug; safety and toxicity studies; and the drug's effectiveness once it is on the market.

Such a pathway will require appropriate safeguards for quality, safety, a system that looks out for adverse events after the drug is on the market (i.e. pharmacovigilance), and manufacturing standards – but it will also considerably reduce the need for duplicate paperwork.

What the state can do

We also have an opportunity to take advantage of India's expertise in generic drugs to create a global orphan drug manufacturing industry. The government should draft policy that reduces the financial barriers to producing such drugs locally. A useful model could be developed along the lines of the production-linked incentive schemes for manufacturing. That is, companies investing in the manufacture of selected orphan drugs could receive incentives linked to production, investment, exports, and patient access.

The financial incentives could include tax incentives for investing in orphan drug manufacturing and production-linked incentives for approved orphan drugs. Other kinds of support could include support for technology transfer and process development in collaboration with a national laboratory, advanced market commitments (AMCs) by the government, committing to buy a certain output at a certain price point, and distributing it through the Centres of Excellence on Rare Diseases, the Central Government Health Scheme, and the Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Jan Aushadhi Kendras. Manufacturers could also benefit from predictable demand during the early stages of production, and incentives for exporting to low- and middle-income countries.

The overall objective should not simply be to subsidise companies. Instead, the government should de-risk the initial investment enough to make orphan drug manufacturing commercially viable.

With a streamlined regulatory pathway, appropriate financial incentives, and government procurement, India could build a globally competitive rare-disease pharmaceutical sector.

Taken together, India has already shown the world how to make drugs affordable.

The next challenge is to show the world how to make rare-disease drugs accessible.

(Gayatri Saberwal, Rakesh Mishra, and Alok Bhattacharya are with the Tata Institute for Genetics and Society. Bhattacharya is also with 'World Without GNE Myopathy'.
gayatri.saberwal@gmail.com, rakesh.mishra@tigs.res.in, alok.bhattacharya@gmail.com)

Muhammad Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud (right). GOVT. OF PAKISTAN/FACEBOOK

China brings Pakistani astronauts closer to orbit

Reuters

Two Pakistani pilots are memorising Mandarin, spinning in centrifuge drills, and learning to eat, sleep and repair equipment while weightless as a decision nears on which one will become the first foreign astronaut aboard China's Tiangong space station.

The voyage into space would be a first for the South Asian nation. It is part of broader cooperation with Beijing that straddles the Belt and Road Initiative and has produced Chinese-launched Pakistani satellites, a joint satellite-navigation system and a Pakistani-built rover due to fly on China's Chang'e 8 lunar mission around 2028.

Pilots Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud have spent months training at the China Astronaut Research and Training Center in Beijing for a mission that was conceived by the two countries in 2019, said Amer Gilani, who oversees human spaceflight cooperation at Pakistan's space agency, SUPARCO.

China has not said which of the two will fly or when, but Gilani said a final astronaut selection decision is expected in mid-to-late October.

Whoever is chosen will not return to Pakistan before launch, setting off into space directly from training in China and returning home after a recovery period following the return to Earth, Gilani said in an interview.

The astronaut will fly aboard a Chinese-built spacecraft, launched from a Chinese site, trained by Chinese instructors and communicating in Mandarin in orbit

Training includes intensive Chinese-language instruction, learning spacecraft systems, and adapting to both the microgravity of orbit and the g-forces of liftoff, he added.

The details shared by Gilani and SUPARCO's director of artificial intelligence Uzair Ansari are the first insight provided by SUPARCO to foreign media since the pilots were selected and deployed to China.

Once in space, the chosen pilot will carry the title of "payload specialist", which is astronaut-speak for someone whose job in orbit is running Pakistan's science experiments rather than flying the ship, Ansari said.

Of more than 300 proposals SUPARCO fielded from universities in Karachi, Lahore and Islamabad after a year-long campaign, Gilani said Chinese institutes picked four for this flight: biotechnology experiments that will help combat food insecurity and climate change.

Every experiment is built and pre-tested in SUPARCO's own labs before Chinese engineers sign off.

The scientific payload is modest next to a station that has already hosted more than 180 experiments and produced over 500 research papers and 150 patents, Ansari added.

Tiangong's three modules weigh about 77 metric tonnes combined and house roughly 14 experiment racks spanning life sciences, materials, fluid physics, combustion and radiation exposure, Gilani said.

The astronaut will fly aboard a Chinese-built spacecraft, launched from a Chinese site, trained by Chinese instructors and communicating in Mandarin in orbit.

The Pakistani astronaut is due to return with two members of a Chinese crew that arrived at the space station in May because the third member is expected to stay for a year to enable the study of long-duration human physiology in space.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount earned by MCD from unipole advertisement in 2026

79 in ₹ crore. The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has no records of estimated revenue losses from unallotted or inactive unipole advertising sites across its 12 zones, or of action taken against officials for alleged negligence in tendering or revenue oversight, according to an official response. The civic body has identified 1,235 unipole sites across its 12 zones. PTI

Crimes against women reported in Odisha since June 2024

71,769 As many as 71,769 cases of crimes against women were registered at police stations across Odisha between June 2024 and July 2026, Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi informed the Assembly on Monday. Similarly, 21,069 cases involving crimes against women were registered till the end of July, he said. PTI

Children in India who lack sanitation services in schools

50 in million. Nearly a fifth of the children with no access to sanitation services in schools are in India, the highest for any country in the world, according to the WHO-UNICEF Joint Monitoring Programme (JMP) report. India has 50 million of the world's 244 million children who did not have sanitation services in schools in 2025, the report noted. PTI

Percentage increase in India's industrial output in August

8 in per cent. India's industrial output increased by 8 per cent in August from 7.4 per cent in the preceding month, mainly due to a good show by the manufacturing sector, according to the latest government data released on Monday. The data showed that the mining and quarrying sector contracted by 5.6 per cent in August against 15.8 per cent growth a year ago. PTI

Mobile numbers blocked in Rajasthan due to CSEAM

15,326 The Rajasthan Police have blocked 15,326 mobile numbers, nearly 7,800 URLs and profiles and 100 devices allegedly linked to online circulation of child sexual exploitation and abuse material (CSEAM), a senior official said on Monday. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us facebook.com/thehindu X.com/the_hindu instagram.com/the_hindu

A new governance model for Ladakh

Ladakh was made a Union Territory under the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019, prompting concerns from local groups about preservation of Ladakh's culture and demands for Sixth Schedule status; the Centre has proposed to insert Article 371-K into the Constitution to provide for a directly elected legislative body instead

EXPLAINER

C.B.P. Srivastava

The demand by Ladakh for Sixth Schedule status and the proposal made by the Ministry of Home Affairs to provide for a directly elected legislative body for governance in the Union Territory has created a paradoxical situation and raised the question of whether a UT can be granted such status. Whether it would be constitutionally valid to equate States and UTs in the context of their respective governance is a question worth examining. Indian federalism is unique in the sense that, in general, it functions as a federation, while during an Emergency, it becomes perfectly a union. This is why the Supreme Court has called it "Amphibian" in *State of Rajasthan v. Union of India* (1977). This observation signifies that while India intends to distribute the resources equitably through its federal structure, it retains a unitary character to ensure the unity and integrity of the nation.

Moreover, India's territory includes States, UTs and any other territory acquired under international law, making it a decentralised federal design. The political idea behind this design is to include every cultural and ethnic group in democratic governance to sustain its political structure. This has also been the primary reason for the provisions of the Fifth and Sixth Schedules, which provide for Scheduled Areas and Autonomous Districts, especially to ensure the inclusion of tribal communities. From a functional perspective, this design is founded on the 'Doctrine of Proportionality', so that the Rawlsian principle of justice, i.e., the greatest advantage to the least advantaged could be achieved. Considering its unique ethnic composition and cultural specificity, Ladakh has demanded Sixth Schedule status. However, the Central Government is unwilling to provide this status and has instead proposed an elected legislative authority for a sui generics model of governance.

A protest demanding Sixth Schedule status for Ladakh, held in Leh in January 2026. ANI

What is the Sixth Schedule?

The Sixth Schedule covers only Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram primarily because most of these areas were part of Assam during British rule and were classified as "Excluded" or "Partially Excluded" areas. Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram later became separate States, retaining their Sixth Schedule protections. The Sixth Schedule is governed by Article 244(2) and 275(1). The Governor has the power to create new Autonomous Districts through a public notification. Each such district is governed by a district council with a maximum of 30 members. In short, the States covered by the Sixth Schedule enjoy considerable autonomy in governance.

Ladakh was made a Union Territory without a Legislative Assembly under the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019. Many local groups expressed concerns about protecting the culture of Ladakh's people, including their language, traditions and customary practices. They also wanted to prevent outsiders from acquiring land in Ladakh, as it could deprive local people of their land rights. Above all, local groups are dissatisfied with the way political representation has been given to Ladakh. All these factors have contributed significantly to the demand for Sixth Schedule status.

Proposal of Article 371- K

The Government has proposed to insert Article 371-K in Part XXI of the Constitution (Temporary, Transitional and Special Provisions) to strike a balance between national administration and local self-government. If the Government grants special status under the Sixth Schedule to Ladakh, the autonomy it would receive might prove detrimental to national security, given Ladakh's strategic location in the vicinity of China. However, the ethno-cultural aspects of Ladakh must also be protected through an efficient and autonomous local government.

Against this backdrop, the proposal to provide a directly elected legislative authority appears more rational, as it would not only ensure adequate and proper political representation but also involve the local population in the decision-making process. The proposed structure may place this body above the existing Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDCs), while retaining panchayats and district-level institutions. However, the role of the Lieutenant Governor after the constitution of this authority is yet to be clearly defined. Further, the extent of powers that the said authority might enjoy, particularly in terms of financial autonomy, remains to be seen. As India is a functional federation in which financial and residuary powers are vested in the Union rather than the States, it remains to be decided whether the legislative authority would enjoy any such powers.

Constitutionality of the proposal

Granting special status or providing a sui generis model of governance to a Union Territory is certainly constitutionally valid, as India's constitutional governance practices equitable distribution of rights among States and other units within its territory. It also practises the principle of proportionality and may, therefore, provide special powers or status to a UT based on its location, developmental requirements and the need to protect its democratic identity. Earlier, through constitutional amendments, Parliament has made special provisions for the National Capital Territory of Delhi under Articles 239 AA and 239 AB. This makes it clear that Parliament may grant special status to any UT.

Thus, the proposal to insert Article 371-K is expected to provide the required autonomy without adversely affecting the territorial integrity of the nation.

(C.B.P. Srivastava is president, Centre for Applied Research in Governance, Delhi)

THE GIST

- The Sixth Schedule, which is governed by Article 244(2) and 275(1) provides for the creation of Autonomous Districts. It covers Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram
- The Government has proposed to insert Article 371-K in Part XXI of the Constitution (Temporary, Transitional and Special Provisions) to strike a balance between national administration and local self-government

What does Centre's decision on NEET-SS seats entail?

Why did the Central government agree to reduce the qualifying percentile for NEET-SS?

Nivedita S.

The story so far:

On September 17, 2026, the Union government agreed to the Supreme Court's suggestion of reducing the qualifying percentile for the 2025 National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Super Speciality (NEET-SS) from 50% to 30%. Following this, the Medical Counselling Committee (MCC) commenced a stray round from September 25 to fill the remaining 1,857 vacant seats. The Centre also agreed to give the 40 vacant in-service seats in Tamil Nadu back to the State.

What is the NEET-SS examination?

The NEET-SS is the only entrance examination for admission to DM (Doctorate of Medicine), MCh (Master of Chirurgiae), and DrNB (Doctorate of National Board) super-speciality courses in India. It is conducted by the National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS), an autonomous body under the Union Health Ministry. There are over 7,000 seats in the country, with around 15,000 applicants every year.

NEET-SS is not a single unified examination. The courses offered under it are divided into 15 groups: general medicine, general surgery, orthopaedics, paediatrics, obstetrics and gynaecology, anesthesiology, radiology, respiratory medicine, microbiology, pathology, psychiatry, pharmacology, ENT, critical care, and medical oncology. Each group covers multiple specialty subjects. For example, general medicine covers cardiology, nephrology, neurology, and seven other subjects. Each group has a different question paper and the cut-off for each paper varies.

Why were seats going vacant?

Super-specialisation provides advanced clinical training and teaching for doctors. In India, it is in high demand in private corporate hospitals. "The market factor plays a big role. Doctors are taking super-speciality seats which give more chances for better practice and more money. If the seats they prefer are not available for their ranks this year, they will try the next time. This is a major reason why seats are going unfilled," said Dr. Ravindranath, general secretary of Doctors' Association for Social Equality.

Cardiology, neurosurgery, medical oncology, and gastroenterology are among those subjects which are highly competitive with lower vacancies. Seats mostly go vacant in those courses which do not have as much demand. For example, cardiovascular and thoracic surgery has witnessed a drop in demand as medical treatment now relies on drugs and radioactive interventions over surgery. Super-specialisation in paediatric surgery has a lower demand due to competition from doctors in other specialisations.

In 2023, after 1,003 seats remained vacant, a Supreme Court Bench led by Justices B.R. Gavai and Vikram Nath asked the Centre to find a solution. The Bench called these vacant seats a "wastage of resources". Following this, the Medical Counselling Committee (MCC) announced that the 2023 candidates with zero percentile were also eligible to secure a seat if they opt for it; however, many seats still remained vacant. In 2024, around 600 NEET-SS seats were vacant after two rounds of counselling, which led to mop-up rounds after court intervention.

What did doctors from T.N. demand?

In 2026, while hearing the case filed by Tamil Nadu Medical Officers Association, the court said the large number of vacancies in the 2025 NEET-SS admissions made the case for reduction of the qualifying percentile "compelling." The Bench of Justices B.V. Nagarathna and Joymalya Bagchi said access to super-speciality for in-service government doctors must become easier as they are appearing for the exam while providing service to the public at the same time.

Under G.O. Ms. No. 462, Tamil Nadu has reserved 50% of NEET-SS seats for in-service doctors in State medical colleges. This quota was upheld by the Supreme Court in 2022.

In the 2025 cycle, the State had reserved 219 seats for in-service doctors, of which only 68 were filled. Over 111 candidates remained on the waiting list. In the petition, the Tamil Nadu Medical Officers Association challenged the "premature diversion" of 152 seats reserved for in-service doctors working in State hospitals into the All-India Quota. Senior advocate P. Wilson, for the petitioner, said that many candidates, particularly from rural parts of the State, were awaiting a reduction in the qualifying percentile. This is relevant as there is no caste- or religion-based reservation in this exam. He also sought protection of the in-service quota. This led to the Centre giving 40 vacant seats back to the State.

Is this adequate to address the issue?

"Reducing the cut-off might address this problem to an extent, but it cannot prevent seats from going vacant," Dr. Ravindranath said. He added that the low number of seats in government hospitals in States like Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, and the northeast is worsening the issue. Along with this, employment and promotion opportunities have not increased for super-specialists. This is because in government hospitals, new departments for such specialisations have not been established. The low stipends and heavy workload in the course are also factors that discourage candidates from pursuing super-specialisation.

Nepal's flash foods: How can communities rebuild after a disaster?

The state is often quick to respond to disasters, but its approach is usually centralised and top-down, often undermining the role of local bodies, which have greater knowledge of the local context; these bodies need to have a say in issues such as the resettlement of communities

INTERVIEW

Nimesh Dhungana

Kunal Shankar
Nivedita Varadarajan

Trail of destruction: Damaged houses covered in sludge in the aftermath of the flash flood in Nepal's Rasuwa district. AFP

On August 26, floods hit Nepal's Rasuwa, Nuwakot and Dhading districts, wiping away entire towns and communities. Roads and bridges were washed away, and telecommunications networks were down. The immediate focus was on rescuing people trapped under debris and providing relief to those affected. A month on, the focus has now shifted to rehabilitation, rebuilding and long-term recovery.

The Hindu spoke to Dr. Nimesh Dhungana, Senior Lecturer in Disaster Studies and Global Health at the University of Manchester's Humanitarian and Conflict Response Institute (HCRI), who studies disasters through the lens of governance, democracy and accountability, about recovery after the devastating flash floods. Dr. Dhungana describes himself as an accidental disaster researcher who started studying disasters after the 2015 Nepal earthquake. He also studied the Himalayan country's response to the COVID pandemic. Edited excerpts:

Is there a difference between the way the government responded to the 2015 earthquake, the COVID pandemic and the recent flash floods?
The government has a sense of moral responsibility [to save lives] when a disaster of this scale strikes. One common element is that the state acts decisively and with the speed required in the aftermath of such disasters. It mobilises its emergency forces, led by the security forces. However, we are increasingly seeing that the state's response is not matched by a sustained commitment to long-term recovery and reconstruction. That responsibility starts to fade, particularly when it comes to listening to affected communities and ensuring that their rights are protected. It is about transparency, engagement with the affected population and ensuring that they have a say in the recovery and reconstruction process.

Your work suggests that disasters expose government failures that have built up, or existed long before the disaster itself. What do you mean by this?
I think there is a long-standing debate about what constitutes a disaster. The recent floods have also forced us to revisit this basic question: what is a disaster in the first place? One way of thinking about it is as an event that is often unpredictable and attracts considerable attention from national and international media, as the recent floods did.

Another way of thinking about a disaster is as a process. It is something that happens because of long-term vulnerabilities. Disasters are not caused by nature alone. I think there is a growing consensus that a disaster is more of a process than just an event. Unfortunately, it is more comfortable to think of a disaster as an event, something beyond our control. We saw that with the 2015 earthquake and the pandemic. This is not limited to Nepal; it is a wider issue. I think this is a problematic way of looking at disasters. It can absolve state actors of accountability. We need deeper introspection into the choices we make, our governance structures and institutions. We should adopt a more rights-based approach to disaster response and rethink how we address longstanding inequalities and injustices.

The state is often quick to respond to disasters, but its approach is usually centralised and top-down. This undermines the roles and responsibilities of local bodies, which are the frontline responders.

How do you balance the role of the local bodies and the federal government, especially when a massive disaster strikes a region, leaving the local communities wiped out?
It depends on the scale of the disaster. The flash floods in Nepal are unprecedented. Given the scale of the disaster, Nepal needs support from outside, not just nationally, but also internationally. However, this is no excuse for not involving local representatives in the process. Ward officials, elected representatives, local NGOs and community-based organisations, which are often at the forefront of disaster response, have greater knowledge of the local context. In the Rasuwa floods, questions have been raised about their role being undermined by the centralised disaster response.

Mobilising military and security forces for disaster relief is a way of centralisation. We need to think beyond security forces for the immediate response and recovery. We need to engage more civilian actors for immediate relief and in policy-making. We should empower the local government with resources, equipment and infrastructure to deal with disasters. In the longer term, policy-wise, local bodies need to have a say in answering the big questions, like how we resettle communities.

The problem is that, in Nepal and elsewhere, reconstruction tends to focus more on physical reconstruction, like building houses and other infrastructure. But they are often not aligned with community priorities. It also raises a deeper question: what does recovery mean? What if people don't want to move from a certain place? How do we listen to their claims and choices? The local government can play a really important role here.

Your work says there is a difference between the community 'having a voice' and 'having teeth'. What does that mean?
This also stems from a more rights-based approach to thinking about development and disasters. There's a long-standing literature on the role of voice in this kind of difficult situation, going back to Amartya Sen's work in famine prevention. He did seminal work on how we should think about famine not just as a problem of food production, but also in terms of entitlement failures and whether communities have the right to demand answers from authorities.

Be it the 2015 earthquake or the recent Rasuwa floods, bereaved families have demanded answers from the State about the way rescue and relief operations have been organised. There have also been questions about fairness and transparency in relief distribution. This is also about democracy and the responsiveness of State institutions, and whether they listen to these demands. 'Teeth' also means having the resources and ability to respond through concrete policy and programmatic interventions.

The idea of 'voice' and 'teeth', comes from scholar Jonathan Fox's work. I have drawn on that idea, but also looked at it in the context of disaster. Jonathan Fox talks about how 'voice' and 'teeth' come together to operate as a 'bite'. The 'bite', in this sense, is concrete measures that would protect the rights and welfare of disaster-affected communities.

What should a genuinely good, decentralised, community-led approach to disaster governance look like?
At the ward level, disaster management governance committees exist, but only on paper. We need human and financial resources to respond, as well as physical resources such as ambulances, hospitals and relief shelters. Emergency operations are not just about having resources; it is also about the general logic of governance. Disasters are better managed locally, as local governments have knowledge of the local context.

How do we ensure that human decisions do not make disasters even worse?
This comes back to who has the power to make decisions. The major casualties of the recent Nepal floods were hydropower and the road networks. Some estimates say that almost 10% of Nepal's hydropower infrastructure was wiped out. Who granted licenses to construct hydropower projects in these areas? This is fundamentally a question of governance. Decisions about building critical infrastructure, such as schools and hospitals, on riverbanks are linked to human choices.

Do communities that are victims of infrastructural breakdowns have any say? What role did they have in the making of these infrastructures?
It is important to have a conversation about the climate crisis, but we also need to examine what happened downstream. What was the government's role before the disaster? Did it do enough to protect the public? That is where a rights-based, more governance-centric approach to disasters comes in. It also involves a more social scientific approach to understanding disasters, rather than looking at them solely from the perspective of hazards and physical sciences.

How do we plan in such a way as to either avoid a disaster or rebuild after one?
There is no single cause of disaster. Some scholars have long called disasters as a wicked problem because they result from a combination of factors, such as natural hazards, risks and vulnerabilities. In the context of climate change, the recent floods in Nepal have made it painfully clear that this issue will become even more important. We need to be thinking about disasters from a multidimensional, interdisciplinary perspective. We have seen many disasters along the Nepal-India border that defy national boundaries.

We also need to take a transboundary approach.

How do we bring this conversation into policymaking? How do we decentralise disaster governance in a way that gives more power and resources to local bodies? We need accountability and responsibility. The government must listen to communities affected by disasters.

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the origin and meaning of the expression "cock and bull story"? (K. Balaji, Chennai)

When you say that someone gave you a "cock and bull story", what you are implying is that the individual told you a story that was unbelievable; he told you a story that was obviously a lie. People often resort to cock and bull stories when they want to come up with an excuse for not having done something. Here are a few examples.

When I asked Namrata why she hadn't done her assignment, she gave me some cock and bull story about being abducted by aliens.

When the Chairman asked for an explanation, all he got from the Vice President was some cock and bull story.

There are several explanations as to the origin of this expression. Some scholars believe that the idiom has its origins in the fables that we all read as children; stories in which animals behave and talk like human beings. Such stories are often considered to be unrealistic by people who are very practical in their outlook. They can't believe that animals like lions, bulls, foxes, etc. can actually talk. Hence the expression "cock and bull story".

What is the difference between lacto-vegetarian and lacto-ovo-vegetarian? (S. Amarnath, Mysore)

A "lacto-vegetarian" is someone who not only eats vegetables but also dairy products like milk, cheese, butter, etc. He doesn't eat eggs and products made from eggs. A lacto-ovo-vegetarian, on the other hand, is someone who takes both milk and egg products. By the way, a person who eats only vegetables is called a "vegan".

Which of the following sentences is correct? "Each of the children were given chocolates" or "Each of the children was given chocolates". (K. Gauri, Tirupati)

In such sentences, according to the rules of English grammar "each" should be followed by a singular verb. Therefore your second sentence will meet the approval of a grammarian. Here are a few examples.

Each of the books was gift wrapped carefully.

Each of the teachers wants to donate a hundred rupees.

Nowadays, there is a tendency to use a plural verb instead of the singular one in such constructions. This is especially true in speech. Here are a few examples.

Each of his plays have been hits.

Each of his ideas are clearly stated.

What is the difference between "stairway" and "staircase"? (D.S. Bhat, Bangalore)

Most people tend to use the two words interchangeably. For the common man, steps which allow him to move from one floor to another can be called either a staircase or a stairway. There is no difference between the two.

But I understand there are certain technical differences. And one of them is that a staircase usually has a handrail, while a stairway needn't always have one.

Published in The Hindu on February 12, 2002

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

On this day 72 years ago, CERN's founding convention entered into force. A quiz on the storied science lab

Vasudevan Mukunth

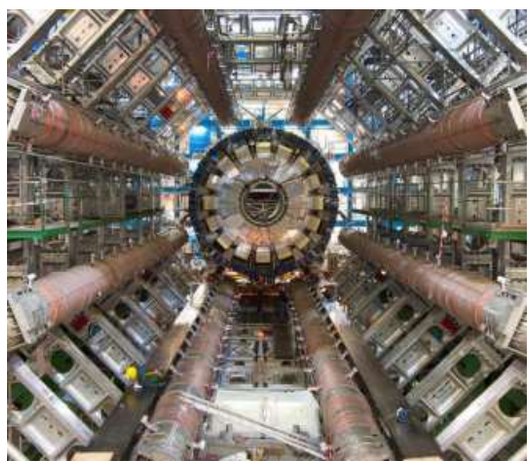
QUESTION 1
Since 2012, CERN has held 'observer status' at the X, allowing it to attend sessions and participate in the work of the organisation, but without having the right to vote. As a result, CERN has been able to contribute scientific and technical expertise central to X's work. Name X.

QUESTION 2
When he was working at CERN, the English scientist ___ _____ ___ invented the World Wide Web. By 1990, he had created the first web browser, server, and website plus core technologies like HTML, HTTP, and URLs. Fill in the blanks.

QUESTION 3
What did India's Department of Atomic Energy present to CERN in 2004? It was selected to commemorate the Indian government's association with the organisation.

QUESTION 4
Of the 12 founding members of CERN, 11 remain. Name the country that ceded its membership in 1961. Its government said the country's high-energy physics programme was too limited to benefit substantially from CERN.

QUESTION 5
CERN runs a distributed computing project called _____. Here, people can donate spare processing power on their personal computers over the internet, which a bespoke network makes use of to help perform calculations required by the Large Hadron Collider experiments.



Visual question: Name this instrument, which is the largest particle collider on the Large Hadron Collider at CERN. It is 46 m long, 25 m high and 25 m wide, and weighs around 7,000 tonnes. MAXIMILIEN BRICE/CERN

Questions and answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Her birth name. **Ans: Hema**
2. Significance of the song *Paa Lagoon Kar Jori.* **Ans: It was her first recorded Hindi solo**
3. The music director who backed her, after she was rejected for a having a 'thin voice'. **Ans: Ghulam Haider**
4. Common element to the songs: *Beeti Na Bitai Raina, Roothe Roothe Piya and Yaara Seeli Seeli (Lekin)*? **Ans: She won the National Awards for these songs**
5. She composed music for Marathi films in the 1960s under this name. **Ans: Anandghan**
6. The rendition that brought PM Jawaharlal Nehru to tears in 1963. **Ans: Aye Mere Watan Ke Logon**
7. The music for the thumri *Kanha Main Tose Hari* was composed by this director. **Ans: Satyajit Ray**
8. She was awarded the Bharat Ratna in this year. **Ans: 2001**
Visual: The location of this installation. **Ans: Ayodhya**
Early birds: Piyali Tuli| Erfanally Oosmany| Prem Nath Tiwari| Sukdev Shet| Gursharan Lal Vadhera
Correction: The quoted song in question 7 of the quiz was not sung by Lata Mangeshkar.

Word of the day

Bemusement:
confusion resulting from failure to understand

Synonyms: puzzlement, befuddlement

Usage: *He shook his head in bemusement at the child's unusual question.*

Pronunciation:
newsth.live/bemusement

International Phonetic Alphabet: /bəˈmjuːzmənt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'